

# BRINGING WORK HOME: FLEXIBLE WORK ARRANGEMENTS AS GATEWAY JOBS FOR WOMEN IN WEST BENGAL \*

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## Abstract

There is a large latent workforce in developing countries that consists of hundreds of millions of women who prefer to have paid work and yet are out of the labor force. Often, available job opportunities are incompatible with traditional gender roles that encourage women to stay at home. In a randomized experiment with 1,670 households, we partner with a jobs platform to offer short-term data work to women who are out of the labor force. We find three main results. First, flexible work-from-home jobs are highly effective at bringing women into paid work. Job flexibility more than triples take up from 15% for an office job to 48% for a job that women can do from home while multitasking with childcare. Second, these jobs can act as a stepping stone to less flexible work. Trying paid work from home increases take up of less flexible jobs two to three months later, particularly among women without previous work experience. “Gateway jobs” are especially important for women from more traditional households: their labor supply is more likely to be marginal to flexibility, and in turn, work experience shifts their attitudes to become less traditional. Third, from the labor demand side, remote work comes with trade-offs in terms of worker performance. Working from the office increases accuracy by 3% and speed by 18%. However, these performance drawbacks of work-from-home arrangements may be outweighed by the increase in available workers.

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# 1 Introduction

There is a large latent workforce in developing countries that consists of women who would prefer to work for pay and yet are out of the labor force. Representative surveys estimate this latent labor force numbers in the hundreds of millions of women, largely concentrated in South Asia, the Middle East, and North Africa.<sup>1</sup> This untapped workforce has high-stakes consequences for both the well-being of women and girls as well as aggregate efficiency. In addition to respecting individual preferences, increasing the share of women in the labor force could improve outcomes such as agency, health, and educational attainment for women and girls (Duflo, 2003; Jensen, 2010; Afridi et al., 2016) and lead to a more efficient allocation of men’s and women’s labor that could contribute to economic development (Hsieh et al., 2019; Ashraf et al., 2024). This misallocation and, consequently, potential gains are particularly pronounced in countries such as India where levels of female employment are low despite advancements in women’s education.

In these countries, social norms are thought to be a key barrier to women’s paid work (Jayachandran, 2021). One widespread norm in this context is that a woman’s place is in the home. In India, many women spend limited time outside the home: the median working-age married woman spends just 0.5 hours per day outside her home, with 45% not leaving the home at all on an ordinary day (Andrew and Smurra, 2024). This norm is in conflict with available jobs, few of which are fully remote.<sup>2</sup> This mismatch between jobs that are available and jobs that women could do without violating norms of appropriate behavior suggests two potential strategies: (1) change *norms* so that existing jobs become more acceptable for women, or (2) change *jobs* to be more compatible with existing norms. In this project, we start by taking the second approach: change jobs so women can do them while incurring lower norms-related costs. However, the two levers may be mutually reinforcing. If a woman’s earned income and labor supply affect attitudes about women and work, then an approach that starts by changing jobs might in turn change gender norms.

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<sup>1</sup>Based on a 2016 ILO–Gallup poll across 142 countries. In India alone, Agte and Bernhardt (2024) estimate that more than 100 million women are disallowed from working.

<sup>2</sup>As far as we know, no representative survey in India exists; however, The Economic Times reported that 20% of new job postings in summer 2024 were remote or hybrid.

In a randomized field experiment in West Bengal, we test the effects of offering an emerging type of work—digital gig work—that is relatively compatible with existing norms of women’s behavior due to the ability to work from home at flexible hours. Our experiment is designed to speak to three main research questions. First, would offering at-home, flexible work arrangements increase female labor force participation, and if so, which dimensions of flexibility are important? Second, given that many existing jobs require in-person attendance, can women who are initially only able to work from home use flexible jobs as a stepping stone to jobs with less flexible work arrangements? Third, to understand whether employers have an incentive to introduce remote working arrangements, what are the effects of work-from-home on job performance, both for inframarginal workers and due to any change in the composition of workers drawn to the firm?

We randomly assign women from 1,670 lower-middle-income households to a treatment group that receives a job offer of month-long digital gig work or to a control group that receives no job offer. Among those receiving job offers, we introduce variation along three dimensions of flexibility: (1) the ability to change one’s work time from day to day, (2) the ability to combine work with childcare, and (3) the ability to work from home. All jobs are part-time, one-month, and are offered in partnership with a smartphone-based data tasks platform in India. To separate the effects of offering work-from-home arrangements on worker composition from effects on job performance, after participants have decided to accept or reject their initial job offer, we randomly select half of the participants in less flexible job groups to be surprised with an upgrade to the most flexible job (as in [Karlan and Zinman, 2009](#)). After the jobs are completed, we estimate the effects of work experience on outcomes including women’s gender attitudes and agency as well as spillover effects on their children. Two to three months later, we measure take-up of new work opportunities (jobs round 2), including the effects of the initial at-home work experience on take up of less flexible jobs.

Most study participants are married women with little previous work experience. To focus on the extensive margin of labor force participation, women are only eligible for the study if they are not currently in the labor force or enrolled in skills training. During study recruitment, to avoid

selecting the sample based on interest in finding paid work, potential participants are not told that the baseline survey could lead to a job opportunity. This leads to a sample where 69% have never worked for pay prior to the study. However, to ensure women have the skills necessary to do the job if assigned to it, they must be literate in Hindi or Bangla and have access to an Android smartphone. Husbands and parents-in-law play a large role in whether or not women work: only 36% of women report having the final say in their own labor supply decisions.

We find three main sets of results. First, flexible work arrangements more than triple women's job take up. Compared to an office job, the most flexible job we offer—which includes the ability to choose work hours flexibly, combine work with childcare, and work from home—dramatically increases take up from 15% to 48% ( $p < 0.001$ ). This 33 pp effect on women's job take up is larger than effects of previously-tested interventions to increase women's labor supply. For example, a promotional video shown to women's families in Uttar Pradesh increased take up by 78% (7 pp) (McKelway, 2024), and correcting Saudi men's second-order beliefs about women working outside the home increased job sign ups by 36% (9 pp) (Bursztyn et al., 2020). The effect is also large compared to women's wage elasticity of labor supply; in an experiment in Mumbai, increasing wages by nearly five times resulted in an increase of one-quarter the size (Jalota and Ho, 2024).

To shed light on which mechanisms drive the effects of flexible work arrangements on women's labor supply, we randomly vary dimensions of flexibility across job offers. This allows us to separately estimate the contributions of having flexible work hours, combining work with childcare, and working from home to the overall effect of flexibility on job take up. The ability to work from home, even without time flexibility or the ability to combine work with childcare, doubles take up from 14.6% to 29.2% ( $p = 0.004$ ). The ability to multitask work with childcare is also important, increasing job take up by approximately 60% ( $p < 0.001$ ), from 29.2% to 45.6% (without time flexibility) and from 28.6% to 47.9% (with time flexibility). The ability to choose work hours flexibly, however, does not significantly change take up—these out-of-labor-force women can, and choose to, set aside consistent hours for paid work. Therefore, decomposing the 33 pp effect of bundled flexibility, approximately one half (14-15 pp) comes from the ability to work from home

and the other half (16-19 pp) from the ability to multitask work with childcare.

Second, we find that flexible work arrangements are not only effective at bringing out-of-labor-force women into paid work but can also act as a stepping stone to less flexible jobs. To test whether flexible work can act as a *gateway job* to less flexible work, we return to all study participants two to three months after the endline survey and offer them another randomly assigned job. The jobs round 2 offers vary in flexibility along the same dimensions as the initial jobs and also introduce variation in the type of work offered; while the original jobs were all online gig work, second round jobs also include non-digital piece-rate work (sewing masks or making jewellery) to assess if effects on interest in work operate through digital-specific mechanisms or apply to interest in paid work more broadly. Consistent with the initial work experience offering a low-cost opportunity to learn what it is like for women to earn income, women who had no work experience prior to the study are 9 pp more likely to start their randomly-assigned round 2 job if they were first given the chance to experience a more flexible job during the initial intervention ( $p = 0.02$ ).

One mechanism consistent with this gateway job effect is a mutually reinforcing relationship between gender attitudes supportive of women's paid work and women's actual labor supply, in which work experience shifts attitudes about appropriate behavior for women and consequently expands the set of jobs within reach. Women with more traditional attitudes at baseline had a stronger labor supply response to job flexibility, and in turn were also more likely to shift their gender attitudes in response to work experience. On average, women's gender attitudes became 0.05 SDs less traditional ( $p = 0.02$ ), with more traditional women's attitudes shifting by 0.12 SDs ( $p < 0.01$ ). In addition to the effects on the women participants themselves, we find suggestive evidence of spillovers to husbands' participation in home production based on surveys with children.

Turning to the labor demand side, the effects of flexibility on women's job participation show that introducing work-from-home even temporarily might allow employers to dramatically increase their pool of potential workers. So why do firms not offer flexible work arrangements more often? Beyond fixed costs and feasibility, employers may be concerned about how adopting home-based arrangements will affect worker performance. Introducing remote work could affect performance

in two ways: (i) by changing the performance of inframarginal workers, those who are willing to work in person but can now work from home, and (ii) by drawing a different type of worker into the firm once the job is advertised as a work-from-home job. We separately identify selection into and treatment effects of flexible work arrangements using randomly assigned surprise upgrades to participants' initial job offers. The main job performance outcomes we measure are accuracy and time required to complete tasks.

Working from home reduces worker performance, with the effect driven by treatment rather than selection. Office-based work causes workers to complete tasks 18% more quickly ( $p = 0.02$ ) and 3% more accurately ( $p = 0.09$ ) compared to workers who were willing to work from the office but were upgraded to work from home. We do not find significant differences on the selection margin, suggesting that *work-from-home compliers*—those whose job take up is marginal to the ability to work from home—are not systematically different in their performance from those who are willing to work from both home and office. In this context of piece-rate wages, the performance cost in completion time is borne by the worker. Examining how work patterns differ between treatment arms, flow effects can explain the negative effect of working from home on productivity. Defining a work session as a period of uninterrupted work in which fewer than ten minutes passes between consecutive tasks following [Adams-Prassl et al. \(2023\)](#), working from home decreases work session length by 25% ( $p < 0.01$ ). These fragmented work patterns are costly to performance because of flow effects: workers complete tasks more quickly, and more accurately, when they work for a longer stretch of time without pauses.

Our paper contributes to four literatures. First, we contribute to an active literature on barriers to and enablers of female labor force participation in low- and middle-income countries. This literature includes factors such as perceived and actual gender norms (e.g., [Bernhardt et al. 2018](#); [Agte and Bernhardt 2024](#); [Bursztyrn et al. 2020](#); [Field et al. 2021](#); see [Jayachandran 2021](#) for a review), internal psychological constraints (e.g., [Orkin et al., 2023](#); [McKelway, 2024](#)), intrahousehold bargaining power (e.g., [Heath and Tan, 2020](#); [Abou Daher et al., 2023](#)), safety and mobility (e.g., [Cheema et al., 2019](#); [Martinez et al., 2020](#); [Field and Vyborny, 2022](#); [Siddique, 2022](#)), early

childbearing (e.g., [Miller, 2010](#); [Herrera et al., 2019](#)), as well as employer and client discrimination (e.g., [Islam et al., 2021](#); [Buchmann et al., 2023](#)). In addition, a small but growing set of papers explore how digital technology interacts with these barriers (e.g., [Alhorr, 2024](#); [Jalota and Ho, 2024](#)). The review paper [Fletcher et al. \(2017\)](#) proposes that one driver of low female employment in India is a mismatch between available jobs and women’s preferences; our study shows one important dimension of mismatch is the desire for flexible work arrangements, particularly the ability to work from home or multitask work with childcare.

Second, while an extensive body of work demonstrates that female workers value flexible work arrangements more highly than men do in high-income countries, these studies focus on women already in the labor force and examine how compensating differentials contribute to gender wage gaps (for examples, see [Filer, 1985](#); [Goldin, 2014](#); [Goldin and Katz, 2016](#); [Wiswall and Zafar, 2018](#); [Mas and Pallais, 2017](#)). In countries like India, however, the first-order issue is not wage gaps but low labor market entry—by age 30, only 14.5% of Indian women have ever engaged in paid work, accounting for nearly all who will ever begin (PLFS 2021-2022). A natural question, then, is to what extent women’s preferences for flexibility explain low labor market entry. We show that among out-of-labor-force women, access to flexible jobs is often the deciding factor for starting paid work. Moreover, while the literature treats women’s preferences for flexibility as exogenous, we show it is shaped by experience: work entry and shifting gender attitudes increase women’s willingness to later accept less flexible jobs.

Third, we contribute to the literature on how economic behavior shapes gender norms. Prior observational work shows that economic conditions, such as plough versus hoe agriculture, shape gendered divisions of labor with long-run effects on norms (e.g., [Boserup, 1970](#); [Alesina et al., 2013](#); [Carranza, 2014](#); [Hansen et al., 2015](#); [Becker, 2021](#)). However, few experimental interventions have changed gender attitudes about women and work, and there is little prior evidence other than [Field et al. \(2021\)](#) that norms change when women start work. We experimentally test whether changing economic conditions to make them more favorable to women’s employment changes gender attitudes and find that women’s entry into paid work appears to kickstart a reinforcing cycle

between employment and less traditional gender roles.

Finally, we contribute to a growing literature about the effects of flexible work arrangements on job performance (e.g., [Bloom et al., 2015](#); [Choudhury et al., 2021](#); [Bloom et al., 2022](#); [Choudhury et al., 2022](#); [Aksoy et al., 2023](#)), as well as to a nascent literature about the effects of work-from-home on female labor force participation (e.g., [Edwards and Field-Hendrey, 2002](#); [Bloom et al., 2024](#); [Tito, 2024](#)). Consistent with most prior work examining the effects of fully remote work, we find negative effects on performance ([Emanuel and Harrington, 2024](#); [Gibbs et al., 2023](#); [Atkin et al., 2023](#); [Adams-Prassl et al., 2023](#)). While performance declines are often attributed to communication frictions (e.g., [Brucks and Levav, 2022](#)), we find negative effects even in fully individual tasks. Our project differs from most prior work in its focus on the performance of labor market entrants with little previous work experience, rather than the performance of incumbent in-person workers. Our paper also differs in that it is among the first—and to our knowledge, the first experimental study—to directly examine the impacts of work-from-home on female labor force participation.

The rest of the paper is organized as follows. Section 2 describes the study population and design. Section 3 describes the empirical strategy for our three main analyses. Section 4 examines effects of flexible work on labor force entry. Section 5 studies short-term work experience, mechanisms, and household impacts. Section 6 analyzes impacts on worker performance. Section 7 concludes.

## **2 Experimental design**

### **2.1 Setting and Participant Characteristics**

We conduct our study in eight areas in and around Kolkata, West Bengal, India. The study includes three rural locations (Canning, Noorpur, and Basanti), three peri-urban areas (Atabagan, Baruipur, and Sodepur), and two urban neighborhoods (Tiljala and New Alipore). Participant recruitment was facilitated by our local partner NGO, the Calcutta Foundation, which has operated in the region since 1994 with programs focusing on education, disaster relief, gender issues, and health.



Appendix Figure A2 maps the study areas.

**Sample Selection.** Recruitment occurred through a combination of door-to-door canvassing and introductions facilitated by local contacts in neighborhoods where our partner organization, the Calcutta Foundation (CF), had previously operated. Importantly, we recruited geographically rather than from CF beneficiary lists, and women currently enrolled in CF skills training were ineligible for the study. CF’s prior activities in these areas also largely focused on health services and disaster relief rather than employment, minimizing the potential for interaction effects with our treatments.

For inclusion in the study, households needed to have a female member who: (i) could read and speak Bangla or Hindi,<sup>3</sup> (ii) had access to an Android smartphone, and (iii) was not currently in the labor force or skills training. These criteria were designed to identify women who were full-time homemakers and would likely remain so absent the intervention, but who would have the skills and resources to do the job if randomly assigned to a job offer. We provide more information on sample recruitment and participation rates in Appendix Section A.3.

Our recruitment approach does not guarantee a representative sample, but our participant demographics largely align with regional population characteristics on key dimensions. As shown in Appendix Table A6, our sample is similar to the average West Bengal household in terms of household size, religion, and the presence of parents-in-law and children within the household. The large-scale survey data are from the National Family Health Survey (2019-21) and the Periodic Labor Force Survey (2021-2022). The large-scale survey sample is restricted to West Bengal and women between ages 18 to 60. Although the difference in means on some of these characteristics is significant, the magnitude of the differences is small across household size, presence of parents-in-law and children, and religion.

Given the demographic characteristics of an average adult woman in urban West Bengal, the study inclusion criteria are not highly restrictive. According to large-scale demographic surveys (the NFHS 2019-21 and PLFS 2021-2022), 67.7% of women between 18 and 60 years in urban

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<sup>3</sup>Bangla (also known as Bengali) is the official language of West Bengal. Bangla is also widely spoken in Bangladesh, as well as in other Indian states such as Tripura, Assam, and Jharkhand. Hindi is the most widely-spoken language in India and is spoken by many people in West Bengal, especially in Kolkata and bordering districts.

West Bengal can read a full sentence, 72.48% own a mobile phone, and 79.12% are not working for pay. Our sample does show slightly higher educational attainment and smartphone access than the general population, consistent with our eligibility requirements. Regarding technology access, all participants have access to Android smartphones (per our eligibility criteria), with 73% reporting exclusive ownership of their device rather than sharing with household members. This exceeds the smartphone penetration rate in the general population, where a 2021 survey found that 58% of even rural West Bengal households had smartphones, with likely higher rates in urban areas. Unfortunately, surveys that are representative of both urban and rural households in West Bengal do not include information about *smartphone* ownership specifically rather than cellphone ownership, but as a lower bound, the Annual Status of Education Report (ASER) for 2021 found that 58% of rural households in West Bengal have a smartphone.

***Participant Demographics.*** The women in our study are predominantly homemakers with limited prior labor market experience. The average participant is 30 years old and married. Half have completed education through tenth standard (age 15-16), while 13% have at least some undergraduate education. Three-quarters of participants are Hindu, with the remainder being Muslim. Forty percent belong to a scheduled caste or other backward caste, which is somewhat lower than the regional average, with a corresponding higher representation from the Open/General caste category. Household composition reflects typical family structures in the area according to representative surveys: the average household size is 4.6 members, and 40% of participants live with at least one parent-in-law. Many women have substantial childcare responsibilities, with three-quarters of participants having children under eighteen and 48% having children under eight.

***Socioeconomic Status and Agency Over Labor Supply.*** Participating households report an average monthly income of 11,791 INR (approximately 142 USD), placing them in the lower-middle-income bracket and somewhat below the West Bengal average. Most participants (69%) have never previously worked for pay. Notably, only 36% of participants report having the final decision-making authority over their own labor supply. The vast majority (86%) of remaining participants report that the final decision-making authority about their job take-up rests with their husbands.

The other 14% say that different family members—father, mother, father-in-law, son, mother-in-law in order of response frequency—would have the final say. Appendix Figure A3 reports respondents’ baseline responses of who would have the final say in their labor supply decisions.

***Gender attitudes about women and work.*** At the start of the study, many participating women hold traditional attitudes about the appropriate role for men and women in a household. For example, during the baseline survey, 67% of women agree that a woman’s most important role is to be a good homemaker, and 64% agree that earning a living is the father’s responsibility while childcare is the mother’s responsibility. Approximately half (52%) of women also agree that a man should have the final say about decisions in his home, which is particularly relevant to women’s labor supply because on average men express lower levels of support for women working—especially outside the home—than women themselves do (Bernhardt et al., 2018; Bursztyn et al., 2024).

We aggregate women’s levels of agreement with these statements, as well as ten other gender-related attitudes on the baseline survey, to classify women as belonging to households that are “more traditional” or “less traditional” depending on how their views compare to those of the median study participant. We show results aggregating statements into a standardized index following Kling et al. (2007) as well as following Anderson (2008). For more information on the gender attitudes index, including a list of all questions used as inputs into the index, see Appendix Section A.1. If women themselves, their husbands, and their in-laws hold these views, it may be difficult for women to take jobs that require spending an extended period of time outside the home, away from their homemaking responsibilities. This helps to motivate the jobs offered in the experiment, which are particularly amenable to flexible, at-home work arrangements.

## 2.2 Job Description

***Jobs platform.*** We partner with a local-language smartphone-based tasks platform in India to offer the intervention jobs. The interface for the job app is presented in Figure A6. The jobs involve piece-rate paid tasks to contribute to Hindi or Bangla speech datasets, which require participants to speak into their phones and record their voices. The platform’s clients build these speech datasets

in low-resourced languages to train speech recognition algorithms, the idea being that there is a large and growing population of digital technology users in India who speak one of the country’s many languages that do not yet have the labelled speech datasets necessary to develop voice-based applications (Abraham et al., 2020; Kumar et al., 2022).

Although the jobs platform hosts data annotation tasks across a wide variety of domains, we concentrate on speech datasets due to several advantages for our study. One advantage is that we can verify from submitted voice tasks if a woman rather than a man seems to be completing the tasks, even if the participant works remotely. Second, we can listen for children’s voices in the background of the speech recordings, which allows us to implement our work arrangement variations which do not allow for multitasking work with childcare. Third, there is a good justification for why it is valuable specifically for *women* to do these tasks, which is that existing datasets underrepresent women’s voices, which are important for training voice-based algorithms that work well in interpreting female voice content (as discussed in papers including Tatman, 2017; Garnerin et al., 2019; Fucci et al., 2023).

Jobs fitting this description have grown rapidly since the COVID-19 pandemic (Goldin, 2021). Remote work in the United States increased five-fold after 2019, and online gig opportunities are expanding in developing countries (Barrero et al., 2023; Datta et al., 2023). These gains in flexibility appear durable (Aksoy et al., 2022) and may have contributed to higher female labor force participation in high-income contexts (Tito, 2024; Bauer and Wang, 2023), with potentially larger impacts in developing countries where mobility and childcare constraints are greater.

**Task structure.** There are four types of paid tasks, which participants can choose to do in either Hindi or Bangla. The simplest tasks involve reading aloud a sentence which appears on the screen. These sentences are selected from a database of common phone or computer commands (e.g. “set an alarm for 7am tomorrow morning”) that previous clients requested and paid for. The rest of the tasks require a higher cognitive load, and we classify them as “difficult” tasks for the purposes of analysis, although we also present results for all task types individually. The first difficult task involves reading a sentence backwards, which we introduce to require more concentration. The

second difficult task involves finding a specific sentence within a paragraph and reading that sentence out loud. This requires more intensive concentration, as workers must read longer passages carefully. Lastly, there are open-ended questions for participants to answer, which our job platform partners were interested in collecting. However, because it is difficult to assess quality for open-ended task prompts, we exclude this last type of task from our analysis.

Participants receive 4000 tasks to complete over the course of one month, with 1000 new tasks refreshed each week that expire after seven days. Each week, workers are presented with 700 of the simplest tasks, 140 of the find-words-in-paragraph tasks, 150 read-sentence-backwards tasks, and 10 open-ended tasks. If participants are unsatisfied with their first attempt, they can re-attempt each task an unlimited number of times. The tasks are presented in a fixed order, but participants can skip any and as many tasks as they want.

***Payment.*** Participants earn up to one rupee per task they complete, with payments processed weekly according to task quality. Payments were deposited directly into women’s bank accounts, except in a small number of cases in which women said they could not be paid into bank accounts, in which case they were paid in cash. Each completed task is assessed by a separate team of validators hired by our partners, who indicate whether they hear children’s voices in the background of the task recordings and score each task on accuracy using a 0-2 scale. This means that participants could earn up to 4000 INR (approximately 50 USD) over the course of the intervention jobs, which is equivalent to 36% of the average household monthly income in the study. The task payment rate is set by the jobs platform and is the same as the payment rate offered to other workers on the platform for the same work. Per hour, this payment rate is also roughly equal to the wages advertised for data annotators in India on websites including Indeed.com.

***Implementing the work arrangements.*** The five work arrangements vary across three dimensions: time, multitasking with childcare, and location (see Table 1). The most flexible job offered, Home: Fully Flexible, allows workers to work from home, at any time they choose, and while multitasking their work with childcare. In each subsequent job, one or more dimensions are switched off.

*Time Flexibility.* In the time-flexible groups (Home: Fully Flexible and Home: Child Inflexible), workers can work for as many hours as they like and at any time of day to complete the tasks before they expire. In the time-inflexible groups (Home: Time Inflexible and Home: Time and Child Inflexible), participants choose a 3-hour timeslot during the job offer stage, and they can only work during that timeslot for the rest of the month. Note that most workers could easily complete the tasks they were assigned in a given week if they worked for all hours during their timeslot. Even the participants in the fifth percentile for speed could complete, or at least attempt, the thousand tasks per week in approximately twelve hours. To enforce these work shifts, engineers working for the jobs platform altered the smartphone application so that it was possible to set time constraints. In the time-inflexible work arrangements, the smartphone application would not open for participants outside of their allotted work hours.

*Multitasking Work with Childcare.* In the work arrangement groups which include the ability to multitask work with childcare (Home: Fully Flexible and Home: Time Inflexible), workers are told that they can have their children next to them while they work. In the groups that do not include the ability to multitask with childcare (Home: Child Inflexible and Home: Time and Child Inflexible), participants are told that it is not acceptable to have their children next to them while they work. If children's voices were heard in the background of their submitted tasks (determined by a separate team of validators), workers were not paid for those tasks.

*Working From the Office.* In four out of five work arrangements, participants work from home, while in the Office group they are required to work from one of our offices. We set up an office in each of the eight recruitment areas such that workers could reach them by walking or by travelling a short distance by vehicle (a two-wheeler or three-wheeler). If workers want to travel by vehicle, we reimburse them for any associated financial commute costs. Participants are not allowed to bring their children to the office. The office was open between 10am-6pm six days per week while the study was running (Monday-Saturday in most areas and Sunday-Thursday in the Muslim-majority area). Lastly, the participant's coworkers and managers are entirely female, shutting down concerns

about harassment or other potential negative consequences of a workplace with men.

## 2.3 Timeline and Randomization

Study implementation was staggered across eight areas, beginning in April 2022 and ending in January 2023. See Figure 1 for a flowchart describing the experimental design.

***Recruitment, informed consent, and baseline surveys.*** During study recruitment, potential participants are not told that the study could include a job opportunity in order to avoid selection into the experiment based on interest in work. If women are eligible and consent to participate, they complete a baseline survey that covers demographics, gender attitudes, agency, technology use, psychological wellbeing, and social contacts. When possible, we also survey one child per household aged eight to eighteen about their aspirations, participation in household activities, and gender attitudes.

***Jobs round 1: initial offers.*** After the baseline survey, we randomly assign households to the control group, which receives no job offer, or to one of the five job groups in Table 1 for their initial job offer. Randomization is stratified by three characteristics: area, individual smartphone ownership, and whether the participant has a child under age eight.<sup>4</sup> Participants can accept or reject the job offer, or else ask us to call back in a day or two if they need more time, for example in order to discuss the job offer with family members.

***Jobs round 1: surprise upgrades.*** After participants decide to accept or reject their initial job offers, we randomly select half of the participants who were assigned to any job other than Home: Fully Flexible to be surprised with an upgrade to the most flexible job. Women who were randomly assigned to an upgrade, but who turned down the initial less flexible job, are also offered the most flexible job. We include these randomly assigned surprise upgrades, following Karlan and Zinman (2009), in order to separately identify the characteristics of women who select into

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<sup>4</sup>One region, New Alipore, was not stratified further for randomization because of the small number of participating households (66).

flexible work arrangements from the effects of those arrangements. To estimate selection, we compare measures of job performance between participants who initially accepted the most flexible job with participants who were upgraded to the most flexible job after initially accepting a less flexible job. This strategy to measure selection holds constant the actual work arrangement while varying worker type (i.e. *flexibility compliers*, women who will only work when the job is flexible, compared to inframarginal workers). To estimate treatment effects of flexibility, we compare job performance between participants who initially accepted an inflexible job and were upgraded versus those who also accepted an inflexible job but did not get a surprise upgrade. This strategy holds constant worker type while randomly varying the work arrangement. After the upgrades, the jobs are implemented for one month as described in Section 2.2.

**Endline surveys.** After the randomized jobs intervention, participants complete an endline survey. This survey takes place within two weeks of job completion for treated participants, and the timing of surveys for control participants is selected to balance the timing of those in the treatment group. The endline survey includes modules such as gender attitudes, agency, and psychological wellbeing. We again survey one child aged eight to eighteen per household when possible.

**Jobs round 2.** Two to three months after jobs round 1, each study participant is approached and offered another randomly selected job. The jobs in this second round vary across the same three dimensions of flexibility as in the first round, and they again last for one month. In addition to the five digital gig work jobs offered in the first round of jobs, jobs round 2 also introduces two non-digital jobs that consist of sewing masks, making jewellery, or constructing bags. These non-digital jobs are also paid according to piece rates that vary by output quality. For the non-digital jobs, there are two possible work arrangements: one work-from-home, and one from the office. There is no way for us to enforce the ability to choose work hours or multitask work with childcare for tasks that are not completed on the jobs platform. The purpose of the non-digital jobs is to understand whether any treatment effects on interest in work are digital-specific or apply to interest in paid work more generally. Participants have an equal likelihood of being randomly assigned to any of



the seven possible round two jobs (two Home: Fully Flexible, one Home: Child Inflexible, one Home: Time Inflexible, one Home: Time and Child Inflexible, and two Office).

## **2.4 Randomization, Balance, and Attrition**

Appendix Table [A1](#) presents means and standard deviations of participant characteristics in the control and treatment groups after randomization into initial job offers, and Appendix Table [A2](#) presents means and standard deviations of participant characteristics in the control and treatment groups after randomization into final job offers. Randomization produced groups which are balanced across most characteristics of interest, although households in the treatment group are more likely to be Hindu, a difference that is significant at the 10% level. Appendix Table [A4](#) presents the same for participants who completed the endline survey. 1,525 households completed the endline survey with balanced attrition: the endline survey completion rate is 91.1% for the treatment group and 91.9% for the control group. The groups remain similar on average across important covariates. As with immediately after randomization, the treatment group is more likely to be Hindu ( $p = 0.064$ ). At the endline survey stage, there is one more imbalance significant at the 10% level, which is that the control group is more likely to have parents-in-law in the household ( $p = 0.119$  after randomization, and  $p = 0.098$  at the time of the endline survey). We also present a balance table for randomization into round 1 versus round 2 job offers in Appendix Table [A3](#), which is the relevant grouping for our gateway jobs analysis. Again, the same two variables (religion and living with in-laws) are significantly different between groups at the 10% level. To control for any imbalances, we present results from specifications that include covariates selected by double post LASSO that are predictive of both treatment assignment and outcomes of interest in regressions estimating the effects of treatment ([Belloni et al., 2014](#)).

## **3 Empirical Strategy**

This section presents the empirical strategy for our three main analyses. We first summarize the research questions and corresponding outcomes, then present the estimating equations, and finally

describe our approach to identification, heterogeneity analysis, and inference. This strategy applies throughout Sections 4–6, which present results.

### 3.1 Research Questions and Outcomes

Our experimental design enables us to address three main research questions:

1. **Labor force entry:** Does offering flexible work arrangements increase women’s entry into paid work, and which dimensions of flexibility matter most?
2. **Gateway jobs:** Can initial experience with flexible work serve as a stepping stone to less flexible jobs in the future?
3. **Worker performance:** How does working from home affect job performance, through both treatment effects on inframarginal workers and selection of different worker types?

The table below summarizes the primary outcomes, experimental variation, and estimating equations corresponding to each research question.

| Research Question           | Primary Outcomes                    | Experimental Variation                     | Equation |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|----------|
| (1) Labor force entry       | Round 1 job take-up                 | Random assignment to R1 work arrangements  | (1)      |
| (2) Gateway jobs            | Round 2 job take-up                 | R1 $\times$ R2 assignment                  | (2)      |
| (3) Work experience effects | Gender attitudes, agency, wellbeing | Any job offer vs. control                  | (3)      |
| (4a) WFH treatment effects  | Accuracy, completion time           | Surprise upgrades (among office accepters) | (4)      |
| (4b) WFH selection effects  | Accuracy, completion time           | Initial offer accepted (among upgraders)   | (5)      |

In addition to these primary outcomes, we examine several secondary outcomes to shed light on mechanisms and broader impacts: gender attitudes of women and their children, women’s agency

and psychological wellbeing, and fathers' participation in home production. We describe these outcomes as they arise in the relevant results sections.

In addition to these primary outcomes, we examine several secondary outcomes to shed light on mechanisms and broader impacts. In Section 4, we examine heterogeneity in labor supply responses by characteristics including demographics, household composition, baseline gender attitudes, and previous work experience. In Section 5, we examine effects of work experience on women's gender attitudes (Section 5.2.1); alternative mechanisms including agency, self-efficacy in smartphone use, and trust in the employer (Section 5.2.2); spillover effects on children (Section 5.3); and effects on women's psychological wellbeing and perceptions of whether their talents are put to good use (Section 5.4). In Section 6, we examine mechanisms underlying the performance effects including workflow interruptions and worksession length (Section 6.3). We describe these outcomes in more detail as they arise in the relevant results sections.

### 3.2 Estimating Equations

**Effects of flexibility on job take-up.** To estimate how job flexibility affects women's labor force entry, we compare take-up rates across randomly assigned work arrangements. The sample consists of all 1,670 women enrolled in the study and assigned to either the control group or to receive a job offer during round 1. We estimate:

$$\text{StartsWork}_i = \sum_{j=1}^5 \beta_j \mathbb{1}\{\text{FinalWorkArrangement}_i = j\} + \mu_s + \varepsilon_i \quad (1)$$

where  $\text{StartsWork}_i$  is an indicator equal to one if participant  $i$  starts the job she is randomly assigned to. The regressors  $\mathbb{1}\{\text{FinalWorkArrangement}_i = j\}$  are indicators for participant  $i$ 's final work arrangement, where  $j \in \{\text{Home: Fully Flexible, Home: Time Inflexible, Home: Child Inflexible, Home: Time and Child Inflexible, Office}\}$ . The omitted category is the control group, for which  $\text{StartsWork}_i = 0$  for all participants. We include strata fixed effects  $\mu_s$  throughout. Because we are interested in the question of how many more women would enter the labor force under these different work arrangements, we do not include any control variables in this part of the analysis.

**Gateway job effects on future labor supply.** To test whether flexible work can serve as a stepping stone to less flexible jobs, we examine how round 1 job assignment affects take-up of round 2 jobs. Because willingness to take up a job monotonically increases within-subject along the spectrum of work arrangements on offer, we say that anyone whose round 1 job assignment was more flexible than their round 2 assignment was given a *gateway job sequence*. Note that this monotonicity refers to take-up decisions, not to the job features themselves: as Table 1 shows, the specific flexibility dimensions bundled into each arrangement do not nest perfectly (for example, the office job includes time flexibility to ensure non-negligible take-up). Rather, by monotonicity we mean that when women are asked if they would be willing to accept each of the five work arrangements, within each respondent there is a single crossing from responding ‘yes’ to ‘no’ for job take-up (see Appendix Table A9).

If monotonicity holds, then there are some women—*gateway job compliers*—who would take up a more flexible round 1 job but could not have taken up the less flexible round 2 job if it had been offered during round 1. That is, their labor supply is marginal to the difference in flexibility between their round 1 and round 2 assignments. If work experience expands the set of jobs women can accept, these gateway job compliers may no longer be marginal to flexibility by the time they receive their round 2 offer, and would therefore be more likely to start work than their counterparts in the control group who did not have the opportunity to gain work experience.

We estimate:

$$y_i = \beta_1 \mathbb{1}[R1 > R2]_i + \beta_2 \mathbb{1}[R1 \leq R2]_i + \gamma_{r(i)} + \mathbf{X}'_i \boldsymbol{\delta} + \mu_s + \varepsilon_i \quad (2)$$

where  $\mathbb{1}[R1 > R2]_i$  indicates assignment to a *gateway job sequence* in which the round 1 job was more flexible than the round 2 job, and  $\mathbb{1}[R1 \leq R2]_i$  indicates assignment to a non-gateway sequence. We include round 2 work arrangement fixed effects  $\gamma_{r(i)}$ , lasso-selected controls  $\mathbf{X}_i$ , and strata fixed effects  $\mu_s$ . The omitted category is the control group, who received no job offer in round 1. Thus,  $\beta_1$  captures the effect of being assigned to a gateway job sequence—relative to

receiving no round 1 offer—on round 2 job take-up, conditional on round 2 job assignment.

**Effects of work experience on attitudes, agency, and wellbeing.** To estimate the effects of work experience on outcomes that may serve as mechanisms such as gender attitudes, agency, and psychological wellbeing, we compare women randomly assigned to receive any job offer with women in the control group. We estimate:

$$y_i = \beta \mathbb{1}\{\text{JobOffer}_i = 1\} + \mathbf{X}_i' \boldsymbol{\delta} + \mu_s + \varepsilon_i \quad (3)$$

where  $y_i$  is the outcome of interest measured at endline,  $\mathbb{1}\{\text{JobOffer}_i = 1\}$  is an indicator for being assigned to any job offer during round 1 pooling across all work arrangements,  $\mathbf{X}_i$  are lasso-selected controls, and  $\mu_s$  are strata fixed effects. The coefficient  $\beta$  captures the intent-to-treat effect of being offered a job on the outcome, relative to the control group. These outcomes are of interest both in their own right and as potential mechanisms: for example, if work experience shifts gender attitudes, this could help explain the gateway job effect documented using equation (2). For outcomes where we expect heterogeneous effects by baseline levels, we also estimate this equation separately for subgroups (e.g., women with more versus less traditional baseline gender attitudes).

**Treatment effects of work-from-home on performance.** To estimate how working from home affects job performance for inframarginal workers—those willing to work from the office—we leverage randomly assigned surprise upgrades. Among workers who initially accepted the office job, we compare the performance of those who remained in the office arrangement with those randomly selected for an upgrade to the most flexible arrangement. We estimate the following individual-by-task level regression:

$$y_{it} = \beta^T \mathbb{1}\{\text{FinalJob}_i = \text{Office}\} + \mathbf{X}_{it}' \boldsymbol{\delta} + \mu_s + \varepsilon_{it} \quad (4)$$

where  $y_{it}$  is participant  $i$ 's performance on task  $t$  (measured as accuracy on a 0–2 scale or completion time in seconds),  $\mathbb{1}\{\text{FinalJob}_i = \text{Office}\}$  is an indicator variable equal to one if  $i$  was not randomly selected to be upgraded to the flexible arrangement,  $\mathbf{X}_{it}$  are lasso-selected controls, and  $\mu_s$  are strata fixed effects. The omitted category consists of workers who were randomly selected for an upgrade after accepting the Office job. The coefficient  $\beta^T$  represents the causal effect of working from home on performance, holding worker type constant.

**Selection effects of work-from-home on performance.** To characterize flexibility compliers—women who work only if offered flexible jobs—we compare performance of different worker types under identical work arrangements. Among all workers ultimately working under Home: Fully Flexible, we compare (1) those who initially accepted Home: Fully Flexible with (2) those who accepted Office before being upgraded:

$$y_{it} = \beta^S \mathbb{1}\{\text{InitialOffer}_i = \text{Home: Fully Flexible}\} + \mathbf{X}_{it}' \boldsymbol{\delta} + \mu_s + \varepsilon_{it} \quad (5)$$

where  $\mathbb{1}\{\text{InitialOffer}_i = \text{Home: Fully Flexible}\}$  is an indicator variable equal to one if participant  $i$  was initially offered the flexible arrangement. The omitted category is the same as for the treatment effects analysis: workers who were initially offered and accepted the Office job but were randomly selected for an upgrade. We note that group (1) combines both flexibility compliers with those who would accept any job offer. To estimate the share of group (1) who are flexibility compliers, we scale the raw difference in productivity between groups (1) and (2) using the shares of participants who start work across different work arrangements. Since 47.9% of participants started work when offered Home: Fully Flexible while 14.6% started work when offered Office, we assume that of the 47.9% who started Home: Fully Flexible, 14.6% would have also taken up the office job if offered it. This leaves  $1 - (14.6/47.9) = 0.695$  as the share of women who are flexibility compliers. That is, they would accept Home: Fully Flexible but not office-based work. Since we are interested in characterizing the differences between these worker types, we do not include lasso-selected controls in this part of the analysis.

To summarize the comparison groups across analyses: throughout, we use the pure control group (no round 1 job offer) as the omitted category for the labor force entry, gateway job, and treatment effects of work analyses (equations 1–3). For the performance analyses (equations 4–5), the control group cannot serve as the omitted category because these individuals do not complete tasks. We therefore use a consistent omitted category across both the treatment and selection analyses: workers who accepted the office job and were randomly selected for an upgrade to Home: Fully Flexible.

### 3.3 Identification

Our identification strategy relies on three sources of experimental variation.

**Random assignment to work arrangements.** Job offers in both rounds are randomly assigned, stratified by area, individual smartphone ownership, and whether the participant has a child under age eight. This ensures that comparisons across work arrangements identify causal effects of job flexibility on take-up. Appendix Tables [A1](#) and [A2](#) demonstrate balance across treatment arms during randomization of initial and final round 1 job offers.

**Surprise upgrades.** After participants decide whether to accept or reject their initial job offers, we randomly select half of those assigned to arrangements other than Home: Fully Flexible to receive an upgrade to the most flexible arrangement. This design, following [Karlan and Zinman \(2009\)](#), enables us to separately identify treatment and selection effects of flexibility on worker performance. Treatment effects are identified by comparing performance among workers who accepted an inflexible job, some of whom were randomly upgraded. Selection effects are identified by comparing workers under identical (flexible) arrangements who differ only in their revealed willingness to accept office work.

**Gateway job sequences.** The combination of random assignment in rounds 1 and 2 generates exogenous variation in whether participants receive a gateway job sequence (round 1 more flexible

than round 2). The control group, which received no round 1 offer, provides the comparison for estimating whether initial work experience affects future labor supply. The key identifying assumption is that, conditional on round 2 assignment, round 1 assignment only affects round 2 take-up through the experience of round 1 work (or the offer itself for those who declined).

### 3.4 Heterogeneity Analysis

We examine treatment effect heterogeneity using two complementary approaches.

**Sample splits by baseline levels.** For each outcome, we examine heterogeneity by splitting the sample at the median baseline level of that outcome or a closely related characteristic. For example, for labor supply outcomes, we split by previous work experience (any paid work before the study versus none), while for gender attitudes, we split by baseline attitudes (above versus below median traditional) and for agency outcomes, we split by baseline agency (above versus below median). This recognizes that individuals with different baseline levels may have different scope for change—for example, women with already progressive gender attitudes may have less room to shift further. In addition, theory predicts differential responses: women without previous work experience have more to learn from initial exposure to paid work.

**Data-driven moderator identification.** When seeking to identify which baseline characteristics most strongly predict heterogeneous treatment effects—without restricting attention to a single moderator—we employ causal forests ([Athey and Imbens, 2016](#); [Wager and Athey, 2018](#)). This method measures how frequently each covariate is used to partition the sample when identifying treatment effect heterogeneity. Variable importance scores from the causal forest indicate which characteristics are most predictive of treatment effect heterogeneity across all covariates collected at baseline.



### 3.5 Estimation and Inference

**Control variables.** All specifications include strata fixed effects. For equations (2), (3) and (4), we also present specifications with controls selected by double post-lasso (Belloni et al., 2014), which identifies variables predictive of both treatment assignment and outcomes of interest. For the job take up analysis in equation (1), we do not include control variables as this would prevent us from getting the raw population difference in labor supply under different work arrangements. For the selection analysis in equation (5), we do not include control variables as we seek to characterize the overall differences between these worker types, including any differences in observable characteristics.

**Standard errors.** We report Huber-White heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors throughout in analyses (1), (2), and (3). For task-level regressions (equations 4–5), we present results clustering at the individual level.

## 4 Extensive margin labor supply response to job flexibility

### 4.1 Effects of flexibility on job take up

Estimating equation (1), we find that job flexibility dramatically increases women’s extensive margin labor supply by more than three times, from 15% for Office to 48% ( $p < 0.01$ ) for Home: Fully Flexible (see Figure 2). These estimates reflect the differences in the share of women who start work according to their final job offer after the randomly selected upgrades. To benchmark the magnitude of this effect, the bundled impact of job flexibility on take up (+33 pp or 228%) is larger than the effects of previously-studied levers that successfully increased women’s labor supply. For example, correcting men’s second-order beliefs about social image costs of women working increased sign-up rates for a job matching service by 9 pp or 36% (Bursztyn et al., 2020), a self-efficacy intervention increased job take up rates by 5 pp or 32% (McKelway, 2024), and giving women control over their earnings increased women’s participation in paid work by 5 pp or 13% (Field et al., 2021). The effect of job flexibility is also large compared to estimates of

women's wage elasticity of labor supply from Mumbai, where increasing women's monthly wage offers nearly five times from 5,000 INR (59 USD) to 24,000 INR (283 USD) only resulted in a 7 pp (32%) increase in job take up (Jalota and Ho, 2024). Applying these wage elasticity estimates to West Bengal, this implies women value job flexibility at 89,500 INR (1,050 USD) per month, far above the average monthly income of these households.

The effect of job flexibility on women's job take up varies but remains large across a range of study subsamples. Appendix Figure A4 plots job take up for each work arrangement across sample splits by religion, caste, education, cohabitation with in-laws, having a young child, having one's own smartphone, previous work experience, agency over one's labor supply, and gender attitudes. Using the causal forest approach described in Section 3, we find that gender attitudes emerge as the characteristic most important to mediating the effect of job flexibility on take-up (see Appendix Tables A16 and A17). The variable pool included all baseline variables, including the nine used to split the sample in Figure A4.

Job flexibility makes a difference to job take-up decisions of all subsets of women, especially for women from more traditional households. The job-take-up difference by gender attitudes in levels as well as the elasticity of labor supply appears even among women without children. Appendix Figure A5 splits the sample by gender attitudes as well having a child under age eight.<sup>5</sup> Regardless of whether or not a woman has a child younger than eight, more traditional women are less likely to start work and more likely to change their labor supply in response to job flexibility.

Finally, the large effect of job flexibility on women's job take up is robust to changing the cutoff of number of tasks completed that qualifies as having started work (see Appendix Table A7 columns (2)-(4) for results using 10 tasks, 50 tasks, and 100 tasks as cutoffs). The effect is also not driven by job upgrades, as shown in Appendix Table A8, which presents the coefficients for all initial-offer job groups separately. Differences in job take up between women initially assigned to Home: Fully Flexible and women who were initially assigned to another arrangement but were randomly selected for an upgrade to Home: Fully Flexible are small and insignificant across all

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<sup>5</sup>Having a child under age eight was one of our stratification criteria for randomization, chosen to reflect an age at which it may be possible to let a child self-supervise for a couple of hours while doing paid work.

dimensions of flexibility.

## 4.2 Mechanisms: dimensions of flexibility

To understand the mechanisms driving the impact of this bundled job flexibility on women's labor supply, we sequentially shut down time flexibility, multitasking-with-childcare flexibility, and the ability to work from home in job offers that are randomly assigned across participants. Understanding which features of flexible work arrangements affect women's participation in paid work is important for designing jobs that can include more women into the labor market.

1. **Time flexibility.** The ability to choose hours flexibly does not make a significant difference to women's job take up. Time flexibility has no significant impact regardless of whether women are assigned to a work arrangement in which they can multitask work with childcare. The job take up rate for Home: Time Inflexible is 46% as compared to 48% for Home: Fully Flexible ( $p$ -value for the difference = 0.69). In this comparison, both work arrangements include the ability to work from home and multitask work with childcare and differ only in time flexibility. Then, to examine the impact of time flexibility when women are *not* able to multitask work with childcare, we compare the take-up rate for Home: Child Inflexible with the take up rate for the Home: Time and Child Inflexible. Both have take-up rates of 29%.

These results show that the out-of-labor-force women in our study can, and choose to, set aside consistent hours of their day to work for pay. This holds regardless of whether or not the work allows them to multitask work with childcare. This suggests that lack of time, at least for part-time work, is not the binding constraint that prevents these women from entering the labor market.

2. **Multitasking-with-childcare flexibility.** The ability to multitask work with childcare is an important determinant of women's job take up. The share of women who start work increases from 29% for Home: Child Inflexible to 48% for Home: Fully Flexible (+19 pp or 67%,  $p < 0.01$ ). Similarly, the share of women who start work increases from 29% for the Home: Time and Child Inflexible to 46% for Home: Time Inflexible (+16 pp or 56%,  $p = 0.01$ ). In

practice, if children were quiet while workers recorded their tasks, it would not be possible to know if workers had children next to them while they worked. However, the lower job take up for childcare-inflexible jobs suggests that women did take this constraint seriously. Out of the 180,010 tasks submitted for review by women in the work arrangements that were multitasking-with-childcare inflexible, 4,682 tasks (2.6%) were marked as having children's voices in the background. Workers were not paid for flagged tasks, which reinforced the constraint and gave women a financial incentive to comply.

3. **Ability to work from home.** The ability to work from home—even at fixed hours and without multitasking with childcare—is also a consequential determinant of women's job take up, increasing the share of women who start work from 15% for Office to 29% for Home: Time and Child Inflexible (+14 pp or 100%,  $p < 0.01$ ).

In sum, the extensive margin labor supply decisions of 33% of women in our study are marginal to bundled job flexibility. A decomposition of this effect using random variation in work arrangements finds that approximately half of the effect can be attributed to the ability to multitask work with childcare (16-19 pp), and approximately half can be attributed to the ability to work from home independent of childcare concerns (14 pp).

## 5 Gateway jobs: flexible, home-based jobs as a stepping stone

### 5.1 Results.

Women randomly assigned to a gateway job sequence are more likely to start work conditional on their round 2 job offer (Table 2). Estimating equation (2), we find that assignment to a gateway job sequence increases round 2 job take-up by 5 percentage points for the full sample, though this effect is not statistically significant at conventional levels ( $p = 0.12$ ). Consistent with the stepping stone effect operating through learning from the experience of earning income, the effect is driven by women without previous work experience, who are 9 pp more likely to begin work ( $p = 0.02$ ). In contrast, there is no significant effect for women who already have experience with paid work (-

1pp,  $p = 0.83$ ). There is also no significant effect of being assigned to a non-gateway job sequence on women's take-up during round 2, as represented by  $\hat{\beta}_2$ , which is not significantly different from zero.

Figure 4 provides another view of the gateway job effect by comparing take-up rates for inflexible round 2 jobs across three groups: women assigned to a flexible round 1 job, women assigned to an inflexible round 1 job, and women in the control group. Because any single threshold for defining “flexible” versus “inflexible” is arbitrary, each panel varies this cutoff, moving from the most restrictive definition (left panel, where only Home: Fully Flexible is classified as flexible) to the most expansive (right panel, where all home-based arrangements are classified as flexible relative to Office). In each case the finding is qualitatively the same: among women without previous work experience, round 2 take up is higher among those assigned to the flexible job in round 1 as compared to those assigned to the control group or to the inflexible job in round 1. When “flexible” is defined as Home: Fully Flexible only, being assigned a flexible job in round 1 increases take up by 9.7 pp as compared to control ( $p = 0.07$ ) and by 5.9 pp as compared to being assigned to an inflexible job ( $p = 0.24$ ). When “flexible” is defined one level less strictly so that both Home: Fully Flexible and Home: Time Inflexible count as “flexible,” then being assigned a flexible job in round 1 increases take up by 11 pp compared to control ( $p = 0.026$ ) and by 9 pp compared to being assigned an inflexible round 1 job ( $p = 0.06$ ). The results are qualitatively similar but no longer significant at 10% levels as the definition of “flexible” expands and therefore the relevant sample of women assigned to an “inflexible” round 2 job becomes smaller. For women with previous work experience, round 1 assignment makes no difference to take up of jobs in round 2.

In the main specification, we use relative flexibility rather than any single threshold to (a) avoid choosing one arbitrary cutoff and (b) improve statistical power by including all women whose round 1 assignment was more flexible than their round 2 assignment, rather than treating some gateway job compliers as inframarginal.

## 5.2 Mechanisms

In this section, we consider possible mechanisms through which work experience might affect future labor supply. We first present evidence supporting gender attitudes as the primary mechanism and then assess the plausibility of alternative channels.

### 5.2.1 Gender attitudes as the primary mechanism

*Potential pathways.* There are several ways through which gender attitudes might affect women’s labor supply. First, traditional gender attitudes may lead women to view certain types of work as incompatible with their roles as wives and mothers, causing them to turn down jobs that conflict with this self-identity (Akerlof and Kranton, 2000; Oh, 2023). Second, more egalitarian attitudes about household decision-making could increase the weight placed on women’s preferences regarding labor supply. This is likely to increase women’s labor supply because women express higher levels of support for female labor force participation than men do across many settings (Bernhardt et al., 2018; Bursztyn et al., 2024). Third, initial experience with paid work might cause women and their household members to update their beliefs about the costs of employment as they learn through experience that initial concerns were overstated. Beliefs about the costs and benefits of paid work may be an input into attitudes, which in this paper we define as an expression of preferences conditional on beliefs. Although the overall attitudes index measures a combination of preferences and beliefs, several components of our index speak more directly to beliefs—for example, “Men generally understand money-related issues better than women”—and we show treatment effects on individual index components in Appendix Table A15. However, most of the index components bundle together preferences and beliefs. For example, if women learn that their children are not harmed when cared for by a neighbor or relative, they might change their response to the attitude statement, “It is better for children if their mother does not have a job when they are young.” Our gender attitudes index thus captures a combination of beliefs and preferences. We discuss the results for different components below.

*Data-driven approach for mechanism selection.* Using the causal forest approach described in Section 3, we identify which baseline covariates best predict heterogeneity in the gateway job treatment effect. As reported in Appendix Tables A18 and A19, the baseline gender attitudes index emerges as the strongest predictor of treatment effect heterogeneity, followed by baseline survey duration and the agency index. That gender attitudes ranks first among all candidate moderators, which include all covariates collected at baseline, provides empirical support for our focus on gender attitudes as the key mechanism.

*Empirical evidence on gender attitudes as the main mechanism.* We present evidence for two relationships linking gender attitudes to labor supply. First, traditional gender attitudes constrain women’s labor supply, particularly in less flexible jobs. Figure 3Panel A Panel A shows round 1 take-up rates for the five different work arrangements, split by whether women’s baseline gender attitudes are more or less traditional than the median participant.<sup>6</sup> Job take-up rates are weakly lower for traditional women across all work arrangements. Importantly, job flexibility is *differentially* more important for women with traditional gender views: labor supply elasticity with respect to flexibility increases in how traditional attitudes are.

Second, work experience shifts gender attitudes to become less traditional. Figure 3Panel A Panel B shows that women randomly assigned to receive a job offer become 0.05 SDs less traditional ( $p = 0.02$ ). This effect is concentrated among women who held more-than-median traditional attitudes at baseline; these women’s attitudes shift by 0.12 SDs ( $p < 0.01$ ). Figure A8 plots gender attitude distributions at endline and shows that the lack of effect on less-than-median traditional women is not due to ceiling effects. Finally, Appendix Figures A13 and A14 show effects on gender attitudes of work experience separately by different work arrangements. The intent-to-treat point estimates are similar across work arrangements, and the treatment-on-the-treated estimates are not precisely estimated enough to be significantly different from each other.

These results show that job flexibility and work experience affect the same subset of participants: women from more traditional households are those whose labor supply is more responsive

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<sup>6</sup>See Appendix Section A.1 for more information on measuring gender attitudes.

to flexibility, and it is these same women whose attitudes change most in response to work experience. Our finding that treatment effects are concentrated among women with more traditional baseline attitudes is consistent with the pathways outlined above: more traditional women have the most room for updating their beliefs and self-image, and likely face the largest internalized and household-level barriers to employment.

*Beliefs vs preferences.* Appendix Table A15 reports treatment effects on each component of the gender attitudes index separately. The two individually significant components—whether they would want their daughter to work after marriage, and whether a woman’s most important role is to be a good homemaker—appear to reflect preferences as much as or more than beliefs, while more belief-oriented components (e.g., whether men understand money matters better) are similar in magnitude but not individually significant. We thus cannot fully disentangle whether the attitudinal shifts we measure operate primarily through updated beliefs about the costs and benefits of working or through changed preferences; we view belief updating as one likely pathway through which the broader gender attitudes channel operates.

*Correlates of gender attitudes.* One concern with our focus on gender attitudes is that attitudes might be confounded with other sources of heterogeneity. Appendix Table A11 presents correlation coefficients between baseline gender attitudes and demographic characteristics. Educational attainment (completing 10th standard), having one’s own smartphone, and having a bank account are positively correlated with progressive gender attitudes. Having never worked for pay and having a child under eight are negatively correlated with progressive attitudes. Correlation coefficients between the gender attitudes index and household income, age, and co-habitation with in-laws are not statistically significant. Importantly, covariates that correlate with gender attitudes such as education and having one’s own smartphone were included in the causal forest analysis, yet gender attitudes still emerges with the highest variable importance score. This suggests that gender attitudes captures meaningful variation in treatment effect heterogeneity beyond what is explained by correlated observables.



### 5.2.2 Alternative Mechanisms

We now assess the plausibility of alternative channels other than gender attitudes.

***Skills and signaling.*** An initial work experience might help workers gain additional employment by teaching them valuable skills or by signaling to other employers that they have the skills to be good workers. While these mechanisms could strengthen the gateway job effect outside this study, our experimental design shuts down this channel. Job offers in round 2 are decided randomly with no screening on skill beyond the inclusion criteria for study participation, which required access to a smartphone and literacy in Bangla or Hindi.

***Income effects.*** Income from round 1 might affect labor supply decisions in round 2 if the household is less financially stressed when the second job offer arrives. However, income effects would push treatment effects in the opposite direction of what we observe: random assignment to a more flexible job would increase income and make it *less* rather than more likely that women accept a less flexible job in round 2. Thus, if present, income effects are dominated by other channels.

***Bargaining power.*** Women's additional income may increase their bargaining weight in household decisions, which could increase labor supply if women are more supportive of themselves working than their husbands are. However, we do not find significant effects on agency as measured by an index aggregating responses about decision-making (see Appendix Figure A9). This null effect is consistent with prior literature: unlike studies finding effects on agency from permanent income increases (e.g., [Duflo, 2003](#); [Field et al., 2021](#)), the income increase in our study was temporary.

***Digital skills.*** Round 1 work experience involved completing microtasks on a smartphone, which could have increased women's comfort with digital technology. If this skill-building rather than broader updating about employment drove the gateway job effects, we would expect women to differentially take up digital over non-digital jobs in round 2. However, we find no significant difference in take-up between digital and non-digital round 2 jobs (Appendix Table A20), despite the non-digital job (sewing masks, making jewelry, and constructing bags) requiring an entirely different skill set. This suggests that round 1 experience shifted women's willingness to work

more broadly, rather than simply building task-specific digital skills.

***Self-efficacy.*** If initial work experience increases self-efficacy (as found in [McKelway, 2024](#)), women might be more willing to take up jobs they consider more challenging, such as an office job, after the first experience with paid work. We do not find treatment effects on women’s reported self-efficacy in their ability to use a smartphone for a variety of skills ( $\hat{\beta}_1 = -1.5\%$ ,  $p = 0.48$ ), although we cannot rule out effects on self-efficacy in other domains.

***Trust in the employer and perceived safety.*** Work experience might affect future labor supply with the same employer if the experience helps build trust in the firm. For example, workers might learn that the employer pays workers on time, or that the managers seem reputable and safe for women to interact with. Treatment group women may have learned from interactions with staff that the employer is trustworthy, making them more comfortable coming to an office. This increased trust could lead to higher subsequent take up of less flexible jobs, especially outside-the-home jobs, if women think that it is risky to their safety to go to an office run by an unknown employer. This is a plausible channel that our gateway job effect may operate through, in addition to gender attitudes, given that existing papers show safety concerns are important to women’s labor supply and educational choices in South Asia (e.g., [Cheema et al., 2019](#); [Field et al., 2021](#); [Borker, 2021](#); [Kapoor and Gade, 2024](#); [Tandon, 2025](#)). Since all jobs in our experiment come from the same employer, we cannot empirically disentangle this channel from others. If employer trust is important, a key policy implication is that it may not be effective for third parties to provide at-home opportunities that lead to in-person jobs with *different* employers; this trust mechanism requires the same company to offer both.

### 5.3 Spillover effects to children

At the time of baseline and endline surveys, we survey one child aged eight to eighteen in each household when possible. Children are asked about their parents’ labor supply and home production activities and surveyed about their own gender attitudes. The children’s gender attitudes module is combined into an index following the same procedure as for adult women. Questions

about attitudes were similar to those asked to mothers (see Appendix Section A.1).

**Do children notice their mothers are working?** Children whose mothers were assigned to the treatment group are 18 pp more likely to say that their mother had a job during the last month ( $p < 0.01$ , see Figure A11 and Appendix Table A21). As a placebo check, we also ask children if their fathers had a job and find no effect on this outcome, which is consistent with the responses of primary female participants about their husbands' labor supply.

**Effects on fathers' participation in home production.** We ask children to what degree their fathers help with cooking, cleaning, and laundry. In the control group, 42% of children report that their fathers *never* helped with cooking, cleaning, or laundry during the time period of the study intervention. In comparison, treatment group children are 9 pp more likely ( $p = 0.06$ , Figure A11 and Appendix Table A21) to report that their fathers helped at least occasionally during the treatment period.

**Effects on children's gender attitudes.** There is suggestive evidence that treatment shifts children's gender attitudes. Using the Anderson (2008) index, treatment has a marginally significant impact on the attitudes of children older than the median age (12 years old), who become less traditional by 0.11 SDs ( $p = 0.05$ ), though the overall effect across all children is not statistically significant (Figure A13). However, using the Kling et al. (2007) index aggregation method, effects on children's attitudes are not significant for any age group (Figure A12, Table A22). Given the sensitivity of the result to the index aggregation method and the smaller sample size for children, we interpret these findings as at most suggestive of an effect on children's attitudes.

At baseline, boys' attitudes are 0.25 SDs less gender-equal than girls' attitudes ( $p < 0.001$ ), suggesting that differences in gender-based preferences and beliefs start at a young age. There are no significantly heterogeneous effects by child gender, and so the gap in gender attitudes between boys and girls persists at the same magnitude in both the treatment and control groups at endline (Appendix Figure A14).

## 5.4 Effects on wellbeing.

In addition to any effects on future labor supply, in order to assess the welfare effects of increasing the availability of flexible work arrangements, it would be useful to understand how these paid work experiences affect women’s wellbeing. If women are now working for pay and continuing with most of their home production responsibilities, then the work could become a “second shift” even if the women themselves prefer to work for pay (Hochschild, 1989).

Endline survey measures show that work experience has no significant effect on an index of psychological wellbeing ( $\hat{\beta}_1 = 0.01, p = 0.81$ ), nor on any of the individual index components (see Table A23). The index is composed of questions in which participants rate how frequently during the intervention period they report (i) sleeping peacefully, (ii) feeling overwhelmed, (iii) feeling happy, and (iv) feeling worried. Response options are feeling this way never, a few days out of a month, around half the days, more than half the days, or nearly every day.

However, paid work experience does shift women’s perceptions of whether their talents and abilities are put to good use. Strikingly, in the control group, more than one in four women report that their potential and talents are put to use *not at all*. Treatment shifts the entire response distribution to the right: women randomly assigned to receive a job offer are more likely to report that their potential and talents are put to use a little bit, somewhat, or very much ( $p = 0.02$ , see Figure 5).

## 6 Effects of flexibility on worker performance

### 6.1 Empirical Approach

We leverage randomly assigned surprise upgrades to separately identify how working from home affects worker performance through treatment effects (impacts on inframarginal workers) versus selection effects (changes in worker composition). The identification strategy and estimating equations are described in Section 3. Here we provide additional details specific to the performance analysis.

**Outcome measures.** We examine two primary measures of job performance: accuracy and task completion time. Accuracy is measured on a 0–2 scale by independent validators, where 0 indicates a completely incorrect submission, 1 indicates a partially correct submission, and 2 indicates a fully correct submission meeting all quality standards. Task completion time is measured as seconds elapsed between task initiation and submission.

**Task-level controls.** Because workers complete many tasks over the study period, learning and attrition could confound treatment effect estimates. In order to capture these effects, we include these task-level variables in the set of possible controls selected by double post-lasso: the cumulative number of tasks completed before task  $t$ , its quadratic, the cumulative number of tasks attempted, its quadratic, and fixed effects for each of the 4000 tasks.

**Heterogeneity by task difficulty.** We examine whether performance effects differ by task complexity. Simple tasks involve reading a sentence displayed on screen, while difficult tasks require more cognitive load: reading sentences backwards or locating specific sentences within paragraphs. We interact treatment assignment with task difficulty and task type to test whether the productivity effects of working from home are more pronounced for complex tasks requiring sustained concentration.

## 6.2 Results

**Treatment effects of work-from-home on worker performance.** Estimating equation (4), we find that working from home significantly reduces worker productivity. Table 3 presents estimates of the causal effect of work-from-home arrangements on worker productivity for inframarginal workers. Across a range of specifications that control flexibly for previous tasks attempted and completed, we find robust evidence that working from home significantly reduces worker productivity. Office-based work reduces task completion time by 18% ( $p = 0.02$ ) and increases accuracy by 3% ( $p = 0.09$ ) relative to home-based work.

We find that the negative productivity effects of home-based work are magnified for more

complex tasks. Appendix Table A25 presents results for each task type separately. Working from the office decreases the time it takes to complete the simplest tasks by 12% ( $p = 0.02$ ) while decreasing the time it takes to complete more difficult tasks by 18% ( $p = 0.03$  for difference with simple tasks). The pattern is present but less pronounced for accuracy outcomes: working from home has no statistically significant effect on accuracy for the simplest tasks, but increases accuracy by 13% for the most difficult tasks ( $p < 0.01$  for the difference relative to simple tasks).

Our findings largely align with the emerging literature on work-from-home productivity effects, which has so far mostly focused on contexts and populations very different from those in our study. In the U.S. context, Emanuel and Harrington (2024) document a 4% reduction in call center workers' productivity when working remotely, with decreases in both call quantity and quality—paralleling our findings on both task completion time (seconds per task) and accuracy dimensions. In India, Atkin et al. (2023) find an 18% reduction in productivity among full-time data entry workers, comparable to our estimated effect size despite our focus on part-time female workers previously outside the labor force. Similarly, Gibbs et al. (2023) find that remote work reduced productivity among high-skilled IT professionals in India by 8-19%, though their context features collaborative work where communication costs likely play a larger role than in our setting with independent tasks.

**Selection effects: characterizing work-from-home compliers.** Table 4 presents our analysis of selection effects, estimating equation (5) and comparing the performance of inframarginal workers to flexibility compliers working under identical work arrangements. This table scales the difference in performance by the estimated share of flexibility compliers. We present unscaled estimates in Appendix Table A26. Contrary to concerns that offering flexibility might attract lower-productivity workers, we find no statistically significant differences in performance between these groups. The point estimates are somewhat suggestive that flexibility compliers complete tasks more slowly—approximately 7% slower for simple tasks and 3% slower for difficult tasks—but these differences are not statistically distinguishable from zero. For accuracy outcomes, selection effects are more precisely estimated near zero.

Exploring heterogeneity in selection effects by task difficulty, the selection patterns remain statistically insignificant for both simple and difficult tasks, suggesting that flexibility compliers do not possess comparative advantages or disadvantages for particular task types relative to infra-marginal workers. Appendix Table A27 presents the selection results heterogeneity by each task type (simple, backwards, paragraph). These findings suggest that expanding the labor pool through flexible work arrangements does not come at the cost of reduced worker quality.

### 6.3 Mechanisms: Workflow Interruptions and Task-Switching Costs

What is it about working from home that explains the differences in performance for workers who are situated at the office versus at home? One of the major differences between working at home and working from an office is the possibility for interruptions (Adams-Prassl et al., 2023). At home, other family members may call on participants for their immediate attention, while at the office, participants are less likely to be called away from their work. To investigate this channel, we group workers' tasks into *worksessions*, which are defined as a contiguous segment of tasks in which fewer than ten minutes passes between consecutive task submissions (following Adams-Prassl and Berg, 2017).

Figure 6 presents evidence that workflow interruptions are a key mechanism through which flexibility affects productivity. Panel A shows that working from the office causes worksessions to be 25% longer on average than when working from home ( $p < 0.01$ ). This pattern is consistent with the hypothesis that workers face a higher arrival rate of interruptions at home from household demands, fragmenting their productive time. These interruptions are consequential for performance because of task-switching costs. We find that there is a “warm up” period associated with each worksession during which workers complete their tasks more slowly and with more mistakes (Figure 6, Panels B and C). Conditional on worksession length, initial tasks within a worksession are more likely to be completed incorrectly (meaning that participants will not receive full pay, and the output is not useful to the employer). And not only are these tasks more likely to be marked as inaccurate, tasks completed at the start of a worksession also take longer for the worker

to complete.

**Discussion.** In our piece-rate setting, workers themselves bear most of the efficiency cost through lower earnings, though employers still incur quality control costs for filtering inaccurate submissions. However, if this negative effect of work-from-home on productivity exists even in this context where the *worker* pays most of the price of lower productivity, then we might expect the negative effect to be exacerbated in salaried jobs in which the *employer* bears a higher share of the cost. Furthermore, the unpredictable and fragmented work patterns we document might make home-based work particularly problematic for roles requiring synchronous collaboration or rapid response times. This might pose a challenge especially for female workers who are expected to be “on call” at home.

## 6.4 Costs to the Employer

Firms’ incentives to offer work-from-home depend on the tradeoff between saving office costs and losing productivity, and importantly, on how wages are structured. Under piece-rate pay, firms save on office costs while workers bear the productivity loss. Under salaried pay with equal wages at home and in-office, work-from-home is only cost-effective at small scales, since office fixed costs shrink with volume. If firms can set different wages for home versus office, work-from-home is profitable whenever workers’ willingness-to-pay for flexibility exceeds the productivity loss.

Figure A17 illustrates this tradeoff by plotting firm profitability as a function of total hours of work completed under home-based versus office-based arrangements, holding total output fixed. The figure compares unit economics and highlights the role of fixed office costs versus lower per-hour productivity at home. See Appendix A.2 for details and calculations. In our setting, work-from-home can still be attractive overall because it substantially increases labor supply, allowing the firm to scale total hours completed. Finally, work-from-home can also serve as a stepping stone, reducing long-run costs if short-term home-based experience shifts women’s willingness to work outside the home, as shown through the gateway job analysis in Section 5.



## 7 Conclusion

Many women who would like to work for pay cannot do so because available jobs are incompatible with their household roles. In a field experiment with 1,670 households in West Bengal, we study the consequences of shaping work arrangements to accommodate expectations of women's domestic responsibilities. We randomly assign women to receive one of five jobs that vary along the ability to (i) flexibly choose work hours, (ii) multitask work with childcare, and (iii) work from home, and we estimate the effects of these attributes on job take up. To separately identify the effects of flexibility on worker composition and job performance, we use randomly assigned surprise job offer upgrades. Jobs are implemented over the course of one month, and a post-job survey measures effects on the gender attitudes of women and their children. Two to three months after the initial randomized controlled trial, we offer another set of jobs to participants to assess whether work experience increased future interest in work, particularly in less flexible jobs.

We find three sets of results. First, flexible work arrangements are very effective at bringing women who were previously out of the labor force into paid work. Varying different dimensions of job flexibility, we document that the effect of flexibility on labor supply is driven by the ability to multitask (combining work with childcare) and to work from home. These are the deciding factors in whether or not to work for many women. Second, flexible work arrangements act as a stepping stone to less flexible jobs, including outside-the-home work. Job flexibility makes a large difference to women's labor supply—especially the labor supply of those from more traditional households—and experience with flexible jobs in turn shifts the gender attitudes of these women to be less supportive of traditional household roles. Our results highlight that there is a mutually reinforcing relationship between women's actual employment and gender attitudes that support women's work. Last, we examine the incentives of employers to introduce flexible work arrangements, and we find that work-from-home decreases worker accuracy and increases task completion time. In both cases, a higher arrival rate of interruptions combined with flow effects leads to lower performance when working from home.

One implication of the gateway jobs finding is that a gradual approach to transitioning women from unpaid home production to market labor, through intermediate “stepping stone” jobs, could be effective. However, in order for this approach to not trap women in lower-paying, at-home jobs, the intermediate jobs may need to be temporary so that they do not become an absorbing equilibrium, although the job cannot be so temporary that households do not adjust their attitudes to align with a new reference point (Gulesci et al., 2023). In our study, we only offer women one job at a time: their choice is always to take the job or not have any job at all. This raises a question for future research: if women are given the option to continue working from home indefinitely, is it possible that flexible work arrangements could result in a more gender-segregated labor market? If so, what would help to ensure that women do not get “trapped” in jobs that are more flexible but also more precarious or less well paid?

Another policy implication of these findings is that offering flexible work arrangements would likely be an effective strategy for the recruitment and retention of female workers. If firms have work that can be completed from home, then it could be in the firm’s best interest to allow workers to work from home, as this increases the number of potential workers they could access. However, the negative effect of work-from-home on productivity might discourage firms from offering greater job flexibility. That said, as documented by Jalota and Ho (2024), women’s labor supply is very inelastic, and it may be possible to offset the negative effect on productivity with lower wages.

Even taking the negative effect on productivity into account, however, there are at least two reasons that work-from-home arrangements may be *underprovided*. One is that employers may lack the information or skills to offer flexible work arrangements at the efficient level. Employers may underestimate the pool of workers that they miss out on by not offering flexible work arrangements, either in terms of the size or skill of the worker population whose labor supply is marginal to flexibility. Employers may also be interested in introducing greater job flexibility, but may not know how to introduce flexible work arrangements without sacrificing worker performance. In addition, employers may not internalize the positive effect of home-based work experience on

women's future labor supply. Better understanding firms' decisions to offer flexible work arrangements, as well as their willingness to experiment with work-from-home, may be a fruitful area for future research especially in countries with low rates of women's participation in paid work.

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## Tables

Table 1: Description of Work Arrangements

| Work Arrangement                 | Time Flexibility | Multitasking with<br>Childcare | Work From<br>Home |
|----------------------------------|------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------|
| 1. Home: Fully Flexible          | Yes              | Yes                            | Yes               |
| 2. Home: Time Inflexible         | No               | Yes                            | Yes               |
| 3. Home: Child Inflexible        | Yes              | No                             | Yes               |
| 4. Home: Time & Child Inflexible | No               | No                             | Yes               |
| 5. Office                        | (Yes)            | No                             | No                |

*Notes:* This table presents the five work arrangements included in the experiment. The work arrangements varied in three characteristics: flexibility in (i) time, (ii) multitasking work with childcare, and (iii) work-from-home. In work arrangements with time flexibility, workers could work at any hours they wished throughout the job, while in time-inflexible arrangements they had to commit to a particular timeslot and then could only work during that shift for the rest of the job. In work arrangements that included the ability to multitask work with childcare, workers were told that it would be completely all right for them to have children next to them while they work, while in jobs without this feature, workers were told that they could not have children next to them while working. In the office work arrangement, workers had to come to a nearby office to complete their tasks. There were eight offices set up (one in each area or neighborhood of recruitment). The offices were open from 10am-6pm six days per week.

Table 2: Gateway Jobs—Effect of Round 1 Job Assignment on Starting Work in Round 2

|                                     | Started Work During Jobs Round 2 |                 |                       |                  |                 |                 |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------|-----------------------|------------------|-----------------|-----------------|
|                                     | All Participants                 |                 | Study = 1st Paid Work |                  |                 |                 |
|                                     | (1)                              | (2)             | Yes                   |                  | No              |                 |
|                                     |                                  |                 | (3)                   | (4)              | (5)             | (6)             |
| R1 More Flexible Than R2            | 0.04<br>(0.03)                   | 0.05<br>(0.03)  | 0.09**<br>(0.04)      | 0.09**<br>(0.04) | -0.02<br>(0.06) | -0.02<br>(0.06) |
| R1 Less or Equally Flexible Than R2 | -0.04<br>(0.03)                  | -0.04<br>(0.03) | -0.01<br>(0.04)       | -0.01<br>(0.04)  | -0.09<br>(0.06) | -0.10<br>(0.06) |
| Observations                        | 1,524                            | 1,524           | 1,049                 | 1,049            | 475             | 475             |
| R2 work arrangement FE              | Yes                              | Yes             | Yes                   | Yes              | Yes             | Yes             |
| Strata FE                           | Yes                              | Yes             | Yes                   | Yes              | Yes             | Yes             |
| Lasso selected controls             | No                               | Yes             | No                    | Yes              | No              | Yes             |

*Notes:* This table presents results on effects of the initial jobs RCT on starting work during the second round of jobs.

- The outcome variable in all columns is an indicator variable equal to 1 if the participant starts the job that she was randomly assigned to during round 2 and is otherwise equal to 0.
- The omitted group is the control group. Treatment group participants are categorized by the relative flexibility of their randomly-assigned round 1 (R1) versus round 2 (R2) job assignments.
- Columns (1) and (2) report the effects of round 1 job assignment on round 2 job take up for all participants. Columns (3)-(6) report effects separately by whether or not a participant had previous paid work experience before the study.
- All columns include round 2 work arrangement and strata fixed effects. Odd-numbered columns report results without additional controls, while even-numbered columns report results including controls selected by double post lasso.
- Huber-White standard errors in parentheses (·) are robust to heteroskedasticity. Stars next to coefficients denote significance (\* at 10%; \*\* at 5%; \*\*\* at 1%).

Table 3: Treatment Effect of Work-From-Home on Performance

|                                         | Effects of work-from-home on performance |                      |                      |                      |                      |                      |                      |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
|                                         | (1)                                      | (2)                  | (3)                  | (4)                  | (5)                  | (6)                  | (7)                  |
| <i>Panel A: Seconds Per Task</i>        |                                          |                      |                      |                      |                      |                      |                      |
| Final Job: Office                       | -4.84***<br>(1.77)                       | -4.39**<br>(1.95)    | -4.65**<br>(1.87)    | -4.67**<br>(1.89)    | -4.49**<br>(1.87)    | -4.56**<br>(1.87)    | -4.45**<br>(1.88)    |
| Final Job: Office                       | -3.11**<br>(1.54)                        | -2.61<br>(1.69)      | -2.92*<br>(1.60)     | -2.99*<br>(1.64)     | -2.72*<br>(1.62)     | -2.81*<br>(1.60)     | -3.00*<br>(1.63)     |
| Difficult task                          | 23.3***<br>(1.52)                        | 23.2***<br>(1.52)    | 23.4***<br>(1.52)    | 22.9***<br>(1.49)    | 23.2***<br>(1.52)    | 23.4***<br>(1.52)    | 23.2***<br>(1.64)    |
| Difficult task × Final Job: Office      | -5.87**<br>(2.31)                        | -5.88**<br>(2.31)    | -5.88**<br>(2.32)    | -5.71**<br>(2.31)    | -5.88**<br>(2.31)    | -5.89**<br>(2.32)    | -5.08**<br>(2.33)    |
| Home Avg. Seconds/Task                  | 26.521                                   | 26.521               | 26.521               | 26.521               | 26.521               | 26.521               | 26.521               |
| Observations                            | 227,994                                  | 227,994              | 227,994              | 227,994              | 227,994              | 227,994              | 227,994              |
| <i>Panel B: Accuracy</i>                |                                          |                      |                      |                      |                      |                      |                      |
| Final Job: Office                       | 0.054*<br>(0.032)                        | 0.055*<br>(0.032)    | 0.056*<br>(0.032)    | 0.056*<br>(0.032)    | 0.056*<br>(0.032)    | 0.057*<br>(0.032)    | 0.056*<br>(0.032)    |
| Final Job: Office                       | -0.004<br>(0.029)                        | -0.003<br>(0.029)    | -0.002<br>(0.029)    | -0.0009<br>(0.029)   | -0.002<br>(0.029)    | -0.001<br>(0.028)    | 0.003<br>(0.028)     |
| Difficult task                          | -0.280***<br>(0.043)                     | -0.279***<br>(0.043) | -0.280***<br>(0.043) | -0.273***<br>(0.044) | -0.279***<br>(0.043) | -0.281***<br>(0.043) | -0.304***<br>(0.052) |
| Difficult task × Final Job: Office      | 0.195***<br>(0.054)                      | 0.195***<br>(0.054)  | 0.195***<br>(0.054)  | 0.191***<br>(0.055)  | 0.195***<br>(0.054)  | 0.195***<br>(0.054)  | 0.181***<br>(0.053)  |
| Home Avg. Accuracy                      | 1.793                                    | 1.793                | 1.793                | 1.793                | 1.793                | 1.793                | 1.793                |
| Observations                            | 231,017                                  | 231,017              | 231,017              | 231,017              | 231,017              | 231,017              | 231,017              |
| Strata FE                               | ✓                                        | ✓                    | ✓                    | ✓                    | ✓                    | ✓                    | ✓                    |
| Lasso Selected Controls                 | ✓                                        |                      |                      |                      |                      |                      |                      |
| Number Previous Tasks Completed         |                                          | ✓                    | ✓                    |                      |                      |                      |                      |
| Number Previous Tasks Completed Squared |                                          |                      | ✓                    |                      |                      |                      |                      |
| Previous Tasks Completed Fixed Effects  |                                          |                      |                      | ✓                    |                      |                      |                      |
| Number Previous Tasks Attempted         |                                          |                      |                      |                      | ✓                    | ✓                    |                      |
| Number Previous Tasks Attempted Squared |                                          |                      |                      |                      |                      | ✓                    |                      |
| Previous Tasks Attempted Fixed Effects  |                                          |                      |                      |                      |                      |                      | ✓                    |

*Notes:* This table presents effects of work from home on job performance, and then differentially by task difficulty. It compares individuals who were randomly chosen for an upgrade from an inflexible, office-based job to the most flexible, work-from-home job after they accepted the less flexible job to those who were not randomly chosen. This holds worker type constant while comparing performance between the office job and most flexible work-from-home arrangement.

- In Panel A, the outcome variable is the seconds taken to complete a task. In Panel B, the outcome is the accuracy score assigned to a task. In both Panels A and B, the omitted group is individuals who accepted a less flexible job but were then randomly upgraded to the flexible, work-from-home job.
- Final Job: Office takes value 1 if the participant was not randomly chosen for an upgrade to the most flexible work-from-home job and 0 otherwise. Difficult task takes value 1 if the task is one of the three difficult task types and 0 otherwise.
- All columns include strata fixed effects. Column (1) includes controls selected by double post lasso. Columns (2) and (3) include controls for the number of tasks completed before the task, Column (3) also controls for non-linear effects of prior task completion. Column (4) includes fixed effects for all tasks that were previously completed. Column (5) and (6) control for number of tasks previously attempted, Column (6) also controls for non-linear effects. Column (7) includes fixed effects for previously attempted tasks.
- Standard errors in parentheses (·) are clustered at the worker level. Stars next to coefficients denote significance (\* at 10%; \*\* at 5%; \*\*\* at 1%).

Table 4: Characterizing work-from-home compliers: Estimates scaled by complier share

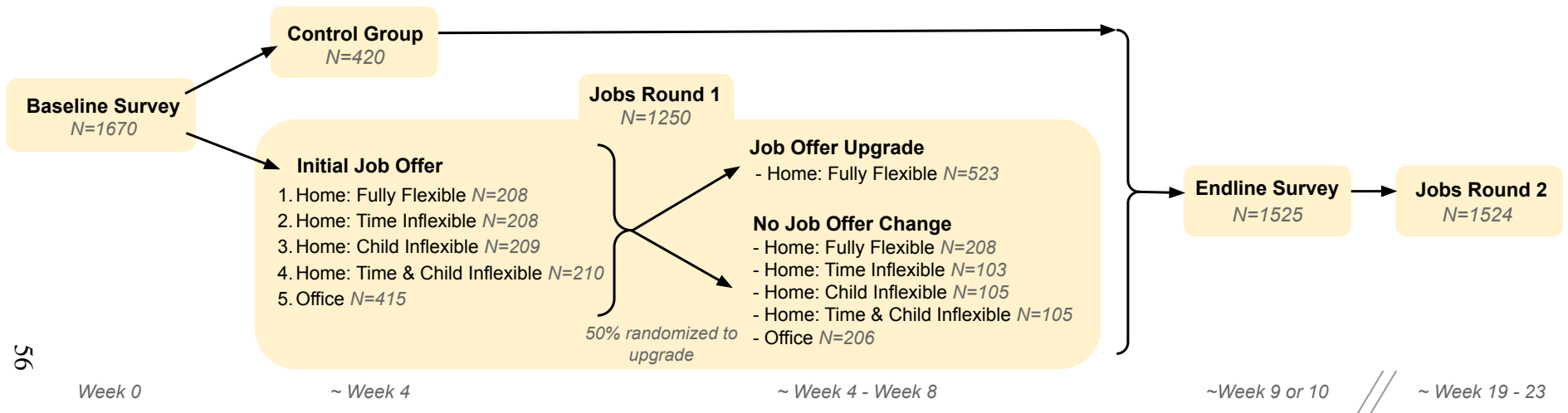
|                                                   | Characterizing work-from-home compliers |                      |                      |                      |                      |                      |
|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
|                                                   | (1)                                     | (2)                  | (3)                  | (4)                  | (5)                  | (6)                  |
| <i>Panel A: Seconds Per Task</i>                  |                                         |                      |                      |                      |                      |                      |
| Work-from-home-compliers                          | 2.37<br>(2.80)                          | 1.80<br>(2.63)       | 1.72<br>(2.61)       | 2.32<br>(2.78)       | 2.35<br>(2.77)       | 2.44<br>(2.78)       |
| Work-from-home-compliers                          | 2.47<br>(2.38)                          | 1.85<br>(2.19)       | 1.86<br>(2.21)       | 2.40<br>(2.34)       | 2.44<br>(2.33)       | 2.39<br>(2.34)       |
| Difficult task                                    | 23.2***<br>(1.51)                       | 23.4***<br>(1.52)    | 22.8***<br>(1.53)    | 23.3***<br>(1.52)    | 23.5***<br>(1.52)    | 23.0***<br>(1.61)    |
| Difficult task × Work-from-home-compliers         | 0.036<br>(2.99)                         | 0.088<br>(2.99)      | -0.150<br>(2.92)     | 0.054<br>(2.98)      | 0.078<br>(2.99)      | 0.333<br>(2.98)      |
| Office Accepters Average Seconds<br>Observations  | 26.521<br>409,300                       | 26.521<br>409,300    | 26.521<br>409,300    | 26.521<br>409,300    | 26.521<br>409,300    | 26.521<br>409,300    |
| <i>Panel B: Accuracy</i>                          |                                         |                      |                      |                      |                      |                      |
| Work-from-home-compliers                          | 0.028<br>(0.041)                        | 0.030<br>(0.041)     | 0.030<br>(0.041)     | 0.029<br>(0.041)     | 0.029<br>(0.041)     | 0.028<br>(0.041)     |
| Work-from-home-compliers                          | 0.018<br>(0.038)                        | 0.021<br>(0.038)     | 0.022<br>(0.039)     | 0.020<br>(0.039)     | 0.019<br>(0.039)     | 0.019<br>(0.039)     |
| Difficult task                                    | -0.281***<br>(0.043)                    | -0.281***<br>(0.043) | -0.269***<br>(0.044) | -0.281***<br>(0.043) | -0.282***<br>(0.043) | -0.282***<br>(0.043) |
| Difficult task × Work-from-home-compliers         | 0.029<br>(0.081)                        | 0.029<br>(0.081)     | 0.023<br>(0.083)     | 0.029<br>(0.081)     | 0.029<br>(0.081)     | 0.029<br>(0.081)     |
| Office Accepters Average Accuracy<br>Observations | 1.793<br>416,562                        | 1.793<br>416,562     | 1.793<br>416,562     | 1.793<br>416,562     | 1.793<br>416,562     | 1.793<br>416,562     |
| Number Previous Tasks Completed                   | ✓                                       | ✓                    |                      |                      |                      |                      |
| Number Previous Tasks Completed Squared           |                                         | ✓                    |                      |                      |                      |                      |
| Previous Tasks Completed Fixed Effects            |                                         |                      | ✓                    |                      |                      |                      |
| Number Previous Tasks Attempted                   |                                         |                      |                      | ✓                    | ✓                    |                      |
| Number Previous Tasks Attempted Squared           |                                         |                      |                      |                      | ✓                    |                      |
| Previous Tasks Attempted Fixed Effects            |                                         |                      |                      |                      |                      | ✓                    |

*Notes:* This table characterizes the job performance of flexibility compliers, comparing individuals randomly offered a flexible, work-from-home job to those who accepted an inflexible, office-based job but were then randomly upgraded to the flexible, home-based job. This holds work type constant and compares individuals who are marginal to flexibility to those who are not. All estimates and standard errors are scaled by the complier share: 47.9% of our sample took up the job when offered the most flexible work arrangement and 14.6% took up the office-based job, so we estimate  $1 - (14.6/47.9) = 69.5\%$  as the share of women who are flexibility compliers. Unscaled estimates appear in Table A26.

- In Panel A, the outcome is seconds taken to complete a task; in Panel B, the outcome is the accuracy score. In both panels, the omitted group is individuals who accepted office-based work before being randomly upgraded.
- Work-from-home compliers equals 1 if an individual accepted flexible, home-based work. Difficult job equals 1 if the task is one of the three difficult task types.
- All columns include strata fixed effects. Columns (1)–(2) control for number of tasks previously completed; column (2) adds non-linear effects of prior completion. Column (3) includes fixed effects for all previously completed tasks. Columns (4)–(5) control for number of tasks previously attempted; column (5) adds non-linear effects. Column (6) includes fixed effects for previously attempted tasks.
- Standard errors in parentheses (·) are clustered at the worker level. Stars next to coefficients denote significance (\* at 10%; \*\* at 5%; \*\*\* at 1%).

## Figures

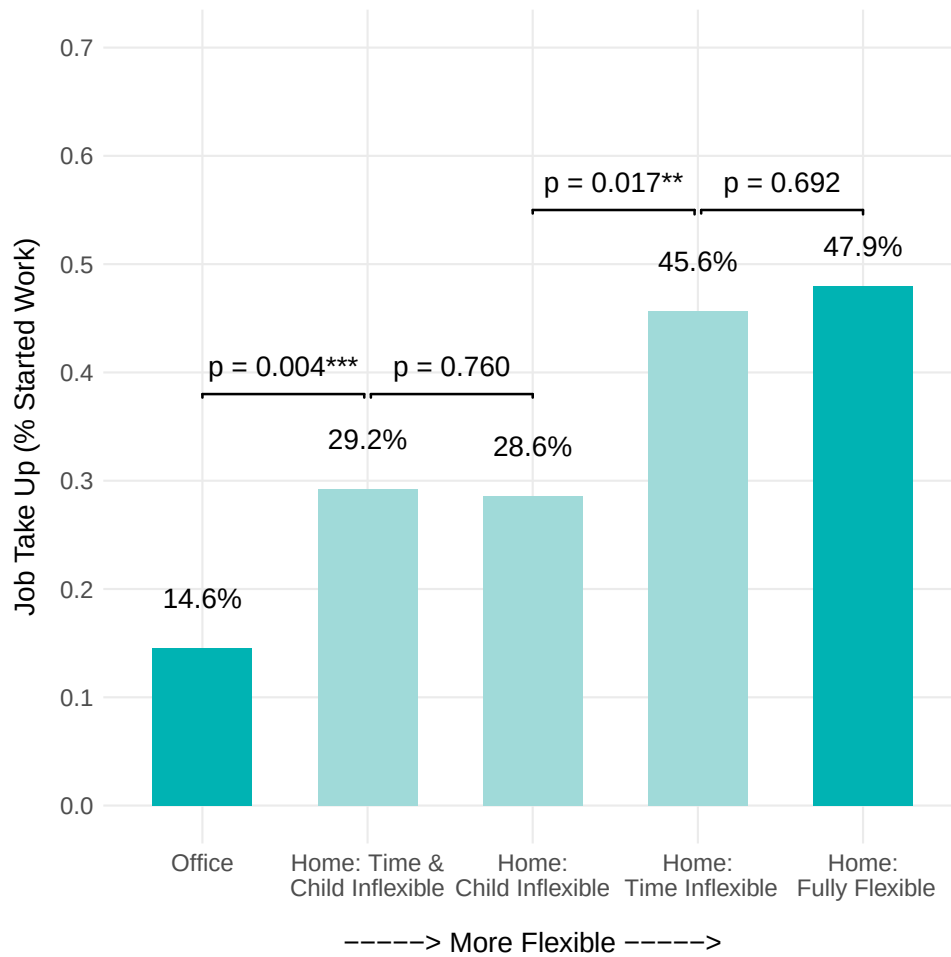
Figure 1: Experimental Design



*Notes:* This figure illustrates the five stages of the experimental design. Eligible households complete a baseline survey, with one part for women and one optional part for children aged 8-18. Households are then randomized into receiving a job offer or to the control group. The jobs vary along three dimensions: flexibility in choosing work hours, the ability to multitask work with childcare, and the ability to work from home. Time-flexibility and childcare-flexibility are cross-randomized, yielding five job groups. After accepting or declining, half of participants who initially received an inflexible job are randomly selected for an upgrade to the most flexible job. Participants then complete their month-long, part-time job. Within two weeks of job completion, participants complete an endline survey, which includes an incentivized job preferences elicitation for a second round of jobs that vary along the same flexibility dimensions.



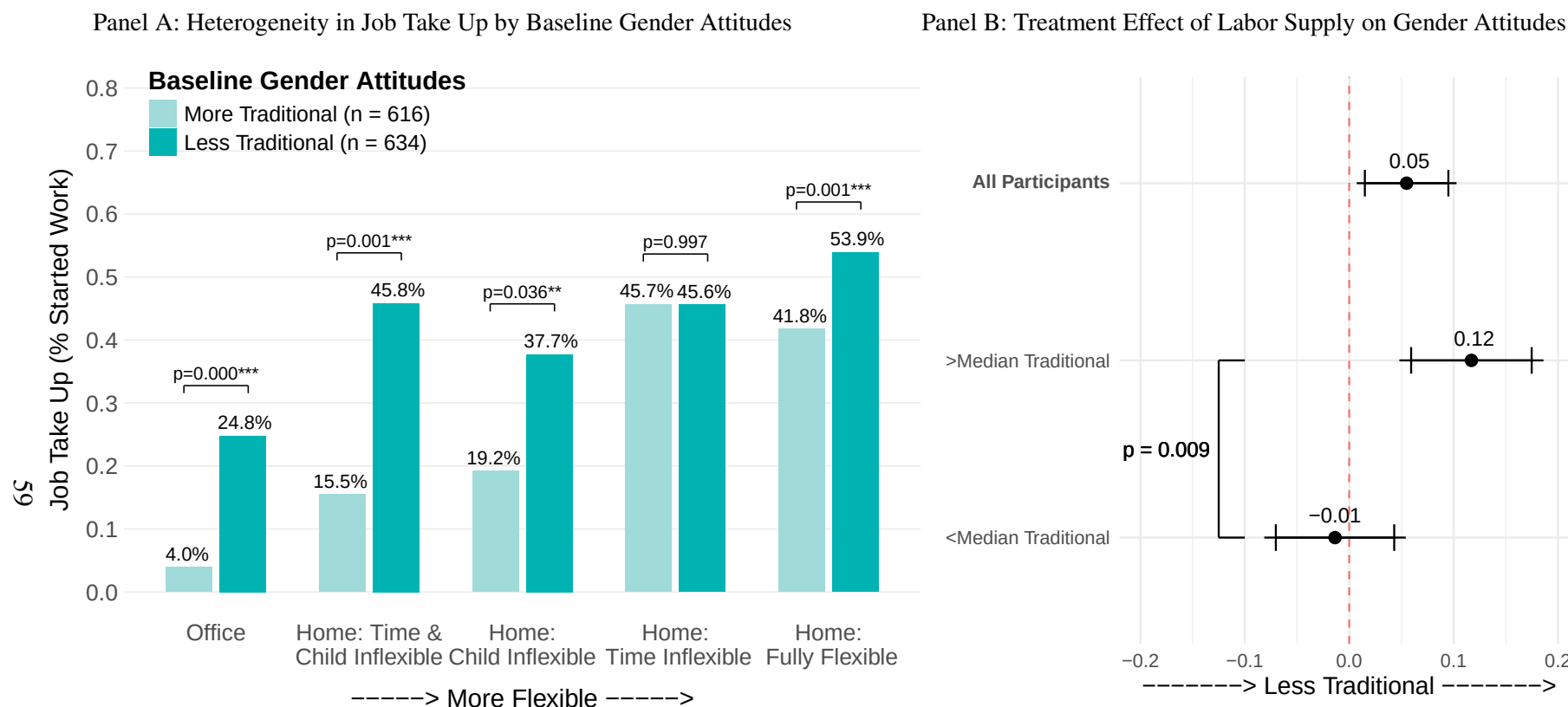
Figure 2: Impact of flexible work arrangements on take up of jobs



*Notes:* This figure plots the take-up rate for each of the five jobs during Jobs Round 1. The sample consists of the 1,250 women in treatment households. The plotted take-up rates correspond to participants' final job offers; that is, women assigned to different initial job offers but who have the same final job offer after randomly-assigned upgrades are implemented are pooled together. Take up is measured as a binary variable equal to one if the participant starts work (i.e. submits any completed tasks to the employer). This figure plots the raw take-up rates for each of the jobs, while the standard errors for these regressions, along with pairwise tests of equality between job take up rates, are presented in column 1 of Appendix Table A7. In these regressions, we control for strata fixed effects and estimate Huber-White heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors. The brackets above the bars show  $p$ -values for pairwise tests of equality between job take-up rates between work arrangements.



Figure 3: Relationship Between Job Flexibility, Gender Attitudes, and Women's Labor Supply

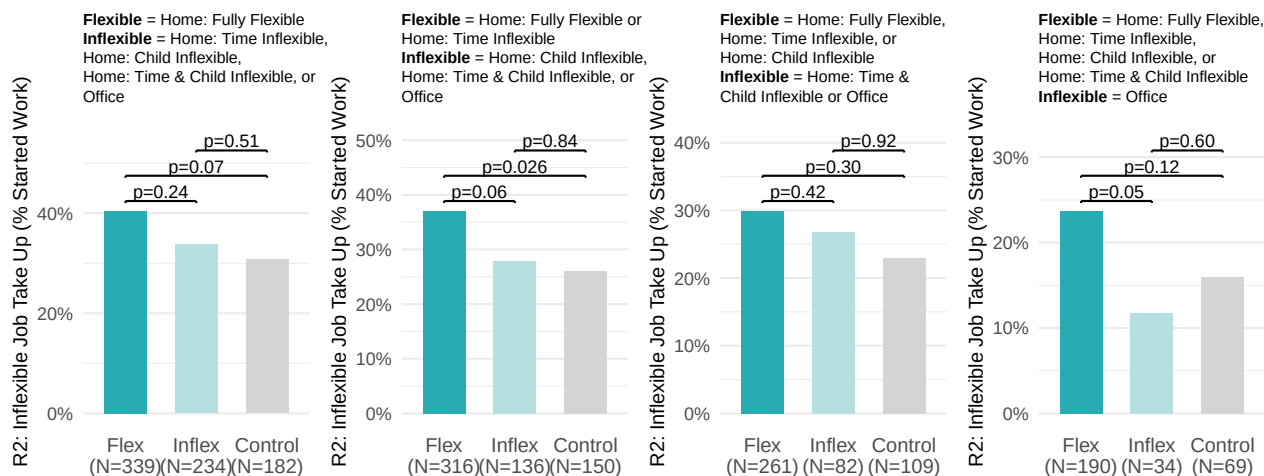


Notes: This figure presents evidence that (i) traditional gender attitudes are associated with lower labor supply and mediate the importance of job flexibility (Panel A), and (ii) work experience shifts gender attitudes to become less traditional (Panel B). Gender attitudes indices are standardized weighted averages of survey questions following [Kling et al. \(2007\)](#); see Appendix Section A.1 for construction details. Participants are classified as more or less than median traditional according to their baseline index score.

- Panel A displays job take-up rates across work arrangements, ordered by increasing flexibility, for the 1,250 participants assigned to a round 1 job offer. Take-up rates reflect final job offers after randomly-assigned upgrades.
- Panel B plots treatment effects on gender attitudes, pooling all treatment groups against the control group ( $N = 1,524$ ). The  $x$ -axis unit is standard deviations of the gender attitudes index (positive = less traditional). All regressions include lasso-selected controls and strata fixed effects. Whiskers denote 90% and 95% confidence intervals using heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors.

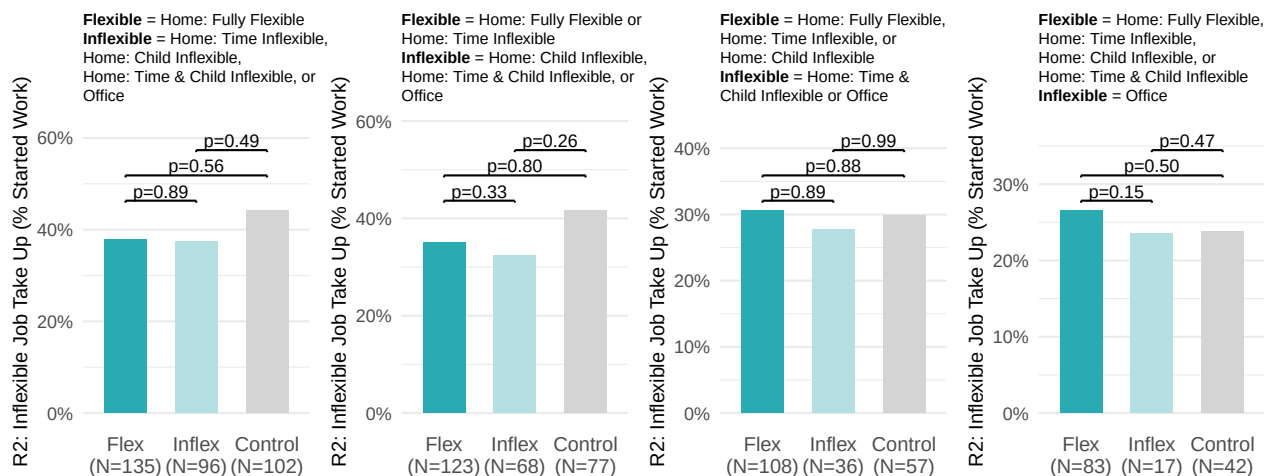
Figure 4: Take Up of Inflexible Round 2 Jobs by Round 1 Job Assignment

### First-Time Paid-Workers: Inflexible R2 Take-Up



Round 1 Job Assignment

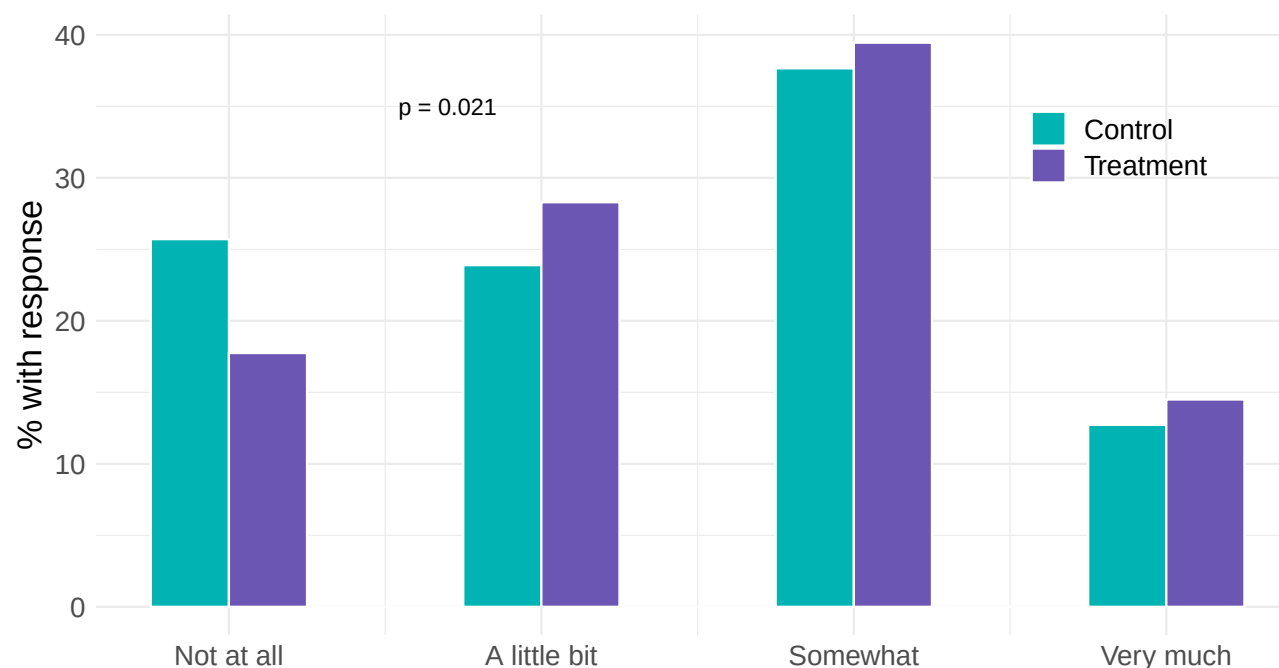
### Had Previous Work Experience: Inflexible R2 Take-Up



Round 1 Job Assignment

*Notes:* This figure shows take-up rates of inflexible round 2 (R2) jobs by round 1 (R1) assignment. Take-up is measured as the share of women who started the R2 job randomly assigned to them. Each panel varies the threshold for classifying jobs as “Flexible” versus “Inflexible,” moving from the most restrictive definition for flexible (left panel) to the most expansive (right panel). This comparison tests whether initial exposure to flexible work increases subsequent take-up of less flexible jobs, i.e. a “gateway” effect. The brackets display regression-based  $p$ -values where specifications control for strata fixed effects and lasso-selected covariates.

Figure 5: Perception of Whether Talents and Abilities Are Put to Good Use

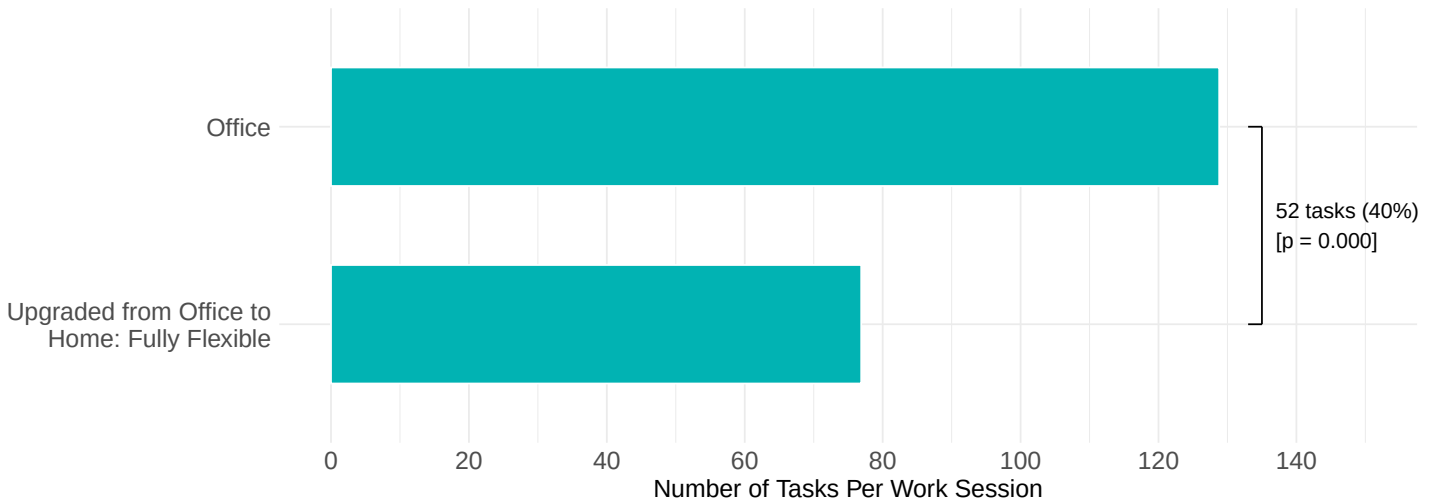


*Notes:* This figure plots participants' endline survey responses to the question, "Do you feel that your full potential and talents are put to good use?"

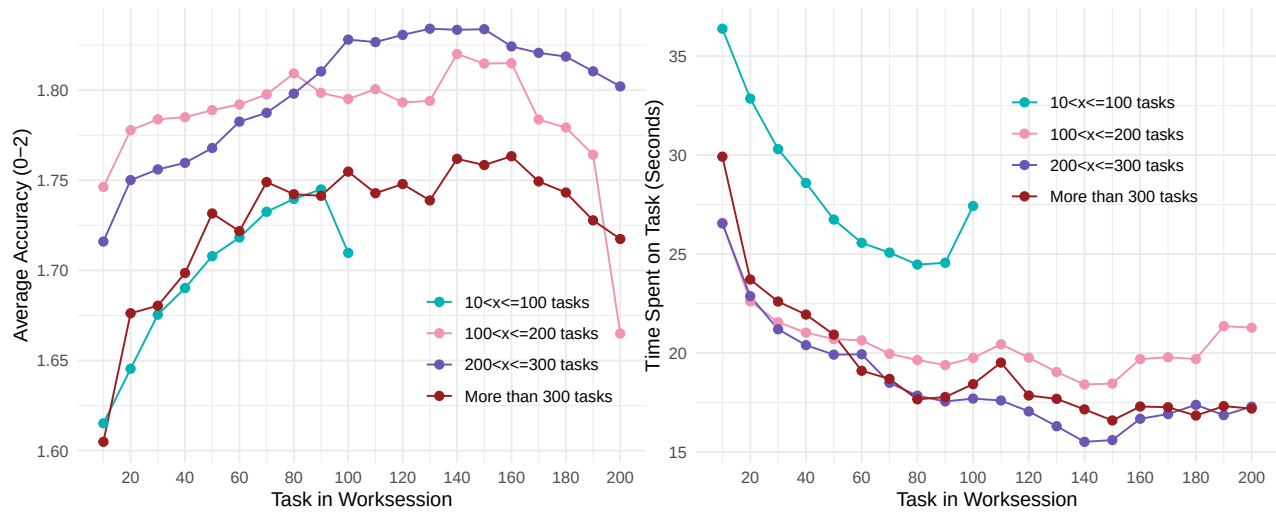
- Response distributions are plotted separately according to treatment assignment. The turquoise bars represent the share of control group participants with each response, while the purple bars represent the share of treatment group participants with each response. All treatment groups are pooled in this analysis.
- The reported  $p$ -value comes from a regression which codes participants' responses numerically, with "not at all" as 0, "a little bit" as 1, "somewhat" as 2, and "very much" as 3. The treatment group has a mean score of 1.50, while the control group has a mean score of 1.37. This outcome is regressed on treatment assignment, lasso-selected controls, and strata fixed effects. Standard errors are heteroskedasticity-robust. The results of the regression are presented in Appendix Table [A24](#).

Figure 6: Flow Effects

Panel A: Treatment Effect of Office on Tasks Per Worksession



Panel B: Task accuracy, by task within worksession      Panel C: Time per task, by task within worksession



Notes: This figure illustrates how worksession interruptions lead to a decrease in worker performance.

- Panel A reports the treatment effects of work-from-home on the number of tasks completed per worksession. A worksession is defined as a continuous segment of time during which a worker submits tasks without taking a break. This subfigure compares the worksessions of workers who accepted an office job and are randomly selected for an upgrade to the most flexible job with those of workers who accept an office job and are not randomly selected for an upgrade. The bracket reports the difference in tasks per worksession from home versus office, along with the  $p$ -value from a worksession-by-individual level regression estimating the effect of work-from-home on worksession length (standard errors clustered at the worker level).
- Panels B and C describe how two key inputs into productivity change over the course of a worksession. In order to capture “flow effects” rather than selection into longer versus shorter worksessions, worksessions are grouped according to their number of tasks. The dependent variable is task-level accuracy in Panel B and time spent per task in Panel C. Accuracy is assessed on a scale from 0-2 by an independent team of validators, and time spent per task is measured at the number of seconds that elapse between task initiation and submission.

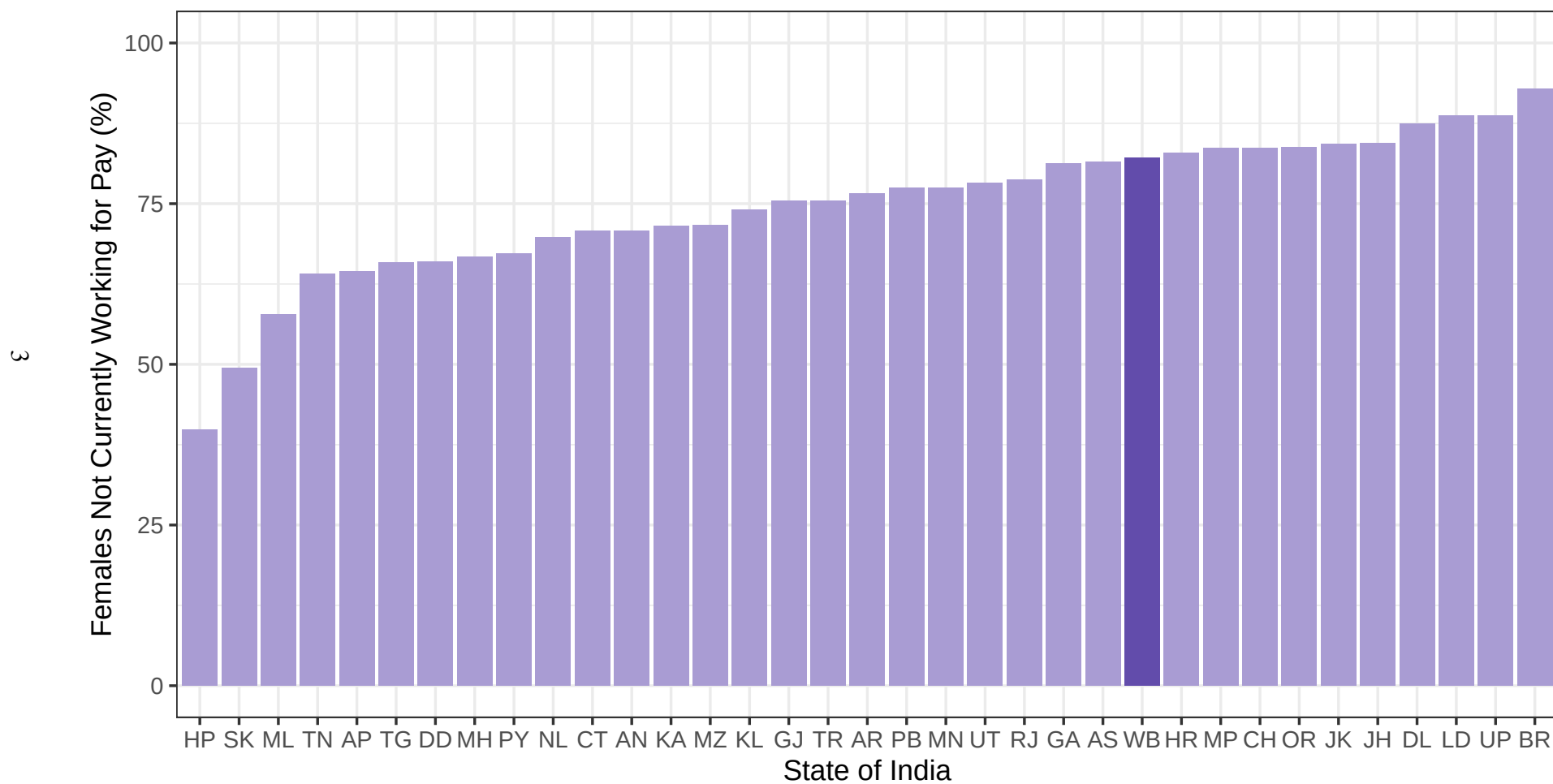
## **A Appendix**





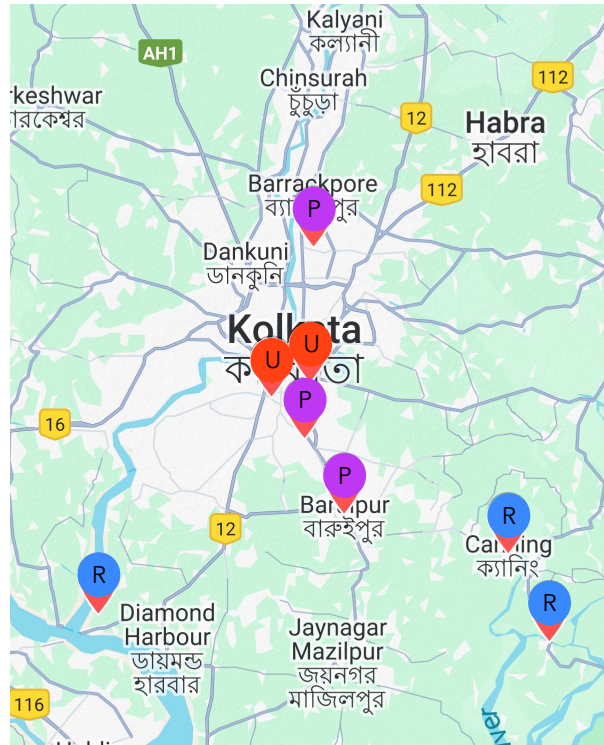
## Appendix Figures

Figure A1: % Women Not Currently Working For Pay: States of India



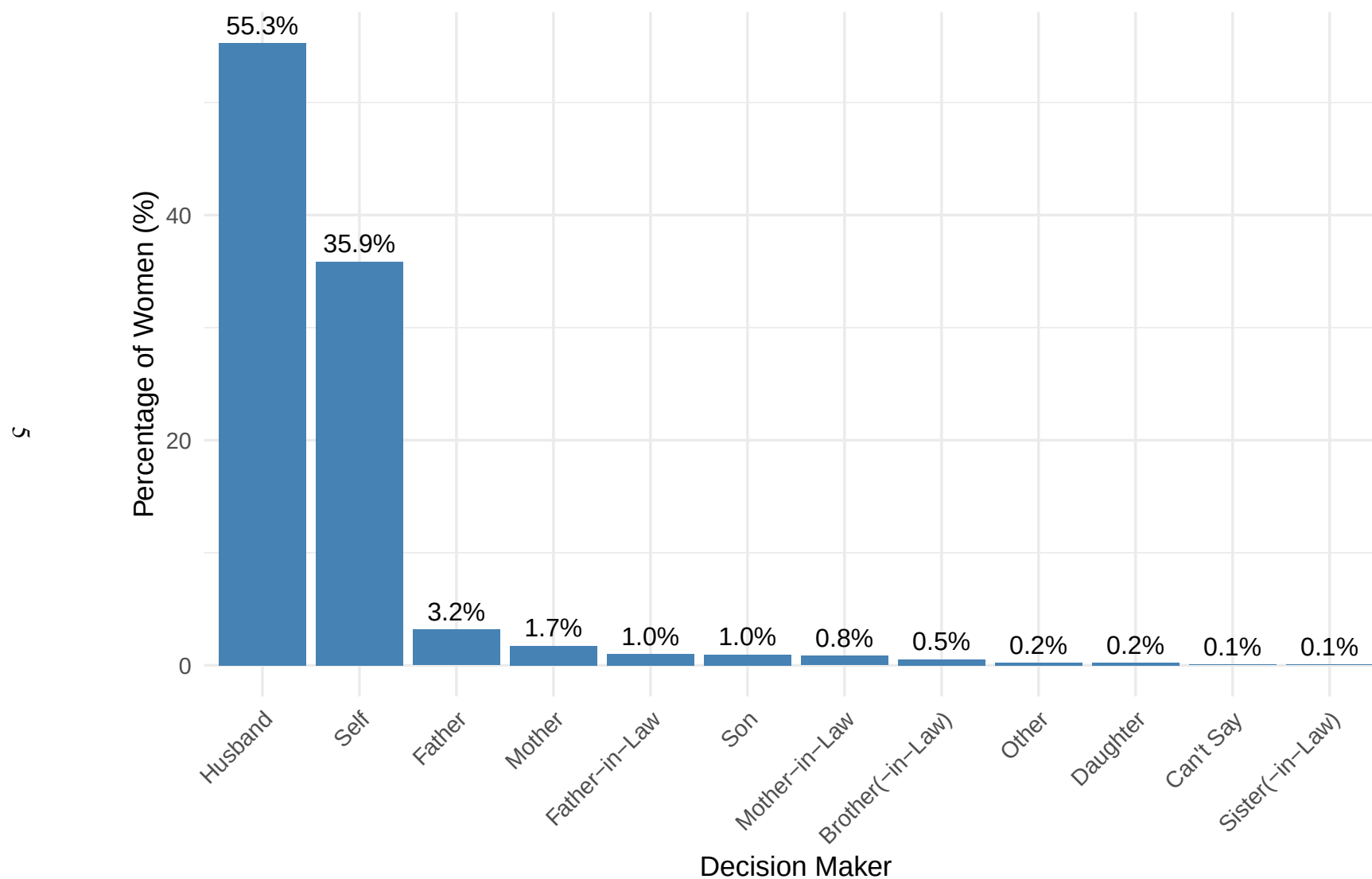
*Notes:* This figure plots the share of women between 18 and 60 years who currently work for pay. The sample excludes women in unpaid work. Data are from the Periodic Labour Force Survey (2021-2022)

Figure A2: Map of study areas



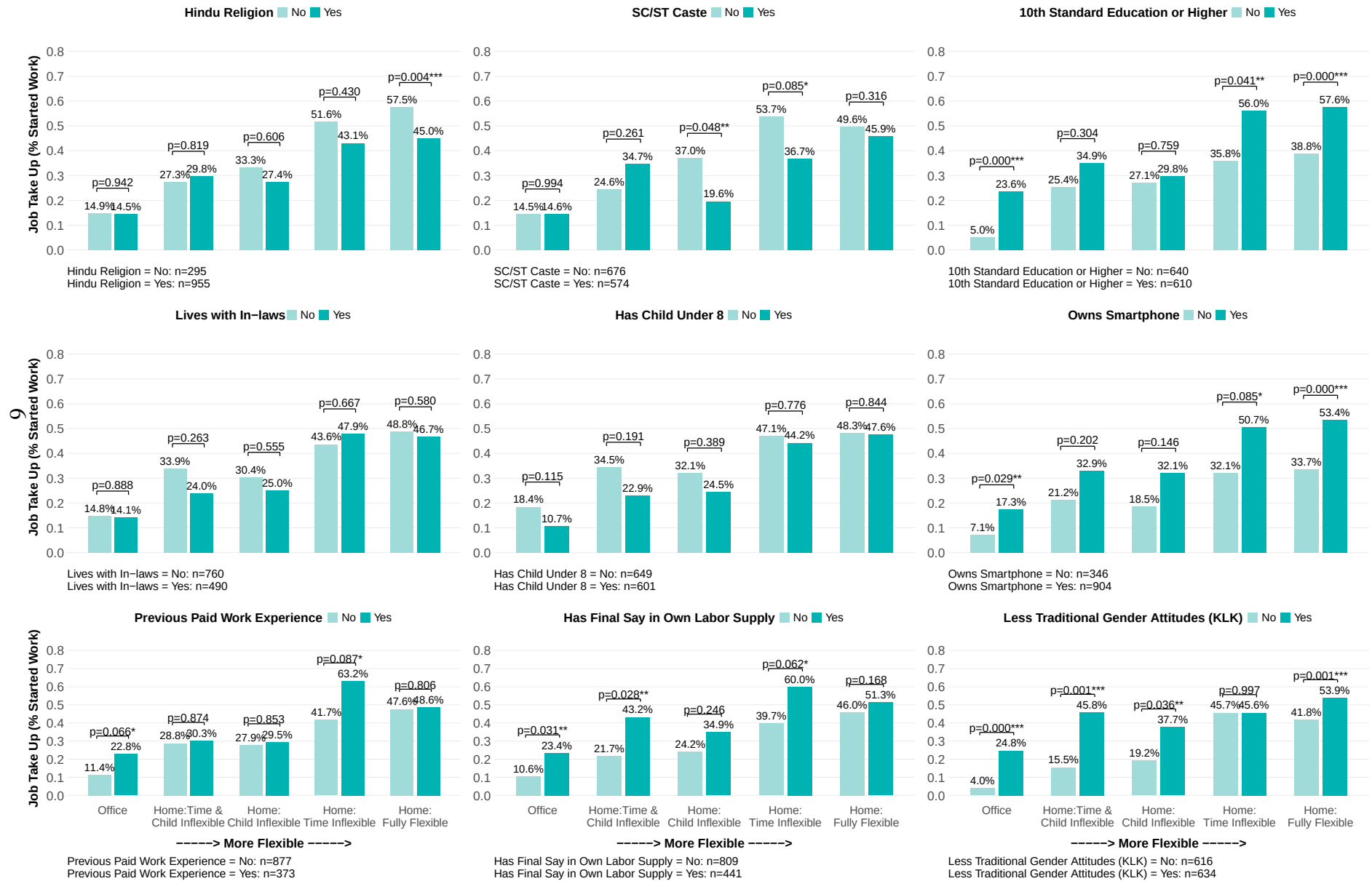
*Notes:* Figure presents locations of study areas. The red “U” bubbles indicate urban areas (Tiljala and New Alipore). The purple “P” bubbles indicate peri-urban areas (Sodepur, Atabagan, and Baruipur). The blue “R” bubbles indicate rural areas (Noorpur, Canning, and Basanti).

Figure A3: Who Has the Final Say in Women's Labor Supply Decisions?



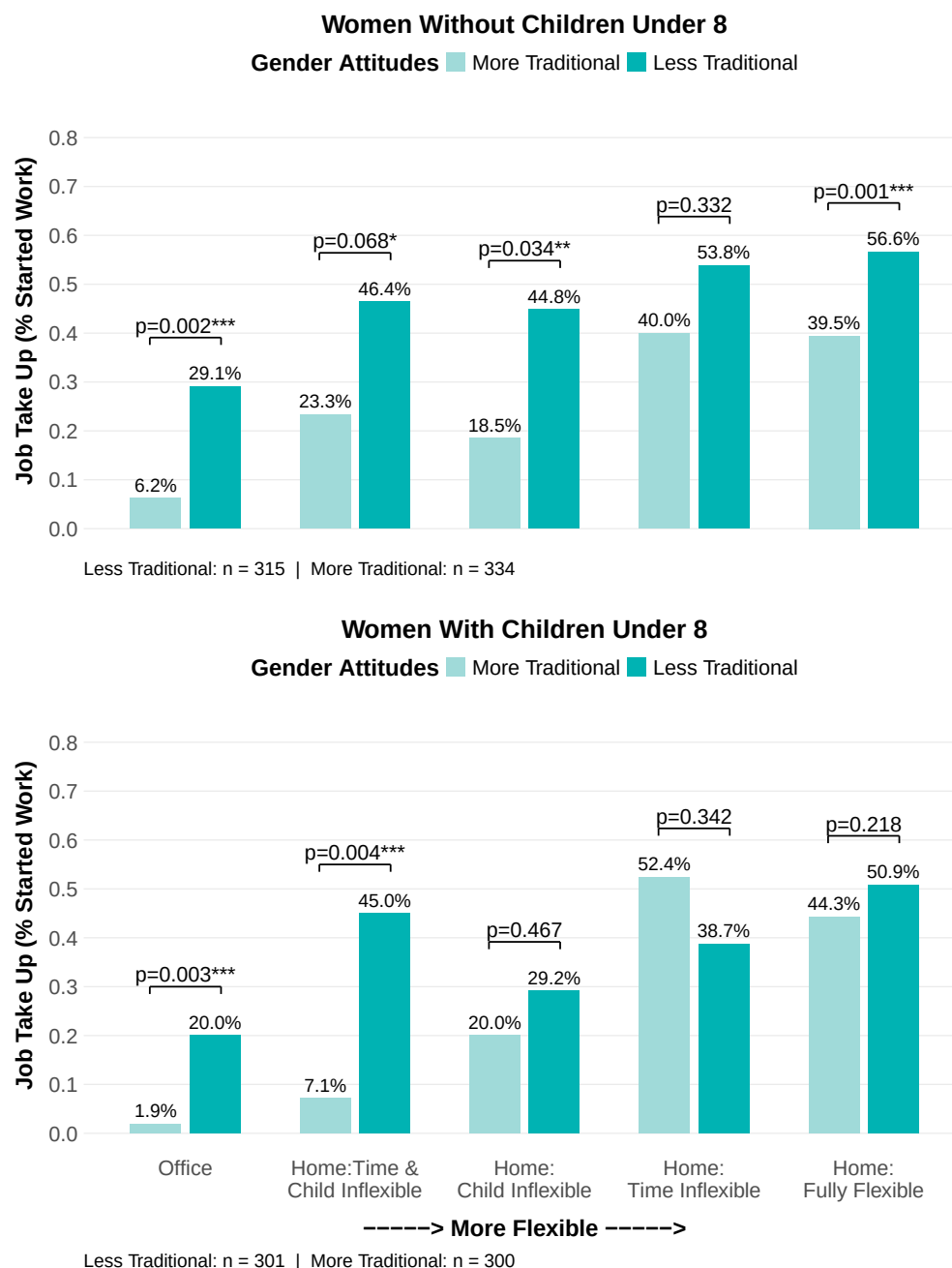
*Notes:* This figure displays the percentage distribution of responses to the question, “If you were offered a new job, who is the one person who would have the final say in whether or not you take it?” This question is asked during the baseline survey (N=1,670).

Figure A4: Heterogeneity in Job Take-up Rates by Flexibility and Respondent Characteristics



*Notes:* This figure displays job take-up rates split by nine baseline characteristics. Take-up rates reflect final job offers after randomly-assigned upgrades. Regression-based  $p$ -values are above brackets. The sample consists of the 1,250 participants assigned to a round 1 job offer. “SC/ST Caste” indicates membership in Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe groups, and “Has Final Say in Own Labor Supply” indicates women who report making final decisions about their own work. Classification by gender attitudes follows Figure 3Panel A and Appendix Section A.1.

Figure A5: Job Take-Up Rates by Flexibility Type, Gender Attitudes, and Child Status



*Notes:* This figure displays job take-up rates across work arrangements by baseline gender attitudes, separately for women without children under 8 (top panel) and women with children under 8 (bottom panel). Work arrangements are ordered by increasing flexibility from left to right. Take-up rates reflect final job offers after randomly-assigned upgrades. The sample consists of the 1,250 participants assigned to a round 1 job offer; subsample sizes are shown below each panel. The gender attitudes index is a standardized weighted average of thirteen baseline survey questions following Kling et al. (2007); respondents scoring above the median are classified as “More Traditional.” See Appendix Section A.1 for index construction details.

Figure A6: Job Task Platform App Screenshots

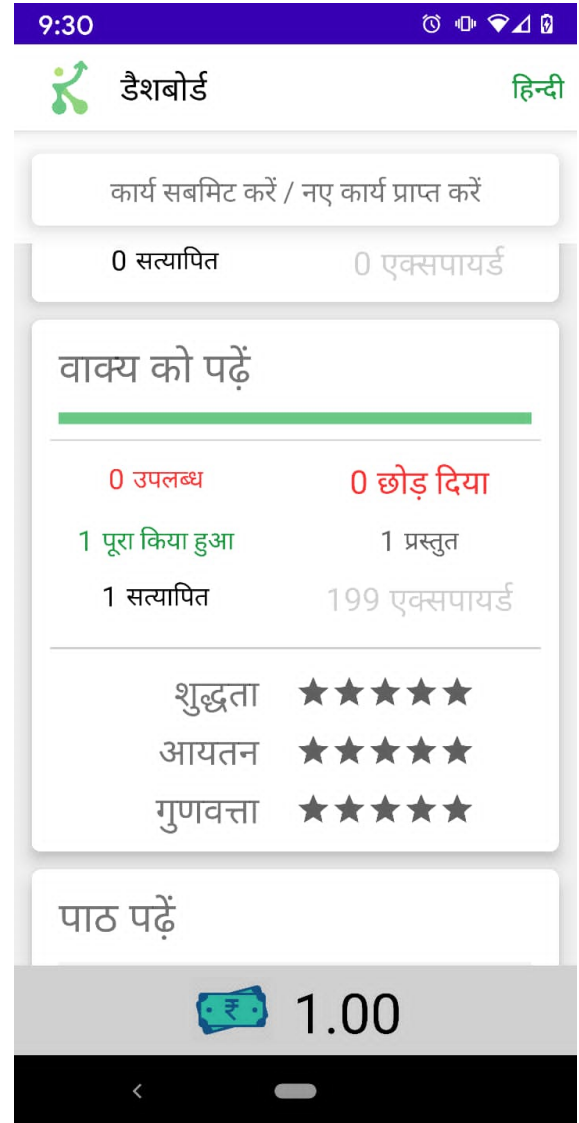
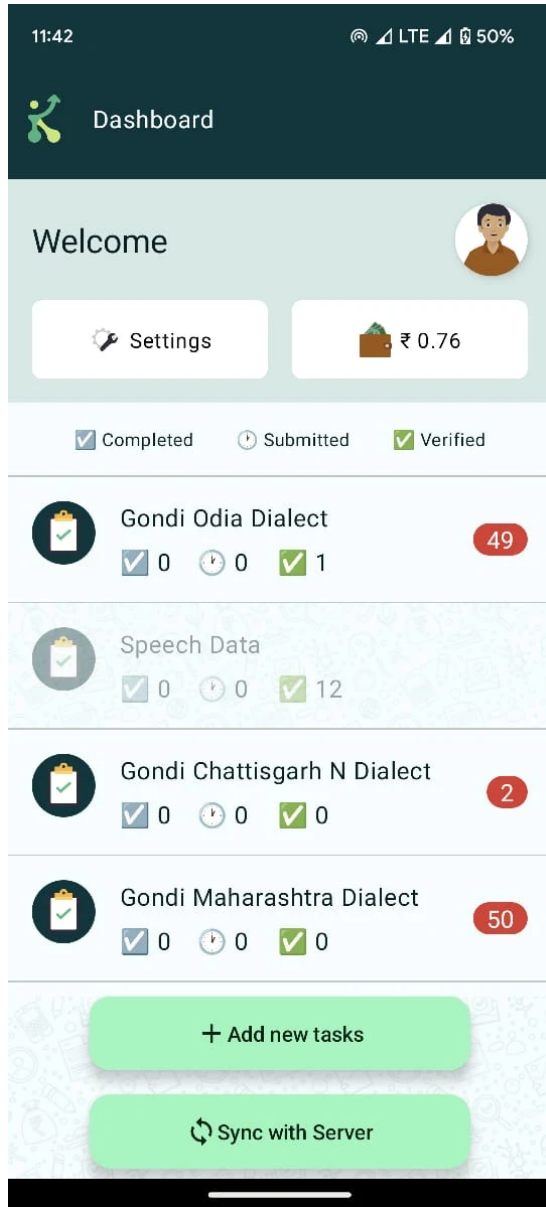
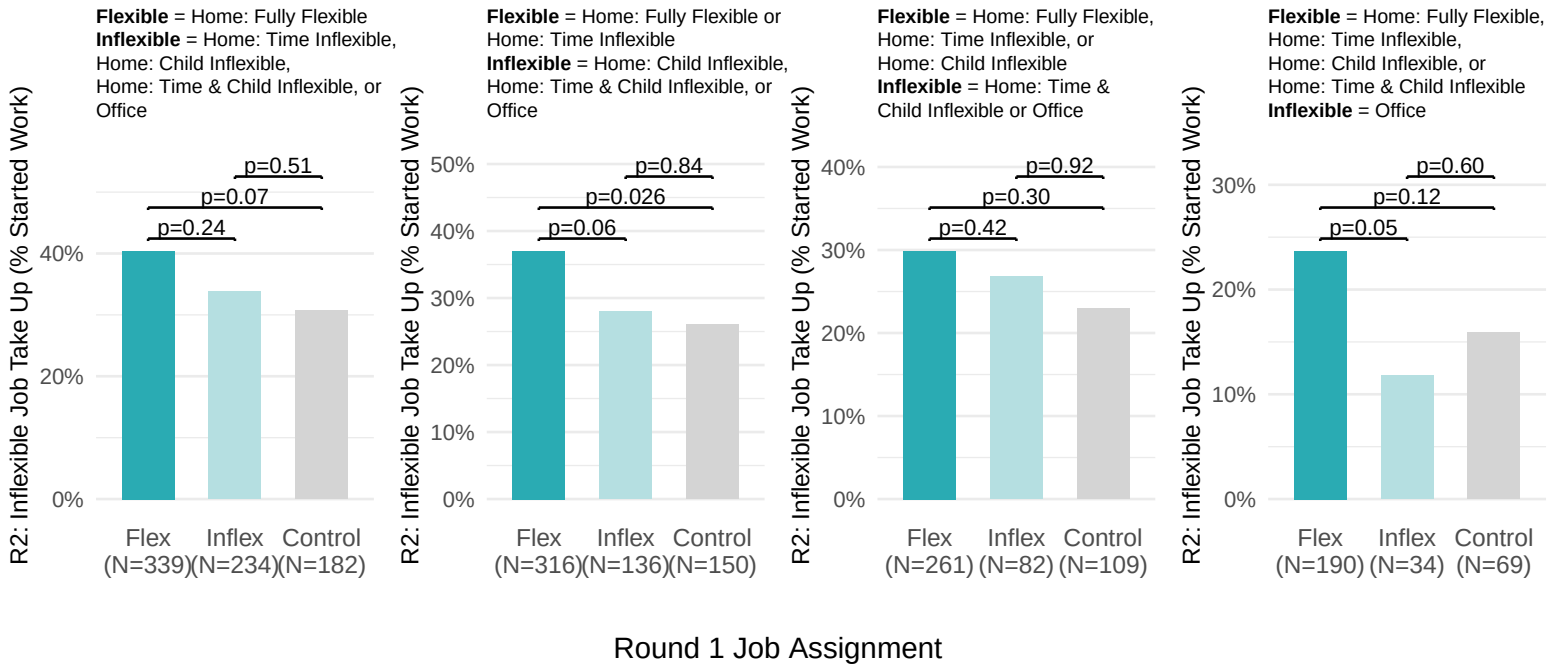
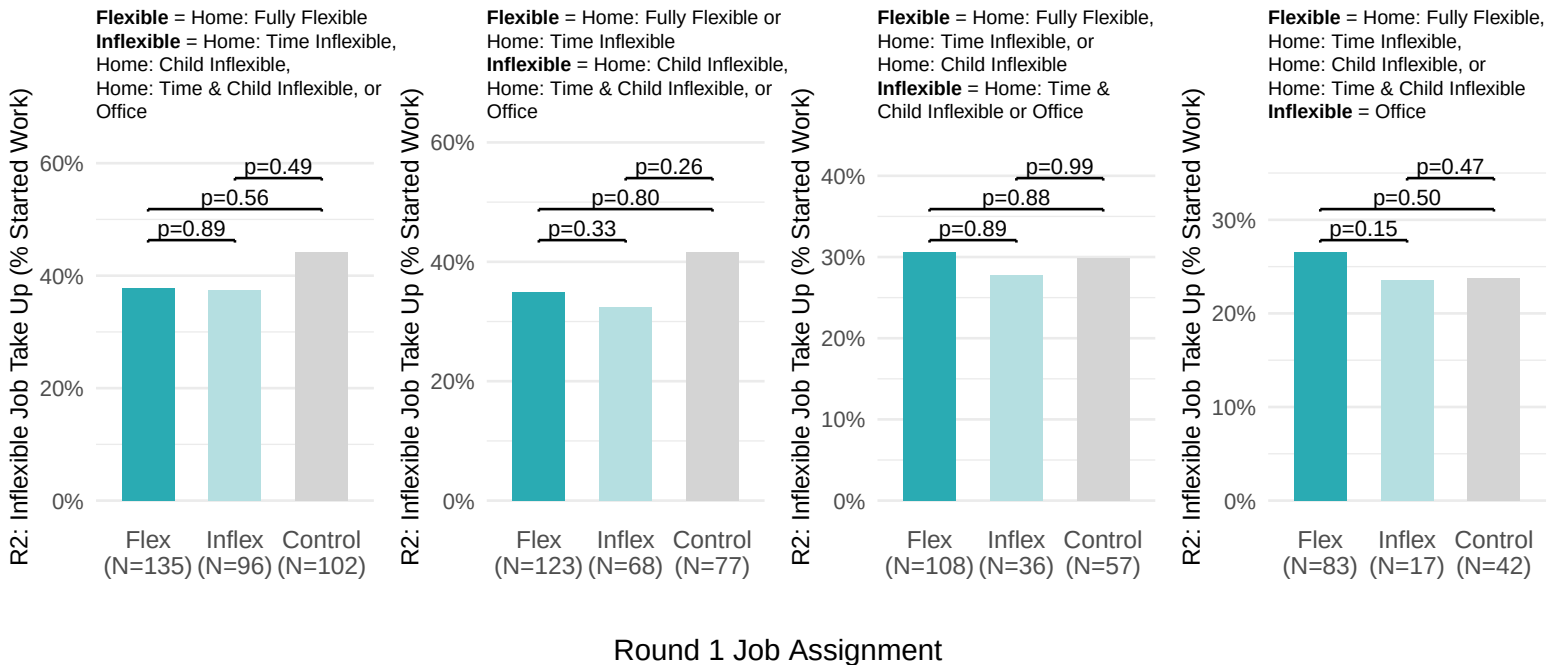


Figure A7: Take up of Flexible Round 2 Jobs By Round 1 Job Assignment

### First-Time Paid-Workers: Inflexible R2 Take-Up

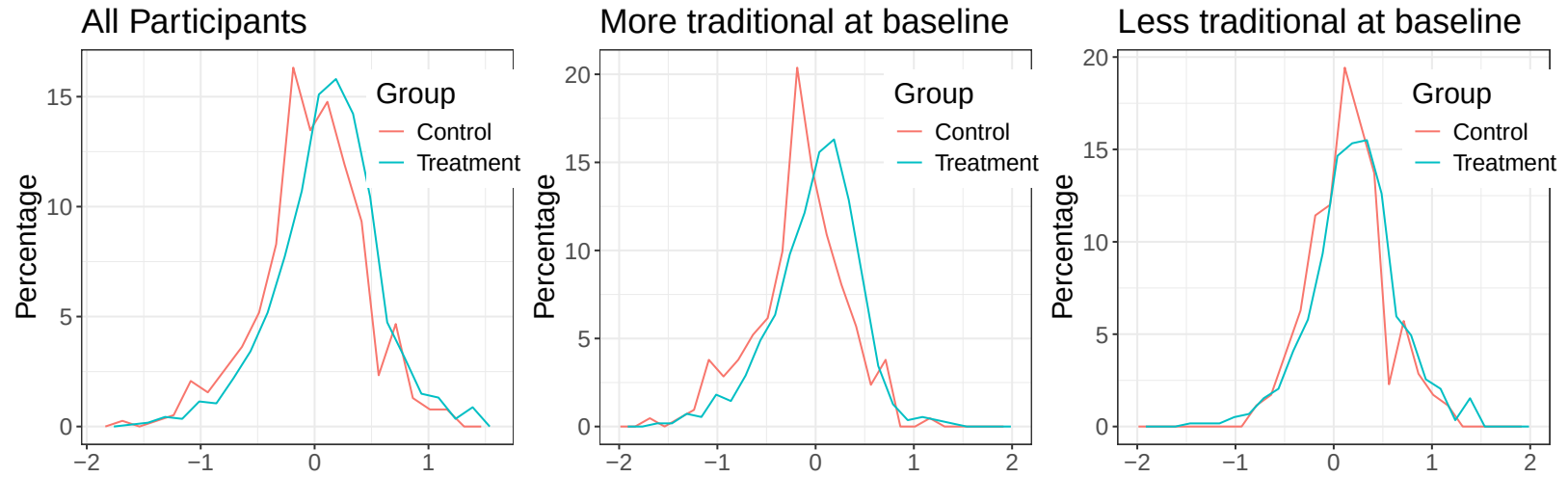


### Had Previous Work Experience: Inflexible R2 Take-Up



*Notes:* This figure shows take-up rates of flexible round 2 (R2) jobs by round 1 (R1) assignment. The sample in each sub-analysis consists of women who were randomly assigned to an flexible job in round 2, according to the same definition of flexibility as in the x-axis. Take-up is measured as the share of women who started the round 2 job randomly assigned to them. Each panel varies the threshold for classifying jobs as “Flexible” versus “Inflexible,” moving from the most restrictive definition for flexible (left panel) to the most expansive (right panel).

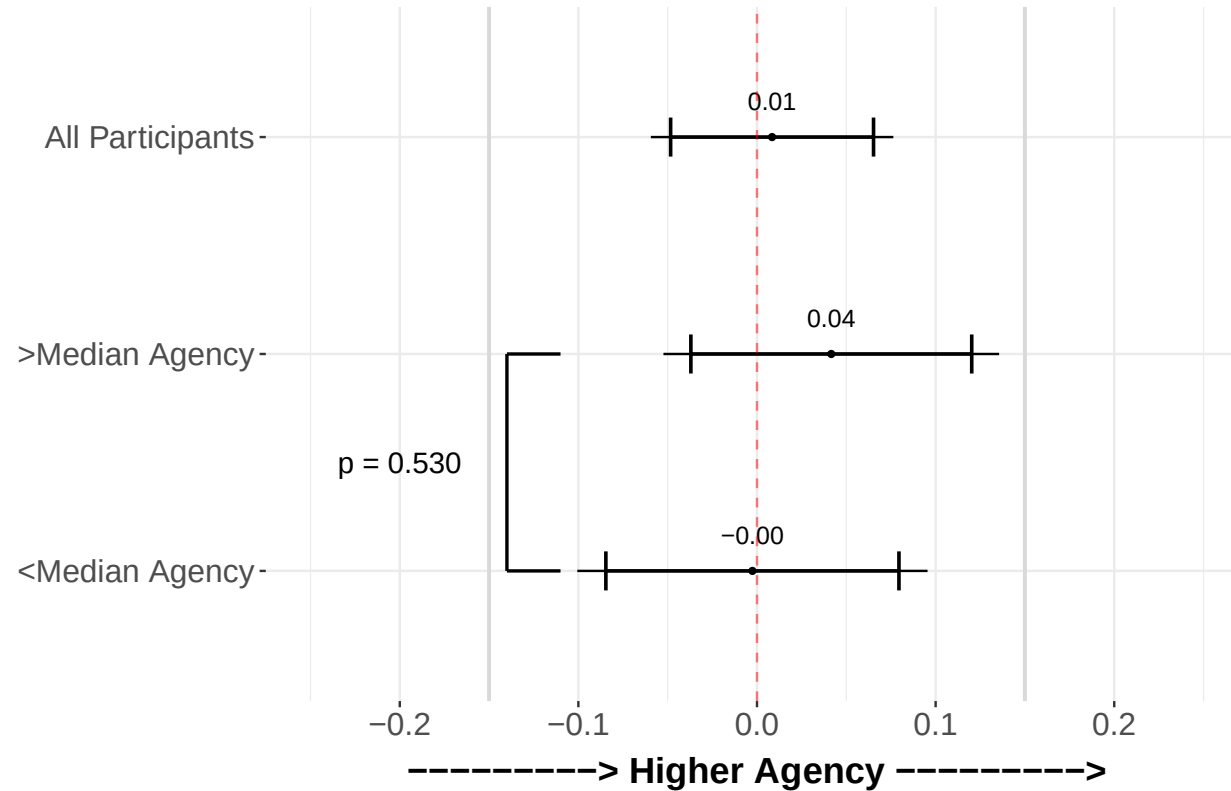
Figure A8: Gender Attitudes at Endline, Split by Baseline Attitudes (Histograms)



*Notes:* This figure plots the distribution of endline gender attitudes for treatment (teal) and control (red) participants. The left panel restricts to participants with more-than-median-traditional baseline attitudes ( $n = 763$ ); the middle panel to those with less-than-median-traditional baseline attitudes ( $n = 762$ ); the right panel includes all participants ( $N = 1,525$ ). The  $x$ -axis measures the standardized gender attitudes index, with higher values indicating less traditional attitudes. The index is standardized to have mean zero and standard deviation one in the control group. All treatment arms are pooled. Classification by baseline attitudes and index construction follow [Kling et al. \(2007\)](#); see Appendix Section A.1 for details.



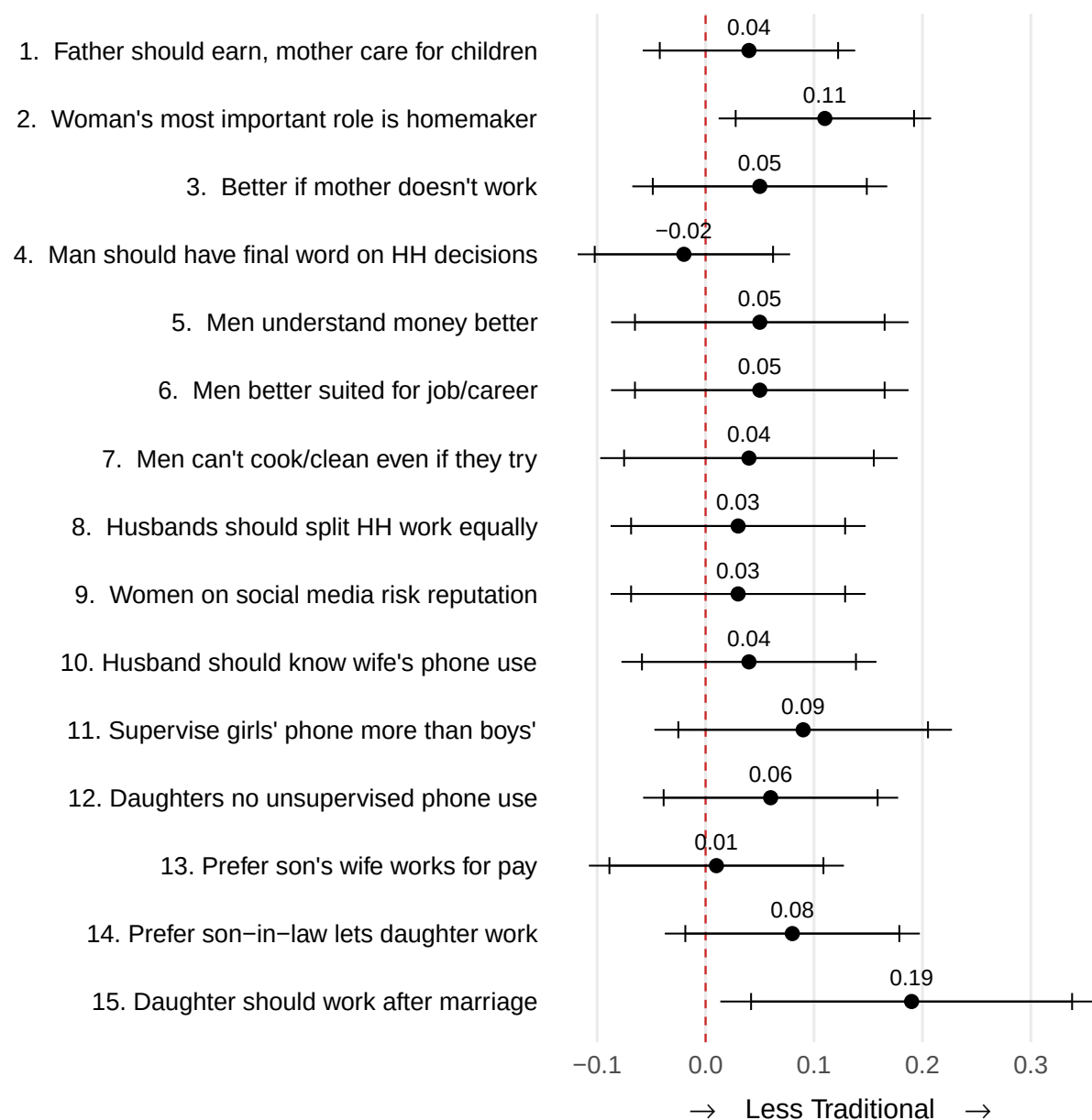
Figure A9: Treatment Effect of Jobs on Women's Agency



Notes: This figure presents treatment effects of the jobs intervention on an index of women's agency.

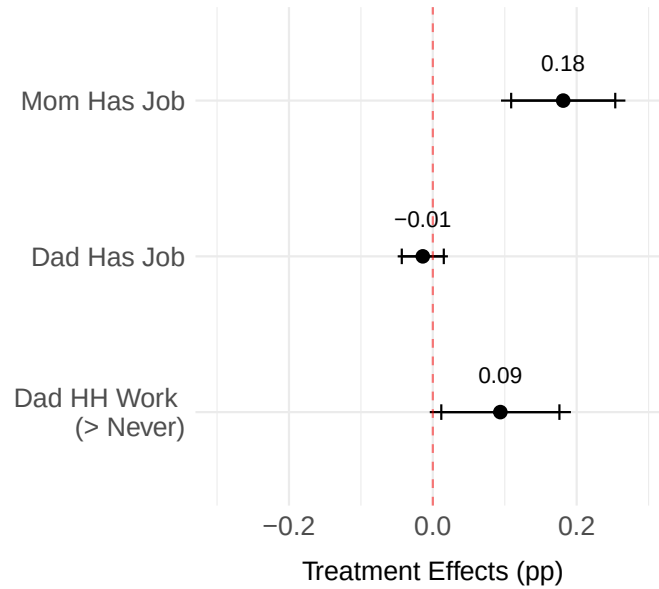
- In this analysis, all treatment groups are pooled and compared to the control group ( $N = 1,524$ ). Point estimates show the impact on the agency index for all participants (top), participants with above-median baseline agency (middle), and participants with below-median baseline agency (bottom).
- The  $x$ -axis measures the standardized effect size, with positive values indicating higher agency. The agency index is a average of standardized responses to seven questions on the endline survey (as in [Kling et al., 2007](#)). The component questions are (i) whether the participant says that she herself would have the final say in her own labor supply decisions, (ii) how often the participant leave home alone, (iii) the participant's ability to leave home without asking permission, (iv) the participant's ability to meet friends without permission, (v) to what extent the participant can purchase clothes without asking permission, (vi) to what extent she can buy items from the market without permission, and (vii) whether the participant has a say in significant household purchases.
- All regressions include lasso-selected controls and strata fixed effects. The whiskers denote 90% and 95% confidence intervals estimated using Huber-White heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors.

Figure A10: Treatment effects on individual gender attitudes index components



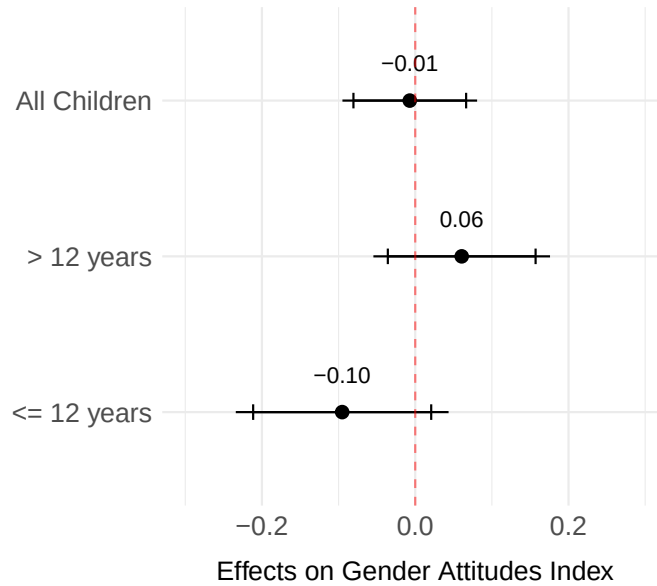
*Notes:* This figure presents ITT estimates of the job treatment on each component of the combined gender attitude index, based on randomly-assigned round 1 job assignments. Each point shows the estimated treatment effect relative to the control group (no job offer), with thin lines indicating 95% confidence intervals and perpendicular tick marks indicating 90% confidence intervals. Where relevant, signs have been flipped so that higher values always indicate more progressive attitudes. All specifications include strata fixed effects and lasso-selected controls, with Huber-White (heteroskedasticity-robust) standard errors. The analysis sample consists of all 1,525 endline survey participants. Components 5, 6, 8, and 11 have  $N = 968$ , as these questions were added to the survey midway through data collection based on qualitative debriefs with women. Component 15 has  $N = 715$ , as it was asked only of women with daughters. Slight deviations from  $N = 1,525$  in the remaining components reflect “don’t know” or “refuse to answer” responses.

Figure A11: Treatment Effects on Children's Report of Parents' Work



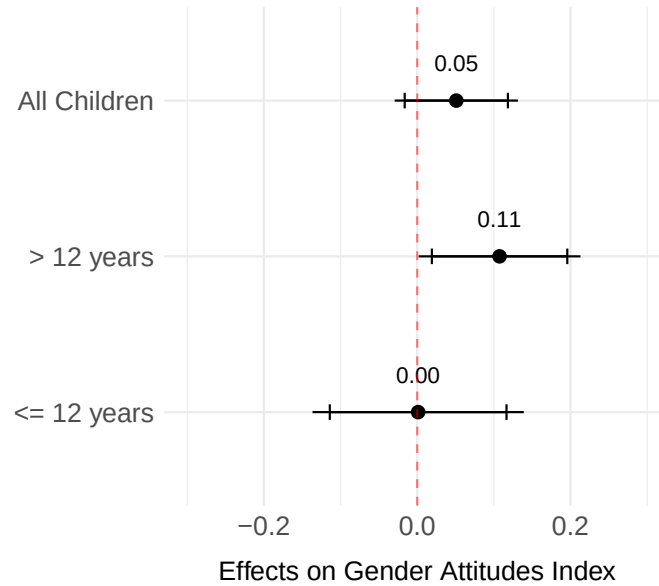
*Notes:* This figure reports treatment effects on children's reports of their parents' activities. All treatment groups are pooled and compared to the control group. Households are only included in the analysis sample if children participated in the survey at both baseline and endline ( $N = 515$ ). The figure reports effects on whether or not children say that, during the timeframe of the intervention, their mother had a job (top), their father had a job (middle), and their father helped more than never with cooking, cleaning, or laundry (bottom). All regressions include strata fixed effects and the baseline measure of the outcome variable. Standard errors are Huber-White heteroskedasticity robust. For the same results in table form, see Appendix Table A21. Estimates are plotted with corresponding 90% and 95% confidence intervals.

Figure A12: Treatment Effects on Children's Gender Attitudes (KLK)



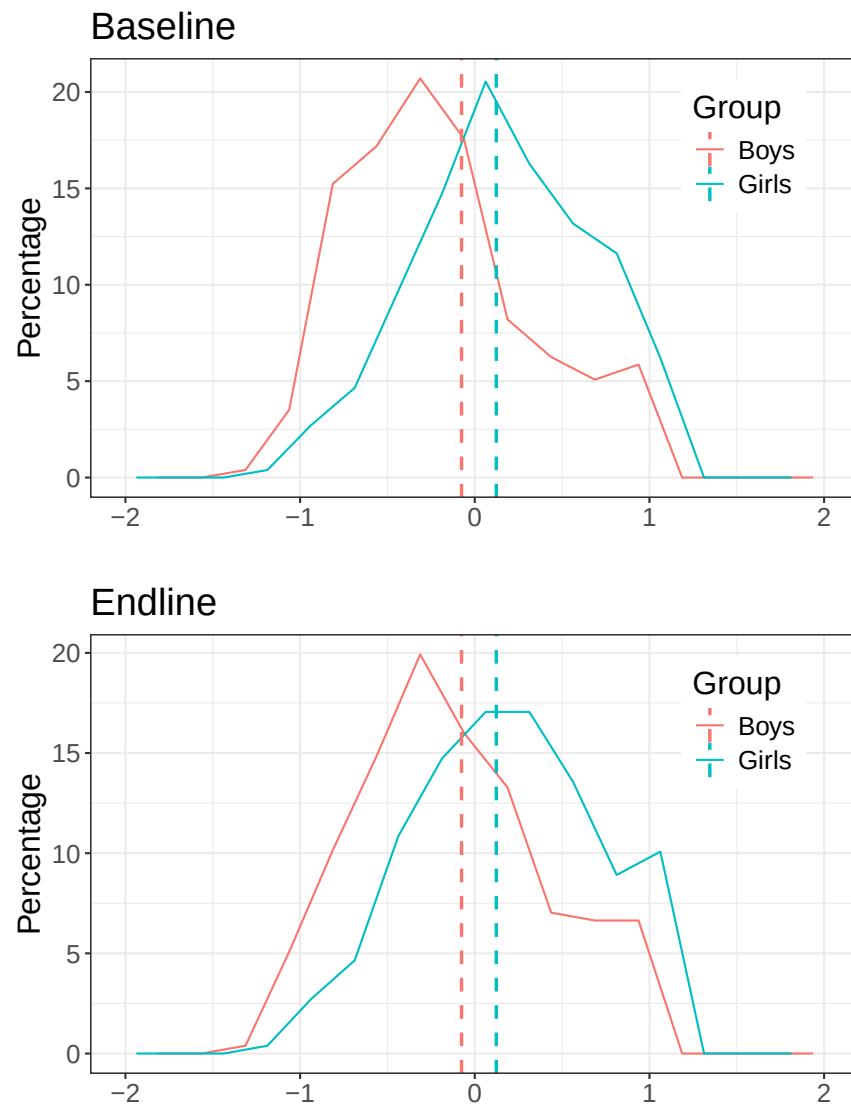
*Notes:* This figure reports treatment effects on children's gender attitudes. All treatment groups are pooled and compared to the control group. Households are only included in the analysis sample if children participated in the survey at both baseline and endline ( $N = 515$ ). The figure reports effects on children's gender attitudes for all children pooled together (top), for children older than the median age of 12 (middle), and for younger children (bottom). The gender attitudes index is computed as a simple average of standardized responses to questions from the endline survey, as in [Kling et al. \(2007\)](#). All regressions include strata fixed effects and the baseline measure of the outcome variable. Standard errors are Huber-White heteroskedasticity robust. For the same results in table form, see Appendix Table [A22](#). Estimates are plotted with corresponding 90% and 95% confidence intervals.

Figure A13: Treatment Effects on Children's Gender Attitudes (Anderson)



*Notes:* This figure reports treatment effects on children's gender attitudes. All treatment groups are pooled and compared to the control group. Households are only included in the analysis sample if children participated in the survey at both baseline and endline ( $N = 515$ ). The figure reports effects on children's gender attitudes for all children pooled together (top), for children older than the median age of 12 (middle), and for younger children (bottom). The gender attitudes index is computed as a simple average of standardized responses to questions from the endline survey, as in [Anderson \(2008\)](#). All regressions include strata fixed effects and the baseline measure of the outcome variable. Standard errors are Huber-White heteroskedasticity robust.

Figure A14: Children's Gender Attitudes: Histograms by Gender



Notes: This figure plots gender attitude index scores for boys and for girls during the baseline and endline surveys. The gender attitudes index is constructed as in [Kling et al. \(2007\)](#).

Figure A15: Treatment Effect of Office on Worksession Length (Minutes)

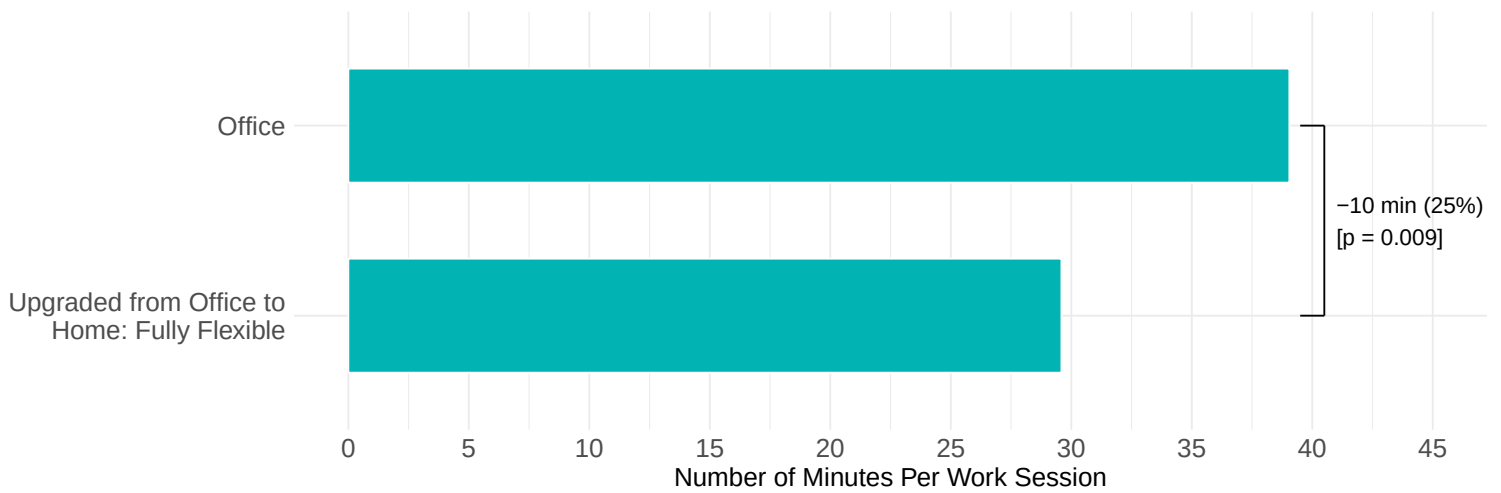


Figure A16: Task Accuracy by Session Length (Minutes)

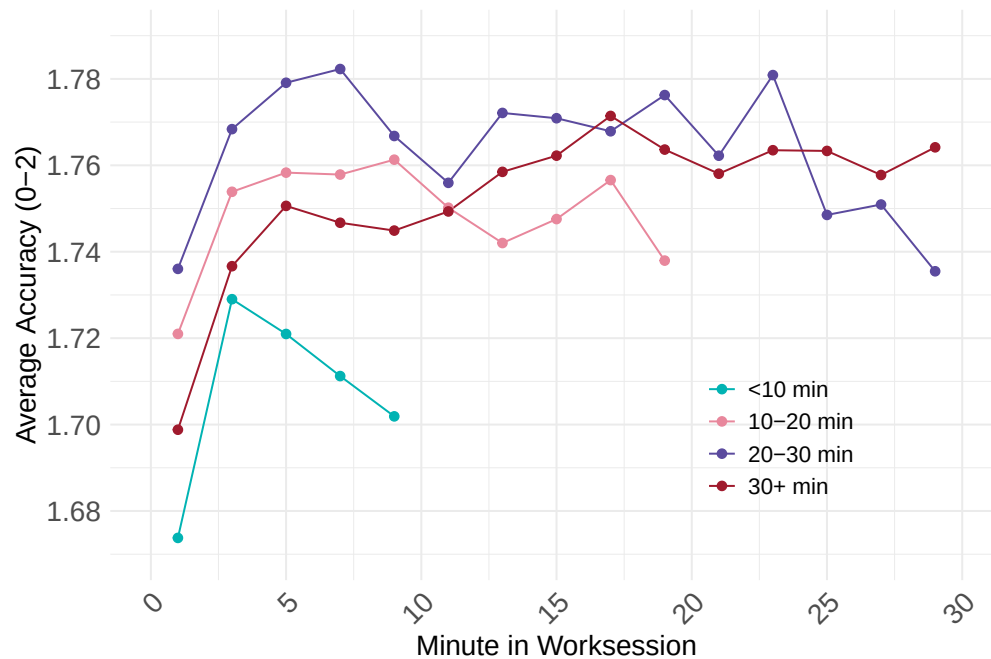
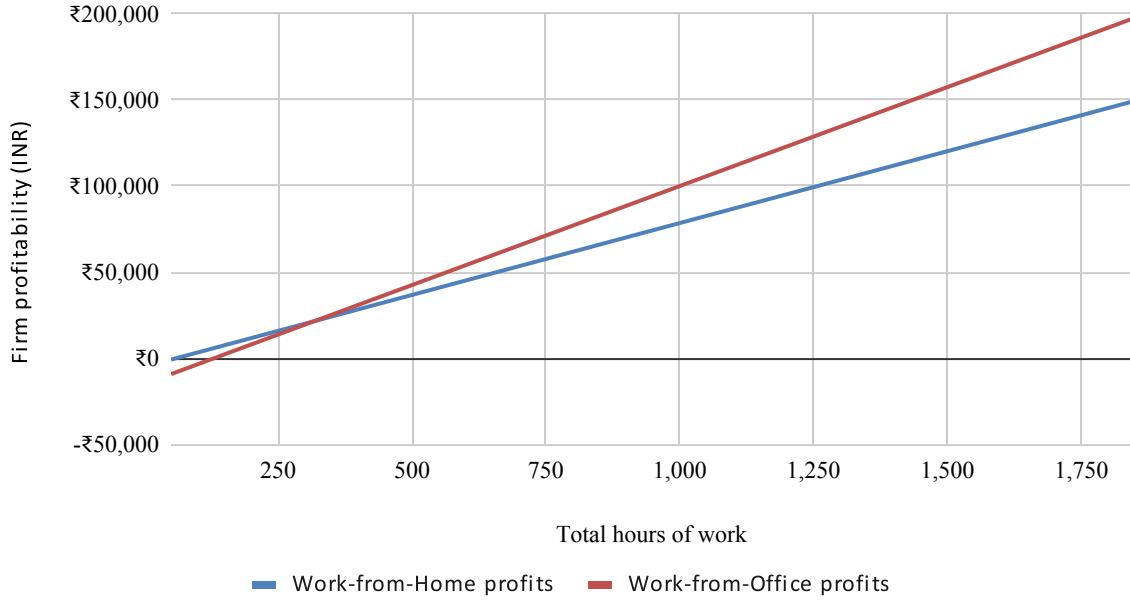


Figure A17: Home-Office Tradeoff (Firm's Perspective)

### Profitability of Work-from-Home vs Office for fixed hours



*Notes:* The figure plots firm profitability as a function of total hours of work completed, comparing work-from-home and office-based production for the same number of hours. Calculations use experimentally estimated effects of work-from-home on task accuracy and completion time and the cost assumptions listed in Table A28. Office-based work incurs fixed costs related to space, supervision, and materials, while work-from-home avoids these costs but has lower productivity and additional monitoring and coordination costs. The figure illustrates unit economics conditional on a given volume of work (hours) and does not incorporate differences in labor supply across work arrangements. As shown in Table A29, work-from-home substantially increases take-up, which can raise total output and profitability even when per-hour productivity is lower.





## Appendix Tables

Table A1: Characteristics of Study Participants: Initial Job Offer Groups

|                                               | Round 1 Work Arrangement (Initial) |                                 |                                 |                                 |                                 |                                 | p-value |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|---------|
|                                               | Control                            | Home: Fully Flexible            | Home: Child Inflexible          | Home: Child Inflexible          | Home: Time and Child Inflexible | Office                          |         |
| Age (Years)                                   | 29.76<br>(7.94)                    | 29.26 [-0.46]<br>(7.72) [0.420] | 28.88 [-0.96]<br>(8.36) [0.125] | 30.01 [0.38]<br>(7.90) [0.544]  | 30.62 [0.61]<br>(8.61) [0.316]  | 30.50 [0.86]<br>(8.33) [0.087*] | 0.592   |
| Educated to 10th Standard                     | 0.51<br>(0.50)                     | 0.49 [-0.02]<br>(0.50) [0.611]  | 0.52 [0.02]<br>(0.50) [0.555]   | 0.50 [-0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.853]  | 0.43 [-0.07]<br>(0.50) [0.102]  | 0.50 [-0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.849]  | 0.617   |
| Native Language = Bangla                      | 0.89<br>(0.31)                     | 0.91 [0.02]<br>(0.29) [0.261]   | 0.91 [0.02]<br>(0.29) [0.361]   | 0.89 [-0.01]<br>(0.32) [0.702]  | 0.91 [0.02]<br>(0.28) [0.137]   | 0.89 [-0.00]<br>(0.31) [0.753]  | 0.542   |
| Scheduled Caste/Scheduled Tribe               | 0.38<br>(0.49)                     | 0.36 [-0.02]<br>(0.48) [0.547]  | 0.38 [-0.02]<br>(0.49) [0.609]  | 0.42 [0.04]<br>(0.49) [0.330]   | 0.39 [0.01]<br>(0.49) [0.845]   | 0.39 [0.00]<br>(0.49) [0.959]   | 0.968   |
| Other Backward Caste                          | 0.10<br>(0.30)                     | 0.11 [0.01]<br>(0.31) [0.568]   | 0.09 [-0.01]<br>(0.28) [0.793]  | 0.05 [-0.04]<br>(0.22) [0.059*] | 0.11 [0.01]<br>(0.31) [0.622]   | 0.11 [0.01]<br>(0.31) [0.503]   | 0.936   |
| Religion = Hindu                              | 0.72<br>(0.45)                     | 0.78 [0.05]<br>(0.41) [0.035**] | 0.74 [-0.00]<br>(0.44) [0.905]  | 0.78 [0.05]<br>(0.42) [0.075*]  | 0.78 [0.04]<br>(0.42) [0.092*]  | 0.76 [0.02]<br>(0.43) [0.312]   | 0.094*  |
| Rural Location                                | 0.48<br>(0.50)                     | 0.48 [-0.00]<br>(0.50) [0.785]  | 0.48 [-0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.397]  | 0.48 [-0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.553]  | 0.48 [-0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.754]  | 0.48 [-0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.577]  | 0.469   |
| Married or Previously Married                 | 0.94<br>(0.24)                     | 0.92 [-0.02]<br>(0.27) [0.306]  | 0.91 [-0.03]<br>(0.28) [0.121]  | 0.92 [-0.02]<br>(0.27) [0.396]  | 0.95 [0.01]<br>(0.21) [0.610]   | 0.93 [-0.01]<br>(0.26) [0.529]  | 0.298   |
| Lives with In-Laws                            | 0.43<br>(0.50)                     | 0.37 [-0.06]<br>(0.48) [0.117]  | 0.40 [-0.03]<br>(0.49) [0.405]  | 0.36 [-0.07]<br>(0.48) [0.068*] | 0.44 [0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.791]   | 0.39 [-0.05]<br>(0.49) [0.156]  | 0.119   |
| Has Children under 8                          | 0.47<br>(0.50)                     | 0.49 [0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.155]   | 0.48 [0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.260]   | 0.47 [-0.00]<br>(0.50) [0.763]  | 0.47 [0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.557]   | 0.49 [0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.158]   | 0.185   |
| Individual (Not Shared) Smartphone            | 0.73<br>(0.44)                     | 0.74 [0.00]<br>(0.44) [0.443]   | 0.72 [0.01]<br>(0.45) [0.037**] | 0.74 [0.01]<br>(0.44) [0.046**] | 0.70 [0.01]<br>(0.46) [0.376]   | 0.72 [-0.00]<br>(0.45) [0.701]  | 0.366   |
| Labor Supply Final Say = Self                 | 0.38<br>(0.49)                     | 0.36 [-0.02]<br>(0.48) [0.648]  | 0.35 [-0.03]<br>(0.48) [0.498]  | 0.33 [-0.04]<br>(0.47) [0.290]  | 0.38 [0.01]<br>(0.49) [0.900]   | 0.35 [-0.03]<br>(0.48) [0.380]  | 0.382   |
| Gender Attitudes Index                        | -0.00<br>(0.41)                    | 0.05 [0.05]<br>(0.42) [0.170]   | 0.06 [0.06]<br>(0.44) [0.089*]  | 0.05 [0.05]<br>(0.47) [0.167]   | -0.04 [-0.04]<br>(0.46) [0.320] | 0.01 [0.01]<br>(0.43) [0.818]   | 0.329   |
| F-test of joint significance (with strata FE) |                                    | F=0.61, p=0.966                 | F=0.68, p=0.929                 | F=0.55, p=0.987                 | F=0.53, p=0.991                 | F=0.50, p=0.994                 |         |
| Number of observations                        | 420                                | 208                             | 208                             | 209                             | 211                             | 414                             |         |

*Notes:* This table presents baseline characteristics of study participants randomized across treatment conditions. Participants are grouped according to their initial job offer (before randomly-selected upgrades were implemented). Each cell in the treatment columns reports the mean of the characteristic, with standard deviations in parentheses below. Sample sizes for each cell are reported in parentheses next to the means. The numbers in square brackets next to the group means represent coefficients from regressions of each characteristic on treatment indicators (with Control as the omitted category), controlling for strata fixed effects.  $p$ -values for these coefficients appear in square brackets below the coefficients. The final column reports  $p$ -values from tests comparing the Control group to all job groups pooled together. The bottom row presents F-statistics with their corresponding  $p$ -values. Statistical significance is denoted by: \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*  $p < 0.10$ . Binary indicators (Bangla as native language, SC/ST, Hindu, rural, married/previously married, lives with in-laws, has children under 8, and smartphone ownership) take values of 0 or 1.

Table A2: Characteristics of Study Participants: Final Job Offer Groups

|                                               | Round 1 Work Arrangement (Final) |                                 |                                 |                                 |                                  |                                  | p-value |
|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|---------|
|                                               | Control                          | Home: Fully Flexible            | Home: Time Inflexible           | Home: Child Inflexible          | Home: Time and Child Inflexible  | Office                           |         |
| Age (Years)                                   | 29.76<br>(7.94)                  | 29.72 [-0.04]<br>(8.11) [0.918] | 28.87 [-0.80]<br>(8.33) [0.331] | 30.63 [1.06]<br>(8.66) [0.230]  | 30.78 [0.71]<br>(8.74) [0.367]   | 30.60 [0.96]<br>(8.07) [0.118]   | 0.592   |
| Educated to 10th Standard                     | 0.51<br>(0.50)                   | 0.48 [-0.02]<br>(0.50) [0.555]  | 0.49 [-0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.825]  | 0.54 [0.04]<br>(0.50) [0.467]   | 0.41 [-0.08]<br>(0.49) [0.098*]  | 0.51 [0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.849]    | 0.617   |
| Native Language = Bangla                      | 0.89<br>(0.31)                   | 0.90 [0.01]<br>(0.30) [0.596]   | 0.94 [0.05]<br>(0.24) [0.027**] | 0.88 [-0.01]<br>(0.33) [0.510]  | 0.89 [-0.00]<br>(0.32) [0.785]   | 0.90 [0.01]<br>(0.30) [0.758]    | 0.542   |
| Scheduled Caste/Scheduled Tribe               | 0.38<br>(0.49)                   | 0.38 [-0.00]<br>(0.49) [0.878]  | 0.41 [0.02]<br>(0.49) [0.726]   | 0.44 [0.05]<br>(0.50) [0.307]   | 0.41 [0.02]<br>(0.49) [0.609]    | 0.36 [-0.02]<br>(0.48) [0.498]   | 0.968   |
| Other Backward Caste                          | 0.10<br>(0.30)                   | 0.09 [-0.01]<br>(0.28) [0.687]  | 0.08 [-0.02]<br>(0.27) [0.607]  | 0.05 [-0.04]<br>(0.21) [0.090*] | 0.14 [0.04]<br>(0.35) [0.222]    | 0.14 [0.04]<br>(0.34) [0.144]    | 0.936   |
| Religion = Hindu                              | 0.72<br>(0.45)                   | 0.76 [0.03]<br>(0.43) [0.135]   | 0.70 [-0.04]<br>(0.46) [0.322]  | 0.80 [0.07]<br>(0.40) [0.033**] | 0.79 [0.06]<br>(0.41) [0.062*]   | 0.77 [0.04]<br>(0.42) [0.166]    | 0.094*  |
| Rural Location                                | 0.48<br>(0.50)                   | 0.48 [-0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.516]  | 0.49 [-0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.730]  | 0.48 [-0.02]<br>(0.50) [0.382]  | 0.47 [-0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.887]   | 0.49 [-0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.696]   | 0.469   |
| Married or Previously Married                 | 0.94<br>(0.24)                   | 0.92 [-0.02]<br>(0.27) [0.181]  | 0.95 [0.01]<br>(0.22) [0.697]   | 0.92 [-0.02]<br>(0.27) [0.447]  | 0.95 [0.01]<br>(0.21) [0.590]    | 0.93 [-0.01]<br>(0.26) [0.518]   | 0.298   |
| Lives with In-Laws                            | 0.43<br>(0.50)                   | 0.39 [-0.04]<br>(0.49) [0.145]  | 0.47 [0.03]<br>(0.50) [0.588]   | 0.34 [-0.10]<br>(0.48) [0.057*] | 0.47 [0.04]<br>(0.50) [0.421]    | 0.34 [-0.09]<br>(0.48) [0.025**] | 0.119   |
| Has Children under 8                          | 0.47<br>(0.50)                   | 0.48 [0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.150]   | 0.50 [0.02]<br>(0.50) [0.072*]  | 0.47 [-0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.222]  | 0.45 [-0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.553]   | 0.50 [0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.156]    | 0.185   |
| Individual (Not Shared) Smartphone            | 0.73<br>(0.44)                   | 0.72 [0.00]<br>(0.45) [0.591]   | 0.73 [0.01]<br>(0.45) [0.050**] | 0.74 [0.01]<br>(0.44) [0.071*]  | 0.69 [0.00]<br>(0.47) [0.865]    | 0.73 [0.00]<br>(0.45) [0.444]    | 0.366   |
| Labor Supply Final Say = Self                 | 0.38<br>(0.49)                   | 0.37 [-0.01]<br>(0.48) [0.717]  | 0.29 [-0.09]<br>(0.46) [0.080*] | 0.41 [0.03]<br>(0.49) [0.565]   | 0.35 [-0.03]<br>(0.48) [0.610]   | 0.31 [-0.06]<br>(0.46) [0.099*]  | 0.382   |
| Gender Attitudes Index                        | -0.00<br>(0.41)                  | 0.04 [0.04]<br>(0.43) [0.114]   | 0.04 [0.04]<br>(0.46) [0.394]   | 0.00 [0.00]<br>(0.48) [0.965]   | -0.09 [-0.09]<br>(0.49) [0.070*] | 0.02 [0.02]<br>(0.42) [0.567]    | 0.329   |
| F-test of joint significance (with strata FE) |                                  | F=0.52, p=0.992                 | F=0.63, p=0.957                 | F=0.63, p=0.958                 | F=0.62, p=0.962                  | F=0.79, p=0.807                  |         |
| Number of observations                        | 420                              | 730                             | 103                             | 105                             | 106                              | 206                              |         |

*Notes:* This table presents baseline characteristics of study participants randomized across treatment conditions. Participants are grouped according to their final job offer (after randomly-selected upgrades were implemented). Each cell in the treatment columns reports the mean of the characteristic, with standard deviations in parentheses below. Sample sizes for each cell are reported in parentheses next to the means. The numbers in square brackets next to the group means represent coefficients from regressions of each characteristic on treatment indicators (with Control as the omitted category), controlling for strata fixed effects. *p*-values for these coefficients appear in square brackets below the coefficients. The final column reports *p*-values from tests comparing the Control group to all job groups pooled together. The bottom row presents F-statistics with their corresponding *p*-values. Statistical significance is denoted by: \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*  $p < 0.10$ . Binary indicators (Bangla as native language, SC/ST, Hindu, rural, married/previously married, lives with in-laws, has children under 8, and smartphone ownership) take values of 0 or 1.

Table A3: Characteristics of Study Participants: Gateway Job Groups

|                                               | Round 1 Work Arrangement (Final) |                                 |                                  | p-value |
|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------|----------------------------------|---------|
|                                               | Control                          | Gateway Job Sequence            | Other Job Sequence               |         |
| Age (Years)                                   | 29.64<br>(7.81)                  | 29.93 [0.30]<br>(7.96) [0.518]  | 30.22 [0.72]<br>(8.38) [0.126]   | 0.232   |
| Educated to 10th Standard                     | 0.53<br>(0.50)                   | 0.48 [-0.04]<br>(0.50) [0.245]  | 0.49 [-0.03]<br>(0.50) [0.333]   | 0.230   |
| Native Language = Bangla                      | 0.90<br>(0.30)                   | 0.92 [0.02]<br>(0.28) [0.047**] | 0.90 [0.01]<br>(0.30) [0.629]    | 0.153   |
| Scheduled Caste/Scheduled Tribe               | 0.39<br>(0.49)                   | 0.41 [0.01]<br>(0.49) [0.649]   | 0.38 [-0.01]<br>(0.49) [0.596]   | 0.995   |
| Other Backward Caste                          | 0.10<br>(0.30)                   | 0.09 [-0.00]<br>(0.29) [0.793]  | 0.10 [0.01]<br>(0.31) [0.674]    | 0.946   |
| Religion = Hindu                              | 0.74<br>(0.44)                   | 0.77 [0.04]<br>(0.42) [0.106]   | 0.77 [0.04]<br>(0.42) [0.085*]   | 0.064*  |
| Rural Location                                | 0.50<br>(0.50)                   | 0.50 [-0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.630]  | 0.49 [-0.02]<br>(0.50) [0.259]   | 0.381   |
| Married or Previously Married                 | 0.94<br>(0.24)                   | 0.94 [0.00]<br>(0.23) [0.809]   | 0.91 [-0.03]<br>(0.28) [0.046**] | 0.332   |
| Lives with In-Laws                            | 0.44<br>(0.50)                   | 0.40 [-0.03]<br>(0.49) [0.276]  | 0.38 [-0.06]<br>(0.49) [0.058*]  | 0.098*  |
| Has Children under 8                          | 0.47<br>(0.50)                   | 0.48 [0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.166]   | 0.50 [0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.401]    | 0.204   |
| Individual (Not Shared) Smartphone            | 0.73<br>(0.44)                   | 0.72 [-0.00]<br>(0.45) [0.982]  | 0.72 [0.00]<br>(0.45) [0.337]    | 0.642   |
| Labor Supply Final Say = Self                 | 0.37<br>(0.48)                   | 0.39 [0.02]<br>(0.49) [0.565]   | 0.33 [-0.04]<br>(0.47) [0.179]   | 0.729   |
| Gender Attitudes Index                        | -0.00<br>(0.39)                  | 0.03 [0.03]<br>(0.43) [0.248]   | 0.02 [0.02]<br>(0.45) [0.414]    | 0.271   |
| F-test of joint significance (with strata FE) |                                  | F=0.64, p=0.957                 | F=0.94, p=0.580                  |         |
| Number of observations                        | 386                              | 602                             | 536                              |         |

*Notes:* This table presents baseline characteristics of study participants randomized across treatment conditions (to either a gateway job sequence, a non-gateway job sequence, or the control group). Each cell in the treatment columns reports the mean of the characteristic, with standard deviations in parentheses below. Sample sizes for each cell are reported in parentheses next to the means. The numbers in square brackets next to the group means represent coefficients from regressions of each characteristic on treatment indicators (with Control as the omitted category), controlling for strata fixed effects.  $p$ -values for these coefficients appear in square brackets below the coefficients. The final column reports  $p$ -values from tests comparing the Control group to all job groups pooled together. The bottom row presents F-statistics with their corresponding  $p$ -values. Statistical significance is denoted by: \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*  $p < 0.10$ . Binary indicators (Bangla as native language, SC/ST, Hindu, rural, married/previously married, lives with in-laws, has children under 8, and smartphone ownership) take values of 0 or 1.

Table A4: Characteristics of Endline Survey Respondents

|                                               | Round 1 Work Arrangement (Final) |                                |                                  |                                  |                                  |                                  | p-value |
|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|---------|
|                                               | Control                          | Home: Fully Flexible           | Home: Time Inflexible            | Home: Child Inflexible           | Home: Time and Child Inflexible  | Office                           |         |
| Age (Years)                                   | 29.64<br>(7.81)                  | 29.78 [0.18]<br>(7.95) [0.679] | 29.36 [-0.34]<br>(7.96) [0.677]  | 30.82 [1.43]<br>(8.71) [0.135]   | 30.95 [1.27]<br>(8.99) [0.124]   | 30.62 [1.18]<br>(8.23) [0.066*]  | 0.232   |
| Educated to 10th Standard                     | 0.53<br>(0.50)                   | 0.48 [-0.04]<br>(0.50) [0.208] | 0.49 [-0.02]<br>(0.50) [0.745]   | 0.53 [0.00]<br>(0.50) [0.965]    | 0.40 [-0.12]<br>(0.49) [0.023**] | 0.52 [-0.00]<br>(0.50) [0.934]   | 0.230   |
| Native Language = Bangla                      | 0.90<br>(0.30)                   | 0.90 [0.02]<br>(0.29) [0.182]  | 0.95 [0.06]<br>(0.22) [0.005***] | 0.91 [0.00]<br>(0.28) [0.860]    | 0.90 [0.01]<br>(0.31) [0.654]    | 0.90 [0.00]<br>(0.30) [0.908]    | 0.153   |
| Scheduled Caste/Scheduled Tribe               | 0.39<br>(0.49)                   | 0.39 [-0.01]<br>(0.49) [0.835] | 0.40 [0.01]<br>(0.49) [0.782]    | 0.47 [0.06]<br>(0.50) [0.205]    | 0.42 [0.03]<br>(0.50) [0.578]    | 0.37 [-0.03]<br>(0.49) [0.409]   | 0.995   |
| Other Backward Caste                          | 0.10<br>(0.30)                   | 0.09 [-0.00]<br>(0.29) [0.833] | 0.08 [-0.01]<br>(0.28) [0.641]   | 0.04 [-0.05]<br>(0.21) [0.054*]  | 0.14 [0.04]<br>(0.34) [0.325]    | 0.13 [0.04]<br>(0.34) [0.217]    | 0.946   |
| Religion = Hindu                              | 0.74<br>(0.44)                   | 0.76 [0.03]<br>(0.43) [0.106]  | 0.70 [-0.04]<br>(0.46) [0.422]   | 0.84 [0.09]<br>(0.37) [0.010**]  | 0.80 [0.07]<br>(0.40) [0.048**]  | 0.79 [0.04]<br>(0.41) [0.153]    | 0.064*  |
| Rural Location                                | 0.50<br>(0.50)                   | 0.49 [-0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.491] | 0.48 [-0.00]<br>(0.50) [0.924]   | 0.49 [-0.03]<br>(0.50) [0.258]   | 0.49 [0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.744]    | 0.49 [-0.02]<br>(0.50) [0.267]   | 0.381   |
| Married or Previously Married                 | 0.94<br>(0.24)                   | 0.92 [-0.02]<br>(0.27) [0.218] | 0.96 [0.02]<br>(0.20) [0.397]    | 0.92 [-0.03]<br>(0.27) [0.345]   | 0.95 [0.01]<br>(0.22) [0.484]    | 0.93 [-0.02]<br>(0.26) [0.405]   | 0.332   |
| Lives with In-Laws                            | 0.44<br>(0.50)                   | 0.39 [-0.05]<br>(0.49) [0.123] | 0.47 [0.04]<br>(0.50) [0.500]    | 0.32 [-0.13]<br>(0.47) [0.015**] | 0.47 [0.03]<br>(0.50) [0.554]    | 0.35 [-0.09]<br>(0.48) [0.036**] | 0.098*  |
| Has Children under 8                          | 0.47<br>(0.50)                   | 0.48 [0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.168]  | 0.49 [0.02]<br>(0.50) [0.083*]   | 0.48 [-0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.321]   | 0.45 [-0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.479]   | 0.51 [0.01]<br>(0.50) [0.195]    | 0.204   |
| Individual (Not Shared) Smartphone            | 0.73<br>(0.44)                   | 0.72 [0.00]<br>(0.45) [0.915]  | 0.73 [0.01]<br>(0.45) [0.085*]   | 0.74 [0.01]<br>(0.44) [0.169]    | 0.72 [-0.00]<br>(0.45) [0.959]   | 0.73 [0.00]<br>(0.45) [0.641]    | 0.642   |
| Labor Supply Final Say = Self                 | 0.37<br>(0.48)                   | 0.37 [-0.00]<br>(0.48) [0.978] | 0.29 [-0.08]<br>(0.46) [0.114]   | 0.43 [0.06]<br>(0.50) [0.298]    | 0.35 [-0.01]<br>(0.48) [0.813]   | 0.33 [-0.04]<br>(0.47) [0.357]   | 0.729   |
| Gender Attitudes Index                        | -0.00<br>(0.39)                  | 0.04 [0.04]<br>(0.43) [0.108]  | 0.04 [0.04]<br>(0.46) [0.421]    | 0.00 [0.01]<br>(0.47) [0.861]    | -0.08 [-0.08]<br>(0.49) [0.114]  | 0.03 [0.03]<br>(0.42) [0.458]    | 0.271   |
| F-test of joint significance (with strata FE) |                                  | F=0.64, p=0.954                | F=0.65, p=0.945                  | F=0.75, p=0.853                  | F=0.73, p=0.884                  | F=0.85, p=0.718                  |         |
| Number of observations                        | 386                              | 668                            | 97                               | 91                               | 96                               | 187                              |         |

*Notes:* This table presents baseline characteristics of endline survey participants across treatment conditions. Participants are grouped according to their final work arrangement (after randomly-selected upgrades were implemented). Each cell in the treatment columns reports the mean of the characteristic, with standard deviations in parentheses below. Sample sizes for each cell are reported in parentheses next to the means. The numbers in square brackets next to the group means represent coefficients from regressions of each characteristic on treatment indicators (with Control as the omitted category), controlling for strata fixed effects.  $p$ -values for these coefficients appear in square brackets below the coefficients. The final column reports  $p$ -values from tests comparing the Control group to all job groups pooled together. The bottom row presents F-statistics with their corresponding  $p$ -values. Statistical significance is denoted by: \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*  $p < 0.10$ . Binary indicators (Bangla as native language, SC/ST, Hindu, rural, married/previously married, lives with in-laws, has children under 8, and smartphone ownership) take values of 0 or 1.

Table A5: Baseline Characteristics of Endline Children's Survey Participants

|                       | Control Mean (SD) | Treatment Mean (SD) | <i>p</i> -value |
|-----------------------|-------------------|---------------------|-----------------|
| Age                   | 12.17 (2.85)      | 12.34 (2.94)        | 0.534           |
| % Female              | 0.48 (0.50)       | 0.52 (0.50)         | 0.480           |
| KLK Index             | -0.00 (0.54)      | 0.05 (0.51)         | 0.338           |
| Mother Works (0/1)    | 0.11 (0.32)       | 0.08 (0.27)         | 0.348           |
| Father Works (0/1)    | 0.93 (0.26)       | 0.91 (0.28)         | 0.606           |
| Father Helps HH (0/1) | 1.25 (1.18)       | 1.19 (1.19)         | 0.633           |
| # of Observations     | 135               | 379                 |                 |

Table A6: Demographics Comparison Table: Study Sample vs Representative Household Survey

| Variable                        | (1)<br>Study Sample |                        | (2)<br>Large-scale Survey Data |                        | Difference<br>in Means<br>(1)-(2) |
|---------------------------------|---------------------|------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------------------|
|                                 | N                   | Mean/SE                | N                              | Mean/SE                |                                   |
| Scheduled Caste/Tribe (=1)      | 1553                | 0.414<br>(0.013)       | 18658                          | 0.466<br>(0.004)       | -0.052                            |
| Other Backward Classes (=1)     | 1553                | 0.104<br>(0.008)       | 18658                          | 0.164<br>(0.003)       | -0.060                            |
| Open/General (=1)               | 1553                | 0.482<br>(0.013)       | 18658                          | 0.340<br>(0.003)       | 0.142                             |
| Hindu (=1)                      | 1670                | 0.754<br>(0.011)       | 24200                          | 0.736<br>(0.003)       | 0.018                             |
| Muslim (=1)                     | 1670                | 0.244<br>(0.011)       | 24200                          | 0.246<br>(0.003)       | -0.002                            |
| Number HH Members               | 1670                | 4.626<br>(0.042)       | 24200                          | 4.724<br>(0.013)       | -0.098                            |
| Parent-in-Law in HH (=1)        | 1649                | 0.400<br>(0.012)       | 24200                          | 0.370<br>(0.003)       | 0.031                             |
| Has Child Under 8 (=1)          | 1670                | 0.516<br>(0.012)       | 24200                          | 0.478<br>(0.003)       | 0.038                             |
| Monthly Household Income (Rs.)  | 1583                | 11791.437<br>(299.440) | 7831                           | 14867.574<br>(208.776) | -3076.137                         |
| Age                             | 1670                | 29.911<br>(0.199)      | 19359                          | 32.432<br>(0.067)      | -2.521                            |
| Currently Married (=1)          | 1670                | 0.902<br>(0.007)       | 24200                          | 0.818<br>(0.002)       | 0.084                             |
| Never Attended School (=1)      | 1670                | 0.004<br>(0.002)       | 19359                          | 0.218<br>(0.003)       | -0.214                            |
| Completed Secondary School (=1) | 1670                | 0.493<br>(0.012)       | 19359                          | 0.598<br>(0.004)       | -0.104                            |
| Has Own Cellphone (=1)          | 1670                | 0.881<br>(0.008)       | 2919                           | 0.512<br>(0.009)       | 0.369                             |
| Has Never Worked for Pay (=1)   | 1670                | 0.688<br>(0.011)       | 6847                           | 0.771<br>(0.005)       | -0.083                            |
| Currently Works for Pay (=1)    | 1644                | 0.041<br>(0.005)       | 7603                           | 0.179<br>(0.004)       | -0.137                            |

*Notes:* This table presents demographic data for study participants and households from large-scale demographic surveys in India. The data for the study sample includes participants who were randomized into a treatment or control group. A ‘don’t know’ response is coded as missing, reducing the number of observations in the case of variables like caste and household income. The large-scale survey data are from the National Family Health Survey (2019-21) and the Periodic Labor Force Survey (2021-2022). The large-scale survey sample is restricted to West Bengal and women between 18 and 60 years.





Table A7: Effect of Flexible Job Attributes on Take Up of Work (Round 1)

|                                                          | Number Tasks Completed |                        |                        |                         |
|----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------|
|                                                          | $\geq 1$ task<br>(1)   | $\geq 10$ tasks<br>(2) | $\geq 50$ tasks<br>(3) | $\geq 100$ tasks<br>(4) |
| Home: Fully Flexible                                     | 0.48***<br>(0.02)      | 0.47***<br>(0.02)      | 0.47***<br>(0.02)      | 0.46***<br>(0.02)       |
| Home: Time Inflexible                                    | 0.46***<br>(0.05)      | 0.46***<br>(0.05)      | 0.45***<br>(0.05)      | 0.45***<br>(0.05)       |
| Home: Child Inflexible                                   | 0.29***<br>(0.04)      | 0.29***<br>(0.04)      | 0.28***<br>(0.04)      | 0.28***<br>(0.04)       |
| Home: Time and Child Inflexible                          | 0.30***<br>(0.04)      | 0.29***<br>(0.04)      | 0.29***<br>(0.04)      | 0.29***<br>(0.04)       |
| Office                                                   | 0.14***<br>(0.02)      | 0.13***<br>(0.02)      | 0.13***<br>(0.02)      | 0.13***<br>(0.02)       |
| <i>Tests of coefficient equality (p-values):</i>         |                        |                        |                        |                         |
| Home: Fully Flexible = Home: Time Inflexible             | 0.692                  | 0.813                  | 0.768                  | 0.844                   |
| Home: Fully Flexible = Home: Child Inflexible            | 0.000***               | 0.000***               | 0.000***               | 0.000***                |
| Home: Fully Flexible = Home: Time and Child Inflexible   | 0.000***               | 0.000***               | 0.000***               | 0.000***                |
| Home: Fully Flexible = Office                            | 0.000***               | 0.000***               | 0.000***               | 0.000***                |
| Home: Time Inflexible = Home: Child Inflexible           | 0.007***               | 0.007***               | 0.007***               | 0.007***                |
| Home: Time Inflexible = Home: Time and Child Inflexible  | 0.015**                | 0.010**                | 0.015**                | 0.015**                 |
| Home: Time Inflexible = Office                           | 0.000***               | 0.000***               | 0.000***               | 0.000***                |
| Home: Child Inflexible = Home: Time and Child Inflexible | 0.793                  | 0.904                  | 0.779                  | 0.780                   |
| Home: Child Inflexible = Office                          | 0.004***               | 0.001***               | 0.002***               | 0.002***                |
| Home: Time and Child Inflexible = Office                 | 0.001***               | 0.001***               | 0.001***               | 0.001***                |
| Observations                                             | 1,670                  | 1,670                  | 1,670                  | 1,670                   |
| Control                                                  | 0.00                   | 0.00                   | 0.00                   | 0.00                    |

*Notes:* This table presents the impacts of flexible work arrangements on round 1 job take up. The estimates come from regressions where the outcome variable is an indicator for whether or not the participant started work, and the regressors are indicator variables for each of the five work arrangements. The Control group is the excluded category. Columns (2)-(4) show alternative definitions of job take up with higher thresholds for the number of tasks completed to qualify as having started work. The regressions control for strata fixed effects and are estimated using Huber-White heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors. Stars next to coefficients represent significance (\* at 10%; \*\* at 5%; \*\*\* at 1%).

Table A8: Effect of Flexible Job Attributes on Take Up of Work (Long Regression)

| Treatment                                                  | Coefficient         | Difference from<br>Home: Fully Flexible |
|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Home: Fully Flexible                                       | 0.491***<br>(0.035) | —                                       |
| Home: Time Inflexible (Upgraded)                           | 0.504***<br>(0.045) | 0.014<br>(0.057)                        |
| Home: Child Inflexible (Upgraded)                          | 0.472***<br>(0.047) | -0.018<br>(0.059)                       |
| Home: Time and Child Inflexible (Upgraded)                 | 0.405***<br>(0.045) | -0.086<br>(0.057)                       |
| Office (Upgraded)                                          | 0.500***<br>(0.035) | 0.009<br>(0.049)                        |
| Home: Time Inflexible (No Upgrade)                         | 0.460***<br>(0.049) | -0.031<br>(0.060)                       |
| Home: Child Inflexible (No Upgrade)                        | 0.286***<br>(0.043) | -0.204***<br>(0.055)                    |
| Home: Time and Child Inflexible (No Upgrade)               | 0.302***<br>(0.044) | -0.188***<br>(0.056)                    |
| Office (No Upgrade)                                        | 0.144***<br>(0.025) | -0.346***<br>(0.042)                    |
| Observations                                               | 1,670               |                                         |
| <i>Tests of Coefficient Equality (p-values)</i>            |                     |                                         |
| Home: Time Inflexible (Nograde vs Upgrade)                 | 0.502               |                                         |
| Home: Child Inflexible (Nograde vs Upgrade)                | 0.003***            |                                         |
| Home: Time and Child Inflexible (Nograde vs Upgrade)       | 0.101               |                                         |
| Office (Nograde vs Upgrade)                                | 0.000***            |                                         |
| Home (Time Inflexible Upgrade vs Fully Flexible)           | 0.811               |                                         |
| Home (Child Inflexible Upgrade vs Fully Flexible)          | 0.755               |                                         |
| Home (Time and Child Inflexible Upgrade vs Fully Flexible) | 0.132               |                                         |
| Office Upgrade vs Home: Fully Flexible                     | 0.849               |                                         |

*Notes:* This table presents the impacts of flexible work arrangements on job take up, including all treatment groups (upgrades and no-upgrades) separately. The estimates come from regressions where the outcome variable is an indicator for whether or not the participant started work and the omitted group is the control group. The regressions control for strata fixed effects and are estimated using Huber-White heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors. Stars next to coefficients represent significance (\* at 10%; \*\* at 5%; \*\*\* at 1%).

Table A9: Monotonicity of Job Take-up in Flexibility

|                                 | Did not accept job on left, but would accept... |                      |                      |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
|                                 | 1 less flexible job                             | 2 less flexible jobs | 3 less flexible jobs |
| Home: Fully Flexible            | <1%                                             | <1%                  | <1%                  |
| Home: Time Inflexible           | 4.4%                                            | 1.7%                 | <1%                  |
| Home: Child Inflexible          | 4.8%                                            | <1%                  | -                    |
| Home: Time and Child Inflexible | 6.0%                                            | -                    | -                    |

*Notes:* This table presents results about the monotonicity of job take up with respect to flexibility. Each cell shows the share of individuals that refused a job offer of the type indicated in the left column, but who state on the baseline survey that they would accept a less flexible job if offered it. The three columns indicate whether they state they would accept one, two, or three less flexible jobs than the job they refused. “-” indicates that this case is not relevant, which could occur if there are not enough jobs which are less flexible (for example, because there is only one job that is less flexible than the time- and multitasking-with-childcare-inflexible job).

Table A10: Round 1 → Round 2 Take-up (from fully interacted regression)

| Round 1                       | Round 2              |                       |                        |                               |              |
|-------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------|
|                               | Home: Fully Flexible | Home: Time Inflexible | Home: Child Inflexible | Home: Time & Child Inflexible | Office       |
| Home: Fully Flexible          | -0.05 (0.06)         | 0.03 (0.08)           | 0.08 (0.08)            | 0.00 (0.08)                   | 0.06 (0.05)  |
| Home: Time Inflexible         | -0.11 (0.12)         | -0.05 (0.14)          | 0.00 (0.14)            | 0.16 (0.16)                   | 0.09 (0.09)  |
| Home: Child Inflexible        | 0.03 (0.11)          | -0.03 (0.15)          | -0.17 (0.15)           | -0.00 (0.15)                  | -0.00 (0.09) |
| Home: Time & Child Inflexible | -0.09 (0.11)         | 0.12 (0.14)           | -0.18 (0.16)           | 0.08 (0.16)                   | 0.11 (0.09)  |
| Office                        | -0.08 (0.08)         | -0.02 (0.12)          | -0.02 (0.11)           | -0.02 (0.12)                  | -0.04 (0.06) |

*Notes:* This table presents results from a fully interacted regression of round 2 job take-up on all combinations of round 1 and round 2 job assignments.

- The outcome variable in all columns is an indicator variable equal to 1 if the participant starts the job that she was randomly assigned to during round 2 and is otherwise equal to 0.
- The omitted group is the control group, who received no job offer during round 1. The combinations of round 1 and round 2 job assignments that constitute a gateway job sequence are highlighted in light green.
- The analysis sample consists of all 1,524 participants who were randomly assigned a round 2 job offer.
- The regression includes strata fixed effects and lasso-selected controls. Standard errors (·) are robust to heteroskedasticity.

Table A11: Correlates of Baseline Gender Attitudes

| Variable                        | Coefficient |
|---------------------------------|-------------|
| Completed 10th Standard         | 0.205***    |
| Owens smartphone                | 0.135***    |
| Never been employed             | -0.096***   |
| Has own bank account            | 0.077***    |
| Has child under 8               | -0.058**    |
| Household income (Rupees/month) | 0.043       |
| Age (years)                     | 0.035       |
| Lives with in-laws              | 0.001       |

*Notes:* This table presents correlation coefficients between a baseline gender attitudes index computed as in [Kling et al. \(2007\)](#) and demographic characteristics (listed in rows). Higher values of the baseline gender attitudes index indicate more progressive values. Columns present the correlation coefficients and stars based on robust *p*-values (\* significant at 10%; \*\* at 5%; \*\*\* at 1%). Binary indicators (Completed 10th standard, owns smartphone, never been employed, has own bank account, has child under 8, and lives with in-laws) take values of 0 or 1.

Table A12: Treatment Effect on Gender Attitudes: Heterogeneity by Baseline Attitudes

|                                              | Endline Gender Attitudes Index |                  |                    |                   |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------|--------------------|-------------------|
|                                              | (1)                            | (2)              | (3)                | (4)               |
| Treatment                                    | 0.07**<br>(0.03)               | 0.05**<br>(0.02) | 0.01<br>(0.04)     | -0.01<br>(0.03)   |
| Median Traditional at Baseline               |                                |                  | -0.42***<br>(0.05) | -0.11**<br>(0.05) |
| Treatment x > Median Traditional at Baseline |                                |                  | 0.08<br>(0.05)     | 0.13***<br>(0.05) |
| Strata FE                                    | Yes                            | Yes              | Yes                | Yes               |
| Lasso Selected Controls                      | No                             | Yes              | No                 | Yes               |
| Observations                                 | 1,525                          | 1,525            | 1,525              | 1,525             |
| Control Mean                                 | 0.01                           | 0.01             | 0.01               | 0.01              |

*Notes:* This table presents results on the effects of the job treatment on endline gender attitudes. The outcome variable in all columns is an index of variables measuring gender attitudes, computed as in [Kling et al. \(2007\)](#). Higher values indicate more progressive attitudes. The omitted group is the control group, who received no job offers. Columns (5)-(8) present heterogeneity in treatment effects by baseline attitudes. The indicator "> Median Traditional at Baseline" takes value 1 for respondents whose baseline gender attitudes index (computed as in [Kling et al. \(2007\)](#)) is less than the sample median. Columns (1) and (5) do not include controls. Even columns include strata fixed effects. Columns (3), (4), (7) and (8) also include lasso-selected controls. Standard errors in parentheses (·) are Huber-White (robust to heteroskedasticity). Stars next to coefficients represent *p*-values (\* significant at 10%; \*\* at 5%; \*\*\* at 1%).

Table A13: Effect of Job Treatments By Work Arrangement on Gender Attitudes (KLK)

|                                             | Endline Gender Attitudes Index |                  |                   |                   |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------|-------------------|-------------------|
|                                             | (1)                            | (2)              | (3)               | (4)               |
| Arrangement = Home: Fully Flexible          | 0.08***<br>(0.03)              | 0.07**<br>(0.03) |                   |                   |
| Arrangement = Home: Time Inflexible         | 0.08<br>(0.06)                 | 0.07<br>(0.04)   |                   |                   |
| Arrangement = Home: Child Inflexible        | 0.09*<br>(0.05)                | 0.07<br>(0.05)   |                   |                   |
| Arrangement = Home: Time & Child Inflexible | -0.07<br>(0.06)                | -0.03<br>(0.05)  |                   |                   |
| Arrangement = Office                        | 0.06<br>(0.04)                 | 0.04<br>(0.04)   |                   |                   |
| Started Home: Fully Flexible                |                                |                  | 0.16***<br>(0.06) | 0.13***<br>(0.05) |
| Started Home: Time Inflexible               |                                |                  | 0.18<br>(0.11)    | 0.15<br>(0.09)    |
| Started Home: Child Inflexible              |                                |                  | 0.30*<br>(0.17)   | 0.22<br>(0.15)    |
| Started Home: Time & Child Inflexible       |                                |                  | -0.23<br>(0.18)   | -0.10<br>(0.16)   |
| Started Office                              |                                |                  | 0.40<br>(0.27)    | 0.24<br>(0.23)    |
| Strata FE                                   | Yes                            | Yes              | Yes               | Yes               |
| Lasso Selected Controls                     | No                             | Yes              | No                | Yes               |
| Observations                                | 1,525                          | 1,525            | 1,525             | 1,525             |
| Control Mean                                | 0.01                           | 0.01             | 0.01              | 0.01              |

*Notes:* This table presents results on the effects of the job treatment on endline gender attitudes. The outcome variable in all columns is an index of variables measuring gender attitudes, computed as in [Kling et al. \(2007\)](#). Higher values indicate more progressive attitudes. The omitted group is the control group, who received no job offers. ITT estimates are based on the randomly-assigned round 1 job assignments. 2SLS estimates are based on whether participants started the work they were offered in those assignments. The analysis sample consists of all 1,525 participants who completed the endline survey. All columns include strata fixed effects, and even columns include lasso-selected controls. Standard errors in parentheses (·) are Huber-White (robust to heteroskedasticity). Stars next to coefficients represent *p*-values (\* significant at 10%; \*\* at 5%; \*\*\* at 1%).

Table A14: Effect of Job Treatments By Work Arrangement on Gender Attitudes (Anderson)

|                                       | Endline Gender Attitudes Index |                  |                   |                  |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------|-------------------|------------------|
|                                       | (1)                            | (2)              | (3)               | (4)              |
| Arrangement = Home: Fully Flexible    | 0.08***<br>(0.03)              | 0.06**<br>(0.03) |                   |                  |
| Arrangement = Home: Time Inflexible   | 0.11**<br>(0.05)               | 0.10**<br>(0.04) |                   |                  |
| Arrangement = Home: Child Inflexible  | 0.08*<br>(0.05)                | 0.06<br>(0.05)   |                   |                  |
| Arrangement = Time & Child Inflexibl  | -0.08<br>(0.06)                | -0.06<br>(0.05)  |                   |                  |
| Arrangement = Office                  | 0.05<br>(0.04)                 | 0.03<br>(0.04)   |                   |                  |
| Started Home: Fully Flexible          |                                |                  | 0.15***<br>(0.05) | 0.12**<br>(0.05) |
| Started Home: Time Inflexible         |                                |                  | 0.23**<br>(0.10)  | 0.21**<br>(0.09) |
| Started Home: Child Inflexible        |                                |                  | 0.26*<br>(0.15)   | 0.18<br>(0.14)   |
| Started Home: Time & Child Inflexible |                                |                  | -0.25<br>(0.19)   | -0.18<br>(0.17)  |
| Started Office                        |                                |                  | 0.30<br>(0.25)    | 0.18<br>(0.23)   |
| Strata Fixed Effects                  | Yes                            | Yes              | Yes               | Yes              |
| Lasso Selected Controls               | No                             | Yes              | No                | Yes              |
| Observations                          | 1,525                          | 1,525            | 1,525             | 1,525            |
| Control Mean                          | 0.01                           | 0.01             | 0.01              | 0.01             |

*Notes:* This table presents results on the effects of the job treatment on endline gender attitudes. The outcome variable in all columns is an index of variables measuring gender attitudes, computed as in [Anderson \(2008\)](#). Higher values indicate more progressive attitudes. The omitted group is the control group, who received no job offers. ITT estimates are based on the randomly-assigned round 1 job assignments. 2SLS estimates are based on whether participants started the work they were offered in those assignments. The analysis sample consists of all 1,525 participants who completed the endline survey. All columns include strata fixed effects, and even columns include lasso-selected controls. Standard errors in parentheses (·) are Huber-White (robust to heteroskedasticity). Stars next to coefficients represent *p*-values (\* significant at 10%; \*\* at 5%; \*\*\* at 1%).

Table A15: Effect of Job Treatment on Components of the Gender Attitudes Index

|              | Father<br>resp.<br>work,<br>mother<br>resp.<br>home<br>(1) | Home-<br>maker<br>most imp.<br>role<br>(2) | Mother<br>not work<br>better for<br>child<br>(3) | Man<br>have final<br>say in<br>HH<br>decisions<br>(4) | Men<br>understand<br>money<br>better<br>(5) | Men better<br>suited<br>for career<br>(6) | Women<br>using<br>soc. media<br>risk<br>reputation<br>(7) | Parents<br>should<br>supervise<br>girls'<br>phone<br>more<br>(8) | Men can't<br>cook/clean<br>even if<br>they try<br>(9) | Husb.<br>should<br>always<br>know<br>what wife<br>does on<br>phone<br>(10) | Dau.<br>should<br>not use<br>phone w/o<br>supervision<br>(11) | Husb.<br>should<br>split<br>HH resp.<br>equally<br>(12) | Prefer DIL<br>works<br>(13) | Prefer<br>SIL<br>who lets<br>dau.<br>work<br>(14) | Dau.<br>should<br>work<br>after<br>marriage<br>(15) |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Treatment    | 0.04<br>(0.05)                                             | 0.11**<br>(0.05)                           | 0.05<br>(0.06)                                   | -0.02<br>(0.05)                                       | 0.05<br>(0.07)                              | 0.05<br>(0.07)                            | 0.03<br>(0.06)                                            | 0.09<br>(0.07)                                                   | 0.04<br>(0.07)                                        | 0.04<br>(0.06)                                                             | 0.06<br>(0.06)                                                | 0.03<br>(0.06)                                          | 0.01<br>(0.06)              | 0.08<br>(0.06)                                    | 0.19**<br>(0.09)                                    |
| Observations | 1,525                                                      | 1,525                                      | 1,525                                            | 1,525                                                 | 968                                         | 968                                       | 1,519                                                     | 968                                                              | 968                                                   | 1,524                                                                      | 1,524                                                         | 1,525                                                   | 1,525                       | 1,525                                             | 715                                                 |

*Notes:* This table presents results on the effects of the job treatment on endline gender attitudes. Every outcome is a component variable from the combined gender attitude index used in the rest of the analysis. When relevant, signs have been flipped so that higher (more positive) values always indicate more progressive attitudes. The omitted group is the control group, who received no job offers. All estimates are ITT, based on the randomly-assigned round 1 job assignments. The analysis sample consists of all 1,525 participants who completed the endline survey. All columns include strata fixed effects, and lasso-selected controls. Standard errors in parentheses (·) are Huber-White (robust to heteroskedasticity). Stars next to coefficients represent  $p$ -values (\* significant at 10%; \*\* at 5%; \*\*\* at 1%).

Table A16: Causal Forest Variable Importance for R1 Take Up (KLK Indices)

| Rank | Variable                             | Importance |
|------|--------------------------------------|------------|
| 1    | Gender attitudes index (KLK)         | 0.091      |
| 2    | Baseline survey duration             | 0.073      |
| 3    | Psychological well-being index (KLK) | 0.062      |
| 4    | Agency index (KLK)                   | 0.059      |
| 5    | Age                                  | 0.046      |
| 6    | Phone is shared with husband         | 0.030      |
| 7    | Uses phone for photos                | 0.024      |
| 8    | Baseline survey month = April        | 0.022      |
| 9    | Uses phone for calling friends       | 0.022      |
| 10   | Smartphone use frequency             | 0.020      |

*Notes:* Variable importance scores from a causal forest (2,000 trees) estimating heterogeneity in the importance of flexibility to job take up during round 1. Flexibility is measured as a continuous variable (Office = 1, Home: Time and Child Inflexible = 2, Home: Child Inflexible = 3, Home: Time Inflexible = 4, Home: Fully Flexible = 5). Importance measures the frequency with which each covariate is used to split the sample when identifying treatment effect heterogeneity. All variables are measured at baseline. Top 10 variables shown. Individual components of the indices are dropped from variable selection since the overall indices are already included.

Table A20: Take Up of Digital vs Non-Digital Jobs

|                       | Started Work in Round 2 |                |                 |                 |
|-----------------------|-------------------------|----------------|-----------------|-----------------|
|                       | (1)                     | (2)            | (3)             | (4)             |
| Round 2 Job = Digital | 0.02<br>(0.03)          | 0.02<br>(0.03) | -0.04<br>(0.03) | -0.04<br>(0.03) |
| Observations          | 1,524                   | 1,524          | 1,524           | 1,524           |
| Strata FE             | Yes                     | Yes            | Yes             | Yes             |
| Lasso Controls        | No                      | Yes            | No              | Yes             |
| R2 Arrangement        | No                      | No             | Yes             | Yes             |

*Notes:* This table reports the results of regressions comparing job take up between the digital and non-digital jobs during Jobs Round 2. The outcome variable is a dummy equal to one if the participant started the job she was randomly assigned to during round 2, and otherwise equal to zero.



Table A17: Causal Forest Variable Importance for R1 Take Up (Anderson Indices)

| Rank | Variable                                  | Importance |
|------|-------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1    | Gender attitudes index (Anderson)         | 0.104      |
| 2    | Baseline survey duration                  | 0.086      |
| 3    | Agency index (Anderson)                   | 0.059      |
| 4    | Psychological well-being index (Anderson) | 0.059      |
| 5    | Age                                       | 0.049      |
| 6    | Uses phone for photos                     | 0.022      |
| 7    | Phone is shared with husband              | 0.022      |
| 8    | Number of HH members                      | 0.022      |
| 9    | Number of HH members (squared)            | 0.021      |
| 10   | Number of reported friends                | 0.019      |

*Notes:* Variable importance scores from a causal forest (2,000 trees) estimating heterogeneity in the importance of flexibility to job take up during round 1. Flexibility is measured as a continuous variable (Office = 1, Home: Time and Child Inflexible = 2, Home: Child Inflexible = 3, Home: Time Inflexible = 4, Home: Fully Flexible = 5). Importance measures the frequency with which each covariate is used to split the sample when identifying treatment effect heterogeneity. All variables are measured at baseline. Top 10 variables shown. Individual components of the indices are dropped from variable selection since the overall indices are already included.

Table A18: Causal Forest Variable Importance for R1 Effects on R2 (KLK Indices)

| Rank | Variable                                  | Importance |
|------|-------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1    | Gender attitudes index (KLK)              | 0.059      |
| 2    | Baseline survey duration                  | 0.052      |
| 3    | Agency index (KLK)                        | 0.051      |
| 4    | Psychological well-being index (KLK)      | 0.047      |
| 5    | Age                                       | 0.036      |
| 6    | Number of reported friends                | 0.034      |
| 7    | Reading confidence = very high            | 0.026      |
| 8    | Withdraws from own bank account           | 0.022      |
| 9    | Believes talent/potential put to good use | 0.020      |
| 10   | Deposits in own bank account              | 0.019      |

*Notes:* Variable importance scores from a causal forest (2,000 trees) estimating heterogeneity in the gateway job treatment effects. Importance measures the frequency with which each covariate is used to split the sample when identifying treatment effect heterogeneity. All variables are measured at baseline. Top 10 variables shown. We drop individual components of the indices from being included in the top 10 since the overall indices are already included.

Table A19: Causal Forest Variable Importance for R1 Effects on R2 (Anderson Indices)

| Rank | Variable                                  | Importance |
|------|-------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1    | Gender attitudes index (Anderson)         | 0.072      |
| 2    | Baseline survey duration                  | 0.053      |
| 3    | Agency index (Anderson)                   | 0.048      |
| 4    | Psychological well-being index (Anderson) | 0.048      |
| 5    | Age                                       | 0.035      |
| 6    | Number of reported friends                | 0.034      |
| 7    | Reading confidence = very high            | 0.025      |
| 8    | Withdraws from own bank account           | 0.021      |
| 9    | Deposits in own bank account              | 0.019      |
| 10   | No previous paid work experience          | 0.018      |

*Notes:* Variable importance scores from a causal forest (2,000 trees) estimating heterogeneity in the gateway job treatment effects. Importance measures the frequency with which each covariate is used to split the sample when identifying treatment effect heterogeneity. All variables are measured at baseline. Top 10 variables shown. We drop individual components of the indices from being included in the top 10 since the overall indices are already included.

Table A21: Treatment Effects on Children's Reports of Parents' Activities

|                      | Mom has Job<br>(1) | Dad has Job<br>(2) | Dad Helps (> Never)<br>(3) |
|----------------------|--------------------|--------------------|----------------------------|
| Treatment            | 0.18***<br>(0.04)  | -0.01<br>(0.02)    | 0.09*<br>(0.05)            |
| Observations         | 510                | 508                | 512                        |
| Control Mean         | 0.20               | 0.97               | 0.58                       |
| Strata fixed effects | Yes                | Yes                | Yes                        |
| Baseline measure     | Yes                | Yes                | Yes                        |

*Notes:* This table presents effects of the job treatment on children's reports of whether their parents work for pay and whether their parents contribute to home production activities.

- All treatment groups are pooled and compared to the control group. Households are only included in the analysis sample if children participated in the survey at both baseline and endline ( $N = 515$ ). Differences in the number of observation across columns are due to “don't know” responses.
- The outcome variables in columns (1) and (2) are indicators that take value 1 if the child reports that their mother and father work for pay respectively, and 0 otherwise. The outcome variable in column (3) is based on the child's report about the father's participation in cleaning, cooking, or laundry. The indicator takes value 1 if the child responds that their father helped more than “never” with these activities during the time frame of the intervention.
- Standard errors in parentheses (·) are Huber-White (robust to heteroskedasticity). Stars next to coefficients represent p-values (\* significant at 10%; \*\* at 5%; \*\*\* at 1%).

Table A22: Treatment Effects on Children's Gender Attitudes

|                  | Gender Attitudes Index |                |                 |                 |                |
|------------------|------------------------|----------------|-----------------|-----------------|----------------|
|                  | All Children           | By Child Age   |                 | By Child Gender |                |
|                  |                        | >12            | ≤12             | Male            | Female         |
|                  | (1)                    | (2)            | (3)             | (4)             | (5)            |
| Treatment        | -0.01<br>(0.04)        | 0.06<br>(0.06) | -0.10<br>(0.07) | -0.05<br>(0.06) | 0.07<br>(0.07) |
| Observations     | 514                    | 278            | 236             | 256             | 258            |
| Strata FE        | Yes                    | Yes            | Yes             | Yes             | Yes            |
| Baseline measure | Yes                    | Yes            | Yes             | Yes             | Yes            |

*Notes:* This table presents effects of the job treatment on children's gender attitudes.

- All treatment groups are pooled and compared to the control group. Households are only included in the analysis sample if children responded to the gender attitudes module at both baseline and endline ( $N = 514$ ).
- The outcome variables across all columns is an index of children's gender attitudes from the endline survey. The index is computed as a simple average of standardized responses to questions in the endline survey in [Kling et al. \(2007\)](#). See Appendix Section A.1 for more information on the questions that are used in constructing this index.
- Column (1) includes all children. Columns (2) and (3) report heterogeneous treatment effects by child age. Children are split by the median age of twelve, with treatment effects on older children reported in column (2) and treatment effects on younger children reported in column (3). Columns (4) and (5) report heterogeneous treatment effects by child gender.
- Standard errors in parentheses (·) are Huber-White (robust to heteroskedasticity). Stars next to coefficients represent p-values (\* significant at 10%; \*\* at 5%; \*\*\* at 1%).

Table A23: Effect of Job Treatments on Women's Psychological Well-Being

|                         | Psych Well-being Index (KLK)<br>(1) | Sleep Peacefully<br>(2) | Feel Happy<br>(3) | (Not) Anxious<br>(4) | (Not) Overwhelmed<br>(5) |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------|-------------------|----------------------|--------------------------|
| Treatment               | 0.01<br>(0.04)                      | -0.02<br>(0.06)         | -0.02<br>(0.06)   | -0.01<br>(0.06)      | 0.07<br>(0.06)           |
| Observations            | 1,524                               | 1,524                   | 1,524             | 1,524                | 1,524                    |
| Control Mean (Endline)  | 0.00                                | 0.00                    | 0.00              | 0.00                 | 0.00                     |
| Strata FE               | Yes                                 | Yes                     | Yes               | Yes                  | Yes                      |
| Lasso Selected Controls | Yes                                 | Yes                     | Yes               | Yes                  | Yes                      |

*Notes:* This table presents the treatment effect of the jobs intervention on women's psychological wellbeing.

- In this analysis, all treatment groups are pooled and compared to the control group.
- The dependent variable in column (1) is an index of four standardized variables measuring well-being in the endline survey, computed as in [Kling et al. \(2007\)](#).
- The dependent variables in columns (2)-(5) are components making up the column (1) index. For questions corresponding to columns (2)-(5), participants were asked about how often they felt a certain way in the last month, and the outcome is standardized to have mean 0 and standard deviation 1 in the control group. Column (2) is how often they slept peacefully, column (3) is how often they felt overwhelmed, column (4) is how often they were feeling generally happy, and column (5) is how often they felt worried. Outcomes in columns (3) and (5) are negated so that positive values correspond to better well-being. In response to these questions, participants could answer that in the last month they felt this way (i) Never, (ii) A few days, (iii) Around half the days, (iv) More than half the days, and (v) Nearly every day.
- All regressions include lasso-selected controls and strata fixed effects. Heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors are reported in parentheses. Stars next to coefficients represent p-values (\* significant at 10%; \*\* at 5%; \*\*\* at 1%).

Table A24: Treatment Effects on Use of Talents and Potential

|                         | Talents & Abilities Put to Good Use? |                  |                  |                  |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|
|                         | (1)                                  | (2)              | (3)              | (4)              |
| Treatment               | 0.13**<br>(0.06)                     | 0.13**<br>(0.06) | 0.13**<br>(0.06) | 0.13**<br>(0.06) |
| Observations            | 1,523                                | 1,523            | 1,523            | 1,523            |
| Control Mean            | 1.37                                 | 1.37             | 1.37             | 1.37             |
| Strata Fixed Effects    | No                                   | Yes              | No               | Yes              |
| Lasso Selected Controls | No                                   | No               | Yes              | Yes              |

*Notes:* This table presents effects of the job treatment on women's perceptions of to what degree their talents and potential are put to good use.

- All treatment groups are pooled and compared to the control group. One of the endline participants did not answer this question, resulting in a sample size of 1,523.
- The outcome variable across all columns is participants' endline survey response to the question "Do you feel that your full potential and talents are put to good use?" The answers are coded as a numerical score from 0 to 3, where 0 is "not at all," 1 is "a little bit," 2 is "somewhat," and 3 is "very much."
- Standard errors in parentheses (·) are Huber-White (robust to heteroskedasticity). Stars next to coefficients represent p-values (\* significant at 10%; \*\* at 5%; \*\*\* at 1%).

Table A25: Treatment Effect of Work-From-Home on Performance, Heterogeneity by Task Type

|                                         | Effects of work-from-home on performance |           |           |           |           |           |           |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
|                                         | (1)                                      | (2)       | (3)       | (4)       | (5)       | (6)       | (7)       |
| <i>Panel A: Seconds Per Task</i>        |                                          |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| Final Job: Office                       | -2.80*                                   | -2.35     | -2.63     | -2.66     | -2.45     | -2.52     | -2.51     |
|                                         | (1.57)                                   | (1.71)    | (1.64)    | (1.65)    | (1.65)    | (1.64)    | (1.66)    |
| Paragraph Task                          | 38.7***                                  | 38.8***   | 38.8***   | 38.2***   | 38.7***   | 38.8***   | 37.1***   |
|                                         | (2.88)                                   | (2.88)    | (2.88)    | (2.89)    | (2.88)    | (2.88)    | (2.84)    |
| Backwards Task                          | 3.85***                                  | 3.67***   | 3.90***   | 3.46***   | 3.71***   | 3.94***   | 3.86***   |
|                                         | (0.630)                                  | (0.622)   | (0.619)   | (0.591)   | (0.624)   | (0.616)   | (0.905)   |
| Paragraph Task × Final Job: Office      | -13.0***                                 | -13.1***  | -13.1***  | -12.9***  | -13.1***  | -13.1***  | -12.8***  |
|                                         | (3.82)                                   | (3.79)    | (3.81)    | (3.80)    | (3.80)    | (3.80)    | (3.88)    |
| Backwards Task × Final Job: Office      | -0.067                                   | 0.015     | -0.048    | -0.247    | -0.009    | -0.062    | -0.011    |
|                                         | (1.06)                                   | (1.05)    | (1.05)    | (1.07)    | (1.05)    | (1.05)    | (1.08)    |
| Home Avg. Seconds/Task                  | 26.521                                   | 26.521    | 26.521    | 26.521    | 26.521    | 26.521    | 26.521    |
| Observations                            | 227,994                                  | 227,994   | 227,994   | 227,994   | 227,994   | 227,994   | 227,994   |
| <i>Panel B: Accuracy</i>                |                                          |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| Final Job: Office                       | -0.004                                   | -0.003    | -0.002    | -0.001    | -0.002    | -0.001    | 0.001     |
|                                         | (0.029)                                  | (0.029)   | (0.029)   | (0.029)   | (0.028)   | (0.028)   | (0.028)   |
| Paragraph Task                          | -0.367***                                | -0.367*** | -0.367*** | -0.355*** | -0.366*** | -0.367*** | -0.395*** |
|                                         | (0.062)                                  | (0.062)   | (0.062)   | (0.065)   | (0.062)   | (0.062)   | (0.075)   |
| Backwards Task                          | -0.162***                                | -0.162*** | -0.163*** | -0.160*** | -0.162*** | -0.164*** | -0.173*** |
|                                         | (0.041)                                  | (0.041)   | (0.041)   | (0.041)   | (0.041)   | (0.041)   | (0.049)   |
| Paragraph Task × Final Job: Office      | 0.283***                                 | 0.283***  | 0.282***  | 0.276***  | 0.282***  | 0.282***  | 0.265***  |
|                                         | (0.077)                                  | (0.077)   | (0.077)   | (0.078)   | (0.077)   | (0.077)   | (0.075)   |
| Backwards Task × Final Job: Office      | 0.113**                                  | 0.114**   | 0.114**   | 0.113**   | 0.114**   | 0.114**   | 0.110**   |
|                                         | (0.051)                                  | (0.051)   | (0.051)   | (0.053)   | (0.051)   | (0.051)   | (0.052)   |
| Home Avg. Accuracy                      | 1.793                                    | 1.793     | 1.793     | 1.793     | 1.793     | 1.793     | 1.793     |
| Observations                            | 231,017                                  | 231,017   | 231,017   | 231,017   | 231,017   | 231,017   | 231,017   |
| Strata FE                               | ✓                                        | ✓         | ✓         | ✓         | ✓         | ✓         | ✓         |
| Lasso Selected Controls                 | ✓                                        |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| Number Previous Tasks Completed         |                                          | ✓         | ✓         |           |           |           |           |
| Number Previous Tasks Completed Squared |                                          |           | ✓         |           |           |           |           |
| Previous Tasks Completed Fixed Effects  |                                          |           |           | ✓         |           |           |           |
| Number Previous Tasks Attempted         |                                          |           |           |           | ✓         | ✓         |           |
| Number Previous Tasks Attempted Squared |                                          |           |           |           |           | ✓         |           |
| Previous Tasks Attempted Fixed Effects  |                                          |           |           |           |           |           | ✓         |

*Notes:* This table presents effects of work from home on job performance, and then differentially by task type. It compares individuals who were randomly chosen for an upgrade from Office to Home: Fully Flexible after they accepted Office to those who were not randomly chosen. This holds worker type constant while comparing performance between the office job and most flexible work-from-home arrangement.

– In Panel A, the outcome variable is seconds taken to complete a task. In Panel B, the outcome is accuracy. In both Panels A and B, the omitted group is individuals who accepted Office but were then randomly upgraded to Home: Fully Flexible.

– All columns include strata fixed effects. Column (1) includes controls selected by double post lasso. Columns (2) and (3) include controls for the number of tasks completed before the task, Column (3) also controls for non-linear effects of prior task completion. Column (4) includes fixed effects for all tasks that were previously completed. Column (5) controls for number of tasks previously attempted, and (6) adds non-linear effects. Column (7) includes fixed effects for previously attempted tasks.

– Standard errors in parentheses (·) are clustered at the worker level. Stars next to coefficients denote significance (\* at 10%; \*\* at 5%; \*\*\* at 1%).

Table A26: Characterizing work-from-home compliers: Unscaled estimates

|                                           | Characterizing work-from-home compliers |                      |                      |                      |                      |                      |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
|                                           | (1)                                     | (2)                  | (3)                  | (4)                  | (5)                  | (6)                  |
| <i>Panel A: Seconds Per Task</i>          |                                         |                      |                      |                      |                      |                      |
| Work-from-home compliers                  | 1.65<br>(1.95)                          | 1.25<br>(1.82)       | 1.19<br>(1.81)       | 1.61<br>(1.93)       | 1.64<br>(1.92)       | 1.70<br>(1.93)       |
| Work-from-home compliers                  | 1.71<br>(1.65)                          | 1.28<br>(1.53)       | 1.29<br>(1.53)       | 1.67<br>(1.63)       | 1.69<br>(1.62)       | 1.66<br>(1.62)       |
| Difficult task                            | 23.2***<br>(1.51)                       | 23.4***<br>(1.52)    | 22.8***<br>(1.53)    | 23.3***<br>(1.52)    | 23.5***<br>(1.52)    | 23.0***<br>(1.61)    |
| Difficult task × Work-from-home compliers | 0.025<br>(2.08)                         | 0.061<br>(2.08)      | -0.104<br>(2.03)     | 0.037<br>(2.07)      | 0.054<br>(2.08)      | 0.232<br>(2.07)      |
| Office Accepters Average Seconds          | 26.521                                  | 26.521               | 26.521               | 26.521               | 26.521               | 26.521               |
| Observations                              | 409,300                                 | 409,300              | 409,300              | 409,300              | 409,300              | 409,300              |
| <i>Panel B: Accuracy</i>                  |                                         |                      |                      |                      |                      |                      |
| Work-from-home compliers                  | 0.020<br>(0.028)                        | 0.021<br>(0.028)     | 0.021<br>(0.029)     | 0.020<br>(0.029)     | 0.020<br>(0.029)     | 0.020<br>(0.029)     |
| Work-from-home compliers                  | 0.013<br>(0.027)                        | 0.014<br>(0.027)     | 0.015<br>(0.027)     | 0.014<br>(0.027)     | 0.013<br>(0.027)     | 0.013<br>(0.027)     |
| Difficult task                            | -0.281***<br>(0.043)                    | -0.281***<br>(0.043) | -0.269***<br>(0.044) | -0.281***<br>(0.043) | -0.282***<br>(0.043) | -0.282***<br>(0.043) |
| Difficult task × Work-from-home compliers | 0.020<br>(0.056)                        | 0.020<br>(0.057)     | 0.016<br>(0.058)     | 0.020<br>(0.057)     | 0.020<br>(0.057)     | 0.020<br>(0.057)     |
| Office Accepters Average Accuracy         | 1.793                                   | 1.793                | 1.793                | 1.793                | 1.793                | 1.793                |
| Observations                              | 416,562                                 | 416,562              | 416,562              | 416,562              | 416,562              | 416,562              |
| Number Previous Tasks Completed           | ✓                                       | ✓                    |                      |                      |                      |                      |
| Number Previous Tasks Completed Squared   |                                         | ✓                    |                      |                      |                      |                      |
| Previous Tasks Completed Fixed Effects    |                                         |                      | ✓                    |                      |                      |                      |
| Number Previous Tasks Attempted           |                                         |                      |                      | ✓                    | ✓                    |                      |
| Number Previous Tasks Attempted Squared   |                                         |                      |                      |                      | ✓                    |                      |
| Previous Tasks Attempted Fixed Effects    |                                         |                      |                      |                      |                      | ✓                    |

*Notes:* This table characterizes the job performance of flexibility compliers. It compares individuals randomly offered a flexible, work-from-home job to those who were offered and accepted inflexible, office-based-work but then randomly upgraded to the flexible, home-based job. This holds work type constant, and compares individuals who are marginal to flexibility to those who are not.

- In Panel A, the outcome variable is the seconds taken to complete a task. In Panel B, the outcome is the accuracy score assigned to a task. In both Panels A and B, the omitted group is individuals who accepted office-based work before being randomly upgraded.
- Work-from-home compliers takes value 1 if an individual accepted flexible, home based work and 0 otherwise. Difficult job takes value 1 if the task is one of the three difficult task types and 0 otherwise.
- All columns include strata fixed effects. Columns (1) and (2) include controls for the number of tasks completed before the task, Column (2) also controls for non-linear effects of prior task completion. Column (3) includes fixed effects for all tasks that were previously completed. Column (4) and (5) control for number of tasks previously attempted, Column (5) also controls for non-linear effects. Column (6) includes fixed effects for previously attempted tasks.
- Standard errors in parentheses (·) are clustered at the worker level. Stars next to coefficients denote significance (\* at 10%; \*\* at 5%; \*\*\* at 1%).

Table A28: Assumptions used in the back-of-the-envelope calculation of firm tradeoffs

| Parameter                             | Value  | Units            | Source / Rationale                         |
|---------------------------------------|--------|------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| <i>Labor and productivity mapping</i> |        |                  |                                            |
| Hourly wage (imputed)                 | 120    | INR/hour         | Market wage equivalent used for accounting |
| Hours per worker per month            | 40     | hours            | 2 hrs/day $\times$ 20 days                 |
| Accuracy loss from WFH                | 0.04   | fraction         | Exp. estimate                              |
| Speed loss from WFH                   | 0.21   | fraction         | Exp. estimate                              |
| Derived revenue per hour (office)     | 120    | INR/hour         | Normalized to wage equivalent output       |
| Derived revenue per hour (home)       | 91.008 | INR/hour         | $120 \times (1 - 0.04) \times (1 - 0.21)$  |
| <i>Costs (firm-borne)</i>             |        |                  |                                            |
| Acquisition & development cost        | 200    | INR/worker-month | Implementation cost (common)               |
| Home verifier cost                    | 100    | INR/worker-month | WFH-only monitoring/verification           |
| Home supervisor–coordinator salary    | 5,000  | INR/month        | WFH-only fixed coordination cost           |
| Office rent                           | 8,000  | INR/office-month | Observed costs                             |
| Office supervisor salary              | 5,000  | INR/office-month | Observed costs                             |
| Office materials & maintenance        | 2,000  | INR/office-month | Observed costs                             |
| Total fixed office cost               | 15,000 | INR/office-month | Sum of above                               |
| Office capacity                       | 15     | workers/office   | Observed staffing                          |

*Notes:* This table reports the assumptions used in the back-of-the-envelope calculation comparing the costs of home-based versus office-based work from the firm’s perspective. This figure holds total hours fixed and compares unit economics. Productivity losses from work-from-home reflect experimentally estimated treatment effects on task accuracy and completion time. The calculation includes (i) costs common to both modes, (ii) work-from-home-specific monitoring/coordination costs, and (iii) office fixed costs that scale with the number of offices required, given capacity. Office-based work is assumed to incur fixed monthly costs, including rent, supervision, and materials, which do not scale with output. We assume a single home supervisor–coordinator covers the pilot scale shown in the figure. Workers are paid on a piece-rate basis, but the firm’s costs are expressed in hourly-equivalent terms to map experimentally estimated productivity differences into total labor costs.



Table A27: Characterizing Work-From-Home Compliers: Each Task Type Separately

|                                         | Characterizing work-from-home compliers |                      |                      |                      |                      |                      |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
|                                         | (1)                                     | (2)                  | (3)                  | (4)                  | (5)                  | (6)                  |
| <i>Panel A: Seconds Per Task</i>        |                                         |                      |                      |                      |                      |                      |
| Work-from-home compliers                | 2.13<br>(1.57)                          | 1.66<br>(1.38)       | 1.66<br>(1.40)       | 2.02<br>(1.55)       | 2.14<br>(1.55)       | 2.10<br>(1.55)       |
| Paragraph task                          | 38.7***<br>(2.87)                       | 38.7***<br>(2.87)    | 38.0***<br>(2.91)    | 38.6***<br>(2.87)    | 38.7***<br>(2.87)    | 37.5***<br>(2.94)    |
| Backwards task                          | 3.40***<br>(0.707)                      | 3.92***<br>(0.666)   | 3.63***<br>(0.669)   | 3.80***<br>(0.662)   | 4.06***<br>(0.660)   | 4.37***<br>(0.885)   |
| WFH $\times$ Paragraph                  | -0.333<br>(3.87)                        | -0.168<br>(3.91)     | -0.656<br>(3.79)     | -0.278<br>(3.87)     | -0.239<br>(3.87)     | -0.214<br>(3.86)     |
| WFH $\times$ Backwards                  | 0.387<br>(0.959)                        | 0.282<br>(0.945)     | 0.237<br>(0.947)     | 0.343<br>(0.952)     | 0.343<br>(0.952)     | 0.367<br>(0.961)     |
| Observations                            | 409,300                                 | 409,300              | 409,300              | 409,300              | 409,300              | 409,300              |
| Office Accepters Average Seconds        | 27.9                                    | 27.9                 | 27.9                 | 27.9                 | 27.9                 | 27.9                 |
| <i>Panel B: Accuracy</i>                |                                         |                      |                      |                      |                      |                      |
| Work-from-home compliers                | -0.006<br>(0.023)                       | -0.005<br>(0.023)    | -0.004<br>(0.024)    | -0.004<br>(0.023)    | -0.005<br>(0.023)    | -0.005<br>(0.024)    |
| Paragraph task                          | -0.365***<br>(0.062)                    | -0.365***<br>(0.062) | -0.349***<br>(0.063) | -0.365***<br>(0.062) | -0.365***<br>(0.062) | -0.372***<br>(0.067) |
| Backwards task                          | -0.165***<br>(0.041)                    | -0.166***<br>(0.041) | -0.157***<br>(0.042) | -0.165***<br>(0.041) | -0.167***<br>(0.041) | -0.178***<br>(0.045) |
| WFH $\times$ Paragraph                  | 0.031<br>(0.078)                        | 0.030<br>(0.078)     | 0.024<br>(0.079)     | 0.030<br>(0.078)     | 0.030<br>(0.078)     | 0.030<br>(0.077)     |
| WFH $\times$ Backwards                  | 0.004<br>(0.054)                        | 0.004<br>(0.054)     | 0.003<br>(0.055)     | 0.004<br>(0.054)     | 0.004<br>(0.054)     | 0.007<br>(0.054)     |
| Observations                            | 416,562                                 | 416,562              | 416,562              | 416,562              | 416,562              | 416,562              |
| Office Accepters Average Accuracy       | 1.71                                    | 1.71                 | 1.71                 | 1.71                 | 1.71                 | 1.71                 |
| Number Previous Tasks Completed         | ✓                                       | ✓                    |                      |                      |                      |                      |
| Number Previous Tasks Completed Squared |                                         | ✓                    |                      |                      |                      |                      |
| Previous Tasks Completed Fixed Effects  |                                         |                      | ✓                    |                      |                      |                      |
| Number Previous Tasks Attempted         |                                         |                      |                      | ✓                    | ✓                    |                      |
| Number Previous Tasks Attempted Squared |                                         |                      |                      |                      | ✓                    |                      |
| Previous Tasks Attempted Fixed Effects  |                                         |                      |                      |                      |                      | ✓                    |

*Notes:* This table characterizes the job performance of flexibility compliers, separately by task type. It compares individuals randomly offered a flexible, work-from-home job to those who were offered and accepted inflexible, office-based work but then randomly upgraded to the flexible, home-based job. This holds work type constant, and compares individuals who are marginal to flexibility to those who are not.

- In Panel A, the outcome variable is the seconds taken to complete a task. In Panel B, the outcome is the accuracy score assigned to a task. In both Panels A and B, the omitted group is individuals who accepted office-based work before being randomly upgraded.
- Work-from-home compliers takes value 1 if an individual accepted flexible, home-based work and 0 otherwise. Paragraph task takes value 1 if the task requires locating a specific sentence within a paragraph, and Backwards task takes value 1 if the task requires reading a sentence in reverse. The omitted task type is Simple (reading a sentence displayed on screen). Previously, Paragraph and Backwards were grouped together as “Difficult” tasks.
- All columns include strata fixed effects. Columns (1) and (2) include controls for the number of tasks completed before the task; Column (2) also controls for non-linear effects of prior task completion. Column (3) includes fixed effects for all tasks that were previously completed. Columns (4) and (5) control for number of tasks previously attempted; Column (5) also controls for non-linear effects. Column (6) includes fixed effects for previously attempted tasks.
- Standard errors in parentheses (·) are clustered at the worker level. Stars next to coefficients denote significance (\* at 10%; \*\* at 5%; \*\*\* at 1%).

Table A29: Implied scale and profitability per 1,000 job offers

| Arrangement          | Take-up | Offers | Workers | Hours/worker | Total hours | Firm profit (INR) |
|----------------------|---------|--------|---------|--------------|-------------|-------------------|
| Office               | 0.146   | 1,000  | 146     | 40           | 5,840       | 656,600           |
| Home: Fully flexible | 0.475   | 1,000  | 475     | 40           | 19,000      | 1,581,652         |

*Notes:* This table incorporates labor supply responses by scaling the unit-economics calculations in Figure A17 using experimentally estimated take-up rates. The calculation assumes that labor costs scale proportionally with output (as under piece-rate compensation), and that per-worker monitoring and coordination costs are locally constant over the scale shown. The table is intended as a back-of-the-envelope comparison rather than a statement about firm costs at an arbitrary scale.

Table A30: Comparing Study Participants to Wider Sampling Frame

| Variable                               | (1)           |                         | (2)           |                        | T-test             |
|----------------------------------------|---------------|-------------------------|---------------|------------------------|--------------------|
|                                        | Baseline<br>N | Incomplete<br>Mean/SE   | Baseline<br>N | Complete<br>Mean/SE    | P-value<br>(1)-(2) |
| Age                                    | 643           | 34.672<br>(0.475)       | 1858          | 30.255<br>(0.194)      | 0.000***           |
| Completed 10th grade (=1)              | 184           | 0.342<br>(0.035)        | 1857          | 0.497<br>(0.012)       | 0.000***           |
| Hindu (=1)                             | 158           | 0.715<br>(0.036)        | 1858          | 0.756<br>(0.010)       | 0.278              |
| Never worked for pay (=1)              | 152           | 0.625<br>(0.039)        | 1858          | 0.623<br>(0.011)       | 0.966              |
| Monthly household income (Rs.)         | 131           | 11126.420<br>(1253.202) | 1758          | 11805.316<br>(289.928) | 0.597              |
| Lives with in-laws (=1)                | 156           | 0.417<br>(0.040)        | 1858          | 0.394<br>(0.011)       | 0.581              |
| Has child $\leq$ 18yo (=1)             | 156           | 0.712<br>(0.036)        | 1858          | 0.734<br>(0.010)       | 0.559              |
| Has child $\leq$ 8yo (=1)              | 156           | 0.353<br>(0.038)        | 1858          | 0.467<br>(0.012)       | 0.004***           |
| Has final say in decision to work (=1) | 141           | 0.227<br>(0.035)        | 1859          | 0.363<br>(0.011)       | 0.000***           |

*Notes:* This table presents baseline characteristics of respondents who did and did not complete the baseline survey. Participants are grouped according to their baseline survey completion status, where those who completed the survey are considered study participants. The number of responses (N) and the mean of the characteristic are reported, with robust standard errors in parentheses below. The final column provides T-test  $p$ -values. Statistical significance is denoted by: \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*  $p < 0.10$ . Binary indicators (Completed 10th grade, hindu, never worked for pay, lives with in-laws, has child under 18, has children under 8, and has final say in decision to work) take values of 0 or 1.

## **A.1 Gender Attitudes Index**

**Questions.** The baseline gender attitudes index is composed of responses to the thirteen questions below:

1. People have different opinions about women having a job. Some people feel that women in your religion, caste and area should not have a job outside the home and they should only look after their families, while others say that there is nothing wrong if women have a job and earn money outside the home. What is your opinion?
2. What about if the woman can do the job from home?
3. It is the father's responsibility to earn a living in a family, and it is the mother's responsibility to take care of the children.
4. A woman's most important role is being a good homemaker.
5. Husband and wife should have equal say in decisions about significant household expenditures.
6. It is better for women to quit their jobs when they get married or have children.
7. A man's neighbors or friends will think poorly of him if his wife goes out to work.
8. It is possible for women to be good wives as well as to have a job.
9. A man should have the final word about decisions in his home.
10. Women who use social media risk their family's reputation.
11. A husband should know what his wife is doing while using a mobile phone at all times.
12. It is not wise for a family to allow their unmarried daughters to use their mobile phones or social media without supervision.
13. Husbands should help with household responsibilities such as cooking, cleaning, and child-care.

**Responses.** For questions (1) and (2), respondents had four options to respond with:

0. Strongly believe women should not work for pay
1. Believe women should not work for pay
2. Believe there is nothing wrong if women work for pay
3. Strongly believe there is nothing wrong if women work for pay

For questions (3)-(13), respondents could respond that they strongly disagree (0), disagree (1), agree (2), or strongly agree (3).

**Aggregation into Index.** First, the likert scale above was used to code participants' responses into numeric values. Second, responses were standardized to have mean zero and standard deviation one. Third, questions that were supportive of traditional gender roles were negated so that higher numeric values would always indicate holding less traditional views. This corresponds to negating the standardized numeric responses to questions (1), (2), (5), (8), and (13). In our main analysis, the responses are then aggregated following [Kling et al. \(2007\)](#), where we take an equally weighted average of the standardized responses after orienting the signs. We also show results when aggregating components following [Anderson \(2008\)](#), which weights components according to their new information (inverse correlation with other components).

**Children's Gender Attitudes Index.** The children's gender attitudes index is constructed and analyzed in the same way as the gender attitudes index for adults. However, the questions are adjusted in order to (a) have some questions that are appropriate specifically to children and adolescents and (b) to create some differences from the gender attitudes index questions asked to adults.

1. Boys are better than girls at using technology like phones or computers.
2. A woman's most important role is being a good homemaker.
3. A man should have the final word about decisions in his home.
4. Men are better suited than women to have a job or career.
5. Men and women should contribute to household work such as cooking, cleaning, and child-care equally.
6. Women should be allowed to work outside home.
7. Parents should supervise girls' phone use more closely than boys'.
8. Men cannot cook and clean well even if they try hard to learn it.
9. Women cannot play football well even if they try hard to learn it.
10. Men are better at math than women.
11. Being a politician is not a suitable profession for a woman.
12. Girls are equally as intelligent as boys.
13. It is more appropriate for girls to help with housework than boys.

14. Men generally understand money-related issues better than women.
15. It is more important for boys to go to university than girls.
16. Men have better judgment compared to women, hence they are better leaders.
17. When women have children, it's best if they quit their jobs and become housewives.

## **A.2 Back-of-the-envelope calculation for the employer**

This subsection presents a back-of-the-envelope calculation of a firm's tradeoffs in deciding whether to introduce the option to work from home. Allowing work to be completed from home can reduce fixed office costs, such as rent, materials, and in-person supervision, but may also reduce effective output per hour due to lower accuracy and longer task completion times. Which arrangement is more attractive depends on both how workers are compensated and on whether firms adjust along the intensive margin (holding total hours fixed) or the extensive margin (allowing total hours to vary with take-up).

*Benchmark: piece-rate compensation.* Under piece-rate compensation, workers are paid per unit of output rather than per hour. In this case, introducing work-from-home is unambiguously beneficial for the employer: the firm avoids office-related fixed costs, while productivity losses from lower accuracy and longer completion times are borne by workers through lower earnings per unit. This benchmark corresponds closely to the compensation structure used in our experiment and provides a useful reference point for interpreting the calculations below.

*Unit economics (holding total hours fixed).* Figure A17 compares the unit economics of completing a fixed volume of work from home versus from an office. The figure holds total hours worked constant and therefore isolates the tradeoff between fixed office costs and lower effective output per hour under work-from-home. Table A28 summarizes the cost assumptions used in this calculation, which are based on observed costs in our study areas and experimentally estimated impacts of work-from-home on task accuracy and completion time.

*Implications for salaried workers.* When workers are paid the same wage regardless of work

location, Figure A17 provides the appropriate benchmark for firm decision-making. At sufficiently low volumes of work, avoiding office fixed costs makes work-from-home cost-effective. At larger scales, office-based work becomes more attractive as fixed costs are spread over more output. If firms can instead set different wages for home-based versus office-based work, then work-from-home is profitable whenever workers' willingness-to-pay for flexibility—that is, their willingness to accept a lower wage to work from home—exceeds the productivity loss from home-based work. Evidence from our Mumbai experiment (Jalota and Ho, 2024) suggests that, in similar contexts, willingness-to-pay for work-from-home may be large enough to offset productivity losses.

*Scale effects and labor supply (allowing total hours to vary).* Figure A17 abstracts from labor supply responses by construction. In practice, take-up is substantially higher for work-from-home (0.475) than for office-based work (0.146), implying roughly 3.3 times as many workers and total hours from the same recruitment pool. Table A29 incorporates this extensive-margin response by scaling the unit-economics calculations using experimentally estimated take-up rates. This scale calculation assumes output-proportional compensation, as under piece-rate pay; under fixed salaried contracts, the extensive-margin comparison would be less relevant, and the unit-economics comparison in Figure A17 would remain the appropriate benchmark.

*Dynamic considerations.* Finally, all calculations above are based on a single time period. If short-term experience with work-from-home can increase women's willingness to accept office-based work in the future, this may potentially reduce long-run costs beyond what is captured in this static comparison.

All calculations underlying these cost calculations are reproduced in an accompanying spreadsheet, with parameters and sources documented to allow replication.

### **A.3 Participant Recruitment and Refusal Rates**

***Recruitment Procedure.*** Our partner organization, the Calcutta Foundation (CF), helped us recruit participants for the experiment. CF is a non-profit that provides disaster relief and implements

skilling and community building programs in West Bengal. With the help of CF, we selected three rural, three peri-urban, and two urban neighborhoods in which to conduct the study. In each neighborhood, CF identified a primary contact person to facilitate introductions between the study team and women in their neighborhood who met the eligibility criteria.

Recruitment was geographic in nature: we contacted women in areas where CF had previously operated, but we did not specifically recruit from CF beneficiary lists. Women were contacted based solely on the study's eligibility criteria. Notably, women who were currently participating in any CF skills training program were ineligible for the study, as we restricted our sample to women who were out of the labor force and not enrolled in skills training programs. While some participants may have been past recipients of CF's health or disaster relief programs, there is no overlap between our sample and active CF programming.

All contact persons were given a short introduction script. This script ensured that the study was introduced in a uniform way across areas and that women who were contacted did not know that there was the possibility of getting paid work as part of the study. The survey team reached out to women who agreed to be contacted. The introduction script used by the contact persons is provided below.

*“A team of researchers from J-PAL (an organization based in MIT, USA) are partnering with Calcutta Foundation to study women's lives in India and how households are structured related to employment (you do not need to be employed or interested in being employed). They are looking to conduct a few short surveys with women and their household members in Calcutta. Women and their household members will be compensated for spending time answering the surveys, and can receive up to Rs.150 depending on how many surveys they complete. If you are interested in hearing more about this, I can share a few more details and forward your number to their team. If you agree to be contacted by J-PAL for this study:*

- You will receive a call in March/April 2022. You will be asked to complete 2 short surveys, and if possible, your husband and child (8-18 years) will be asked to complete one short survey each.*

- *The surveys will ask about your household (such as employment status of household members, income, etc.), your interest in work opportunities, how you spend your time on a typical day, and your thoughts and feelings about certain situations.*
- *You will receive up to Rs.150 within a week after you complete these surveys. You can also skip any questions you do not wish to answer and the survey will be scheduled as per your convenience.”*

***Participation, Refusal and No-contact Rates.*** The survey team attempted to contact 3,378 women across the eight identified areas. 1,891 women completed the baseline survey, and after an initial round of data cleaning, 1,670 women were found to meet the eligibility criteria and were randomly assigned to the control condition or to receive one of the job offers. Out of 1,473 women who were contacted but did not complete the baseline survey, 650 (44.1%) could not be reached, 285 (19.3%) refused to participate, and 538 (36.5%) either did not understand or could not speak Hindi nor Bangla. Out of the women who refused, 135 (47.4%) reported a lack of interest in the study and 101 (34.8%) reported that they did not have permission from their family to participate.

***Comparing Participants to the Sample Frame.*** Given that most of the respondents who were contacted but did not end up participating in the study did not complete the baseline survey, the demographic data that would allow us to compare participants to the wider sampling frame is limited. Based on all available baseline responses, we compare demographic characteristics of respondents who did and did not complete the baseline survey in Table A30. We find that women who completed the baseline survey are on average similar to women who did not in terms of their household’s monthly income, their rates of never having worked for pay, the likelihood that they cohabit with their in-laws and the likelihood that they have a child below the age of 18. However, the average study participant is younger, more likely to have completed schooling up to 10th standard, more likely to have a child under the age of 8 and more likely to report having the final say in their decision to work.